

BibInVs MN 11

Kings1

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 11*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

1 Kings

1 Kings 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 King David grew old. The years had caught up with him. Even though they piled blankets on him, he couldn't keep warm.
- 1 When King David was old and well advanced in years, he could not keep warm even when they put covers over him.
- 2 So his servants said to him, "We're going to get a young virgin for our master the king to be at his side and look after him; she'll get in bed with you and arouse our master the king."
- 2 So his servants said to him, "Let us look for a young virgin to attend the king and take care of him. She can lie beside him so that our lord the king may keep warm."
- 3 So they searched the country of Israel for the most ravishing girl they could find; they found Abishag the Shunammite and brought her to the king.
- 3 Then they searched throughout Israel for a beautiful girl and found Abishag, a Shunammite, and brought her to the king.
- 4 The girl was stunningly beautiful; she stayed at his side and looked after the king, but the king did not have sex with her.
- 4 The girl was very beautiful; she took care of the king and waited on him, but the king had no intimate relations with her.
- 5 At this time Adonijah, whose mother was Haggith, puffed himself up saying, "I'm the next king!" He made quite a splash, with chariots and riders and fifty men to run ahead of him.
- 5 Now Adonijah, whose mother was Haggith, put himself forward and said, "I will be king." So he got chariots and horses ready, with fifty men to run ahead of him.
- 6 His father had spoiled him rotten as a child, never once reprimanding him. Besides that, he was very good-looking and the next in line after

Absalom.

- 6 (His father had never interfered with him by asking, "Why do you behave as you do?" He was also very handsome and was born next after Absalom.)
- 7 Adonijah talked with Joab son of Zeruiah and with Abiathar the priest, and they threw their weight on his side.
- 7 Adonijah conferred with Joab son of Zeruiah and with Abiathar the priest, and they gave him their support.
- 8 But neither the priest Zadok, nor Benaiah son of Jehoiada, nor Nathan the prophet, nor Shimei and Rei, nor David's personal bodyguards supported Adonijah.
- 8 But Zadok the priest, Benaiah son of Jehoiada, Nathan the prophet, Shimei and Rei and David's special guard did not join Adonijah.
- 9 Next Adonijah held a coronation feast, sacrificing sheep, cattle, and grain-fed heifers at the Stone of Zohemoth near the Rogel Spring. He invited all his brothers, the king's sons, and everyone in Judah who had position and influence--
- 9 Adonijah then sacrificed sheep, cattle and fattened calves at the Stone of Zohemoth near En Rogel. He invited all his brothers, the king's sons, and all the men of Judah who were royal officials,
- 10 but he did not invite the prophet Nathan, Benaiah, the bodyguards, or his brother Solomon.
- 10 but he did not invite Nathan the prophet or Benaiah or the special guard or his brother Solomon.
- 11 Nathan went to Bathsheba, Solomon's mother, "Did you know that Adonijah, Haggith's son, has taken over as king, and our master David doesn't know a thing about it?
- 11 Then Nathan asked Bathsheba, Solomon's mother, "Have you not heard that Adonijah, the son of Haggith, has become king without our lord David's knowing it?
- 12 Quickly now, let me tell you how you can save both your own life and Solomon's.
- 12 Now then, let me advise you how you can save your own life and the life of your son Solomon.
- 13 Go immediately to King David. Speak up: 'Didn't you, my master the king, promise me, "Your son Solomon will be king after me and sit on

- my throne"? So why is Adonijah now king?'
- 13 Go in to King David and say to him, 'My lord the king, did you not swear to me your servant: "Surely Solomon your son shall be king after me, and he will sit on my throne"? Why then has Adonijah become king?'
- 14 While you're there talking with the king, I'll come in and corroborate your story."
- 14 While you are still there talking to the king, I will come in and confirm what you have said."
- 15 Bathsheba went at once to the king in his palace bedroom. He was so old! Abishag was at his side making him comfortable.
- 15 So Bathsheba went to see the aged king in his room, where Abishag the Shunammite was attending him.
- 16 As Bathsheba bowed low, honoring the king, he said, "What do you want?"
- 16 Bathsheba bowed low and knelt before the king. "What is it you want?" the king asked.
- 17 "My master," she said, "you promised me in GOD's name, 'Your son Solomon will be king after me and sit on my throne.'
- 17 She said to him, "My lord, you yourself swore to me your servant by the LORD your God: 'Solomon your son shall be king after me, and he will sit on my throne.'
- 18 And now look what's happened--Adonijah has taken over as king, and my master the king doesn't even know it!
- 18 But now Adonijah has become king, and you, my lord the king, do not know about it.
- 19 He has thrown a huge coronation feast--cattle and grain-fed heifers and sheep--inviting all the king's sons, the priest Abiathar, and Joab head of the army. But your servant Solomon was not invited.
- 19 He has sacrificed great numbers of cattle, fattened calves, and sheep, and has invited all the king's sons, Abiathar the priest and Joab the commander of the army, but he has not invited Solomon your servant.
- 20 My master the king, every eye in Israel is watching you to see what you'll do--to see who will sit on the throne of my master the king after him.

20 My lord the king, the eyes of all Israel are on you, to learn from you who will sit on the throne of my lord the king after him.

21 If you fail to act, the moment you're buried my son Solomon and I are as good as dead."

21 Otherwise, as soon as my lord the king is laid to rest with his fathers, I and my son Solomon will be treated as criminals."

22 Abruptly, while she was telling the king all this, Nathan the prophet came in

22 While she was still speaking with the king, Nathan the prophet arrived.

23 and was announced: "Nathan the prophet is here." He came before the king, honoring him by bowing deeply, his face touching the ground.

23 And they told the king, "Nathan the prophet is here." So he went before the king and bowed with his face to the ground.

24 "My master the king," Nathan began, "did you say, 'Adonijah shall be king after me and sit on my throne'?"

24 Nathan said, "Have you, my lord the king, declared that Adonijah shall be king after you, and that he will sit on your throne?"

25 Because that's what's happening. He's thrown a huge coronation feast--cattle, grain-fed heifers, sheep--inviting all the king's sons, the army officers, and Abiathar the priest. They're having a grand time, eating and drinking and shouting, 'Long live King Adonijah!'

25 Today he has gone down and sacrificed great numbers of cattle, fattened calves, and sheep. He has invited all the king's sons, the commanders of the army and Abiathar the priest. Right now they are eating and drinking with him and saying, 'Long live King Adonijah!'

26 But I wasn't invited, nor was the priest Zadok, nor Benaiah son of Jehoiada, nor your servant Solomon.

26 But me your servant, and Zadok the priest, and Benaiah son of Jehoiada, and your servant Solomon he did not invite.

27 Is this something that my master the king has done behind our backs, not telling your servants who you intended to be king after you?"

27 Is this something my lord the king has done without letting his servants know who should sit on the throne of my lord the king after him?"

28 King David took action: "Get Bathsheba back in here." She entered and stood before the king.

28 Then King David said, "Call in Bathsheba." So she came into the king's presence and stood before him.

29 The king solemnly promised, "As GOD lives, the God who delivered me from every kind of trouble,

29 The king then took an oath: "As surely as the LORD lives, who has delivered me out of every trouble,

30 I'll do exactly what I promised in GOD's name, the God of Israel: Your son Solomon will be king after me and take my place on the throne. And I'll make sure it happens this very day."

30 I will surely carry out today what I swore to you by the LORD, the God of Israel: Solomon your son shall be king after me, and he will sit on my throne in my place."

31 Bathsheba bowed low, her face to the ground. Kneeling in reverence before the king she said, "Oh, may my master, King David, live forever!"

31 Then Bathsheba bowed low with her face to the ground and, kneeling before the king, said, "May my lord King David live forever!"

32 King David said, "Call Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah son of Jehoiada." They came to the king.

32 King David said, "Call in Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet and Benaiah son of Jehoiada." When they came before the king,

33 Then he ordered, "Gather my servants, then mount my son Solomon on my royal mule and lead him in procession down to Gihon.

33 he said to them: "Take your lord's servants with you and set Solomon my son on my own mule and take him down to Gihon.

34 When you get there, Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet will anoint him king over Israel. Then blow the ram's horn trumpet and shout, 'Long live King Solomon!'

34 There have Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet anoint him king over Israel. Blow the trumpet and shout, 'Long live King Solomon!'

35 You will then accompany him as he enters and takes his place on my throne, succeeding me as king. I have named him ruler over Israel and Judah."

35 Then you are to go up with him, and he is to come and sit on my throne and reign in my place. I have appointed him ruler over Israel and Judah."

36 Benaiah son of Jehoiada backed the king: "Yes! And may GOD, the God of my master the king, confirm it!

- 36 Benaiah son of Jehoiada answered the king, "Amen! May the LORD, the God of my lord the king, so declare it.
- 37 Just as GOD has been with my master the king, may he also be with Solomon and make his rule even greater than that of my master King David!"
- 37 As the LORD was with my lord the king, so may he be with Solomon to make his throne even greater than the throne of my lord King David!"
- 38 Then Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, Benaiah son of Jehoiada, and the king's personal bodyguard (the Kerethites and Pelethites) went down, mounted Solomon on King David's mule, and paraded with him to Gihon.
- 38 So Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, Benaiah son of Jehoiada, the Kerethites and the Pelethites went down and put Solomon on King David's mule and escorted him to Gihon.
- 39 Zadok the priest brought a flask of oil from the sanctuary and anointed Solomon. They blew the ram's horn trumpet and everyone shouted, "Long live King Solomon!"
- 39 Zadok the priest took the horn of oil from the sacred tent and anointed Solomon. Then they sounded the trumpet and all the people shouted, "Long live King Solomon!"
- 40 Everyone joined the fanfare, the band playing and the people singing, the very earth reverberating to the sound.
- 40 And all the people went up after him, playing flutes and rejoicing greatly, so that the ground shook with the sound.
- 41 Adonijah and his retinue of guests were just finishing their "coronation" feast when they heard it. When Joab heard the blast of the ram's horn trumpet he said, "What's going on here? What's all this uproar?"
- 41 Adonijah and all the guests who were with him heard it as they were finishing their feast. On hearing the sound of the trumpet, Joab asked, "What's the meaning of all the noise in the city?"
- 42 Suddenly, in the midst of the questioning, Jonathan son of Abiathar the priest, showed up. Adonijah said, "Welcome! A brave and good man like you must have good news."
- 42 Even as he was speaking, Jonathan son of Abiathar the priest arrived. Adonijah said, "Come in. A worthy man like you must be bringing good news."

43 But Jonathan answered, "Hardly! Our master King David has just made Solomon king!

43 Not at all! Jonathan answered. "Our lord King David has made Solomon king.

44 And the king has surrounded him with Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, Benaiah son of Jehoiada, with the Kerethites and Pelethites; and they've mounted Solomon on the royal mule.

44 The king has sent with him Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, Benaiah son of Jehoiada, the Kerethites and the Pelethites, and they have put him on the king's mule,

45 Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet have anointed him king at Gihon and the parade is headed up this way singing--a great fanfare! The city is rocking! That's what you're hearing.

45 and Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet have anointed him king at Gihon. From there they have gone up cheering, and the city resounds with it. That's the noise you hear.

46 Here's the crowning touch--Solomon is seated on the throne of the kingdom!

46 Moreover, Solomon has taken his seat on the royal throne.

47 And that's not all: The king's servants have come to give their blessing to our master King David saying, 'God make Solomon's name even more honored than yours, and make his rule greater than yours!' On his death bed the king worshiped God

47 Also, the royal officials have come to congratulate our lord King David, saying, 'May your God make Solomon's name more famous than yours and his throne greater than yours!' And the king bowed in worship on his bed

48 and prayed, 'Blessed be GOD, Israel's God, who has provided a successor to my throne, and I've lived to see it!'"

48 and said, 'Praise be to the LORD, the God of Israel, who has allowed my eyes to see a successor on my throne today.' "

49 Panicked, Adonijah's guests got out of there, scattering every which way.

49 At this, all Adonijah's guests rose in alarm and dispersed.

50 But Adonijah himself, afraid for his life because of Solomon, fled to the sanctuary and grabbed the horns of the Altar.

- 50 But Adonijah, in fear of Solomon, went and took hold of the horns of the altar.
- 51 Solomon was told, "Adonijah, fearful of King Solomon, has taken sanctuary and seized the horns of the Altar and is saying, 'I'm not leaving until King Solomon promises that he won't kill me.'"
- 51 Then Solomon was told, "Adonijah is afraid of King Solomon and is clinging to the horns of the altar. He says, 'Let King Solomon swear to me today that he will not put his servant to death with the sword.' "
- 52 Solomon then said, "If he proves to be a man of honor, not a hair of his head will be hurt; but if there is evil in him, he'll die."
- 52 Solomon replied, "If he shows himself to be a worthy man, not a hair of his head will fall to the ground; but if evil is found in him, he will die."
- 53 Solomon summoned him and they brought him from the Altar. Adonijah came and bowed down, honoring the king. Solomon dismissed him, "Go home."
- 53 Then King Solomon sent men, and they brought him down from the altar. And Adonijah came and bowed down to King Solomon, and Solomon said, "Go to your home."

1 Kings 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 When David's time to die approached, he charged his son Solomon, saying,
- 1 When the time drew near for David to die, he gave a charge to Solomon his son.
- 2 "I'm about to go the way of all the earth, but you--be strong; show what you're made of!
- 2 I am about to go the way of all the earth, he said. "So be strong, show yourself a man,
- 3 Do what GOD tells you. Walk in the paths he shows you: Follow the life-map absolutely, keep an eye out for the signposts, his course for life set out in the revelation to Moses; then you'll get on well in whatever you do and wherever you go.

- 3 and observe what the LORD your God requires: Walk in his ways, and keep his decrees and commands, his laws and requirements, as written in the Law of Moses, so that you may prosper in all you do and wherever you go,
- 4 Then GOD will confirm what he promised me when he said, 'If your sons watch their step, staying true to me heart and soul, you'll always have a successor on Israel's throne.'
- 4 and that the LORD may keep his promise to me: 'If your descendants watch how they live, and if they walk faithfully before me with all their heart and soul, you will never fail to have a man on the throne of Israel.'
- 5 "And don't forget what Joab son of Zeruiah did to the two commanders of Israel's army, to Abner son of Ner and to Amasa son of Jether. He murdered them in cold blood, acting in peacetime as if he were at war, and has been stained with that blood ever since.
- 5 Now you yourself know what Joab son of Zeruiah did to me--what he did to the two commanders of Israel's armies, Abner son of Ner and Amasa son of Jether. He killed them, shedding their blood in peacetime as if in battle, and with that blood stained the belt around his waist and the sandals on his feet.
- 6 Do what you think best with him, but by no means let him get off scot-free--make him pay.
- 6 Deal with him according to your wisdom, but do not let his gray head go down to the grave in peace.
- 7 "But be generous to the sons of Barzillai the Gileadite--extend every hospitality to them; that's the way they treated me when I was running for my life from Absalom your brother.
- 7 But show kindness to the sons of Barzillai of Gilead and let them be among those who eat at your table. They stood by me when I fled from your brother Absalom.
- 8 "You also will have to deal with Shimei son of Gera the Benjaminite from Bahurim, the one who cursed me so viciously when I was on my way to Mahanaim. Later, when he welcomed me back at the Jordan, I promised him under GOD, 'I won't put you to death.'
- 8 And remember, you have with you Shimei son of Gera, the Benjamite from Bahurim, who called down bitter curses on me the day I went to

- Mahanaim. When he came down to meet me at the Jordan, I swore to him by the LORD: 'I will not put you to death by the sword.'
- 9 But neither should you treat him as if nothing ever happened. You're wise, you know how to handle these things. You'll know what to do to make him pay before he dies."
- 9 But now, do not consider him innocent. You are a man of wisdom; you will know what to do to him. Bring his gray head down to the grave in blood."
- 10 Then David joined his ancestors. He was buried in the City of David.
- 10 Then David rested with his fathers and was buried in the City of David.
- 11 David ruled Israel for forty years--seven years in Hebron and another thirty-three in Jerusalem.
- 11 He had reigned forty years over Israel--seven years in Hebron and thirty-three in Jerusalem.
- 12 Solomon took over on the throne of his father David; he had a firm grip on the kingdom.
- 12 So Solomon sat on the throne of his father David, and his rule was firmly established.
- 13 Adonijah son of Haggith came to Bathsheba, Solomon's mother. She said, "Do you come in peace?" He said, "In peace."
- 13 Now Adonijah, the son of Haggith, went to Bathsheba, Solomon's mother. Bathsheba asked him, "Do you come peacefully?" He answered, "Yes, peacefully."
- 14 And then, "May I say something to you?" "Go ahead," she said, "speak."
- 14 Then he added, "I have something to say to you." "You may say it," she replied.
- 15 "You know that I had the kingdom right in my hands and everyone expected me to be king, and then the whole thing backfired and the kingdom landed in my brother's lap--GOD's doing.
- 15 As you know, he said, "the kingdom was mine. All Israel looked to me as their king. But things changed, and the kingdom has gone to my brother; for it has come to him from the LORD.
- 16 So now I have one request to ask of you; please don't refuse me." "Go ahead, ask," she said.

- 16 Now I have one request to make of you. Do not refuse me." "You may make it," she said.
- 17 "Ask King Solomon--he won't turn you down--to give me Abishag the Shunammite as my wife."
- 17 So he continued, "Please ask King Solomon--he will not refuse you--to give me Abishag the Shunammite as my wife."
- 18 "Certainly," said Bathsheba. "I'll speak to the king for you."
- 18 Very well, Bathsheba replied, "I will speak to the king for you."
- 19 Bathsheba went to King Solomon to present Adonijah's request. The king got up and welcomed her, bowing respectfully, and returned to his throne. Then he had a throne put in place for his mother, and she sat at his right hand.
- 19 When Bathsheba went to King Solomon to speak to him for Adonijah, the king stood up to meet her, bowed down to her and sat down on his throne. He had a throne brought for the king's mother, and she sat down at his right hand.
- 20 She said, "I have a small favor to ask of you. Don't refuse me." The king replied, "Go ahead, Mother; of course I won't refuse you."
- 20 I have one small request to make of you, she said. "Do not refuse me." The king replied, "Make it, my mother; I will not refuse you."
- 21 She said, "Give Abishag the Shunammite to your brother Adonijah as his wife."
- 21 So she said, "Let Abishag the Shunammite be given in marriage to your brother Adonijah."
- 22 King Solomon answered his mother, "What kind of favor is this, asking that Abishag the Shunammite be given to Adonijah? Why don't you just ask me to hand over the whole kingdom to him on a platter since he is my older brother and has Abiathar the priest and Joab son of Zeruiah on his side!"
- 22 King Solomon answered his mother, "Why do you request Abishag the Shunammite for Adonijah? You might as well request the kingdom for him--after all, he is my older brother--yes, for him and for Abiathar the priest and Joab son of Zeruiah!"
- 23 Then King Solomon swore under GOD, "May God do his worst to me if Adonijah doesn't pay for this with his life!"

- 23 Then King Solomon swore by the LORD: "May God deal with me, be it ever so severely, if Adonijah does not pay with his life for this request!"
- 24 As surely as GOD lives, the God who has set me firmly on the throne of my father David and has put me in charge of the kingdom just as he promised, Adonijah will die for this--today!"
- 24 And now, as surely as the LORD lives--he who has established me securely on the throne of my father David and has founded a dynasty for me as he promised--Adonijah shall be put to death today!"
- 25 King Solomon dispatched Benaiah son of Jehoiada; he struck Adonijah and he died.
- 25 So King Solomon gave orders to Benaiah son of Jehoiada, and he struck down Adonijah and he died.
- 26 The king then told Abiathar the priest, "You're exiled to your place in Anathoth. You deserve death but I'm not going to kill you--for now anyway--because you were in charge of the Chest of our ruling GOD in the company of David my father, and because you shared all the hard times with my father."
- 26 To Abiathar the priest the king said, "Go back to your fields in Anathoth. You deserve to die, but I will not put you to death now, because you carried the ark of the Sovereign LORD before my father David and shared all my father's hardships."
- 27 Solomon stripped Abiathar of his priesthood, fulfilling GOD's word at Shiloh regarding the family of Eli.
- 27 So Solomon removed Abiathar from the priesthood of the LORD, fulfilling the word the LORD had spoken at Shiloh about the house of Eli.
- 28 When this news reached Joab, this Joab who had conspired with Adonijah (although he had remained loyal in the Absalom affair), he took refuge in the sanctuary of GOD, seizing the horns of the Altar and holding on for dear life.
- 28 When the news reached Joab, who had conspired with Adonijah though not with Absalom, he fled to the tent of the LORD and took hold of the horns of the altar.
- 29 King Solomon was told that Joab had escaped to the sanctuary of GOD and was clinging to the Altar; he immediately sent Benaiah son of Jehoiada with orders, "Kill him."

- 29 King Solomon was told that Joab had fled to the tent of the LORD and was beside the altar. Then Solomon ordered Benaiah son of Jehoiada, "Go, strike him down!"
- 30 Benaiah went to the sanctuary of GOD and said, "King's orders: Come out." He said, "No--I'll die right here." Benaiah went back to the king and reported, "This was Joab's answer."
- 30 So Benaiah entered the tent of the LORD and said to Joab, "The king says, 'Come out!' " But he answered, "No, I will die here." Benaiah reported to the king, "This is how Joab answered me."
- 31 The king said, "Go ahead then, do what he says: Kill him and bury him. Absolve me and my father's family of the guilt from Joab's senseless murders.
- 31 Then the king commanded Benaiah, "Do as he says. Strike him down and bury him, and so clear me and my father's house of the guilt of the innocent blood that Joab shed.
- 32 GOD is avenging those bloody murders on Joab's head. Two men he murdered, men better by far than he ever was: Behind my father's back he brutally murdered Abner son of Ner, commander of Israel's army, and Amasa son of Jether, commander of Judah's army.
- 32 The LORD will repay him for the blood he shed, because without the knowledge of my father David he attacked two men and killed them with the sword. Both of them--Abner son of Ner, commander of Israel's army, and Amasa son of Jether, commander of Judah's army--were better men and more upright than he.
- 33 Responsibility for their murders is forever fixed on Joab and his descendants; but for David and his descendants, his family and kingdom, the final verdict is GOD's peace."
- 33 May the guilt of their blood rest on the head of Joab and his descendants forever. But on David and his descendants, his house and his throne, may there be the LORD's peace forever."
- 34 So Benaiah son of Jehoiada went back, struck Joab, and killed him. He was buried in his family plot out in the desert.
- 34 So Benaiah son of Jehoiada went up and struck down Joab and killed him, and he was buried on his own land in the desert.
- 35 The king appointed Benaiah son of Jehoiada over the army in place of Joab, and replaced Abiathar with Zadok the priest.

- 35 The king put Benaiah son of Jehoiada over the army in Joab's position and replaced Abiathar with Zadok the priest.
- 36 The king next called in Shimei and told him, "Build yourself a house in Jerusalem and live there, but you are not to leave the area.
- 36 Then the king sent for Shimei and said to him, "Build yourself a house in Jerusalem and live there, but do not go anywhere else.
- 37 If you so much as cross the Brook Kidron, you're as good as dead--you will have decreed your own death sentence."
- 37 The day you leave and cross the Kidron Valley, you can be sure you will die; your blood will be on your own head."
- 38 Shimei answered the king, "Oh, thank you! Your servant will do exactly as my master the king says." Shimei lived in Jerusalem a long time.
- 38 Shimei answered the king, "What you say is good. Your servant will do as my lord the king has said." And Shimei stayed in Jerusalem for a long time.
- 39 But it so happened that three years later, two of Shimei's slaves ran away to Achish son of Maacah, king of Gath. Shimei was told, "Your slaves are in Gath."
- 39 But three years later, two of Shimei's slaves ran off to Achish son of Maacah, king of Gath, and Shimei was told, "Your slaves are in Gath."
- 40 Shimei sprang into action, saddled his donkey, and went to Achish in Gath looking for his slaves. And then he came back, bringing his slaves.
- 40 At this, he saddled his donkey and went to Achish at Gath in search of his slaves. So Shimei went away and brought the slaves back from Gath.
- 41 Solomon was told, "Shimei left Jerusalem for Gath, and now he's back."
- 41 When Solomon was told that Shimei had gone from Jerusalem to Gath and had returned,
- 42 Solomon then called for Shimei and said, "Didn't I make you promise me under GOD, and give you a good warning besides, that you would not leave this area? That if you left you would have decreed your own death sentence? And didn't you say, 'Oh, thank you--I'll do exactly as you say'?"
- 42 the king summoned Shimei and said to him, "Did I not make you swear by the LORD and warn you, 'On the day you leave to go anywhere else, you can be sure you will die'? At that time you said to me, 'What you say is good. I will obey.'

- 43 So why didn't you keep your sacred promise and do what I ordered?"
- 43 Why then did you not keep your oath to the LORD and obey the command I gave you?"
- 44 Then the king told Shimei, "Deep in your heart you know all the evil that you did to my father David; GOD will now avenge that evil on you.
- 44 The king also said to Shimei, "You know in your heart all the wrong you did to my father David. Now the LORD will repay you for your wrongdoing.
- 45 But King Solomon will be blessed and the rule of David will be a sure thing under GOD forever."
- 45 But King Solomon will be blessed, and David's throne will remain secure before the LORD forever."
- 46 The king then gave orders to Benaiah son of Jehoiada; he went out and struck Shimei dead. The kingdom was now securely in Solomon's grasp.
- 46 Then the king gave the order to Benaiah son of Jehoiada, and he went out and struck Shimei down and killed him. The kingdom was now firmly established in Solomon's hands.

1 Kings 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 Solomon arranged a marriage contract with Pharaoh, king of Egypt. He married Pharaoh's daughter and brought her to the City of David until he had completed building his royal palace and GOD's Temple and the wall around Jerusalem.
- 1 Solomon made an alliance with Pharaoh king of Egypt and married his daughter. He brought her to the City of David until he finished building his palace and the temple of the LORD, and the wall around Jerusalem.
- 2 Meanwhile, the people were worshiping at local shrines because at that time no temple had yet been built to the Name of GOD.
- 2 The people, however, were still sacrificing at the high places, because a temple had not yet been built for the Name of the LORD.
- 3 Solomon loved GOD and continued to live in the God-honoring ways of David his father, except that he also worshiped at the local shrines, offering sacrifices and burning incense.

- 3 Solomon showed his love for the LORD by walking according to the statutes of his father David, except that he offered sacrifices and burned incense on the high places.
- 4 The king went to Gibeon, the most prestigious of the local shrines, to worship. He sacrificed a thousand Whole-Burnt-Offerings on that altar.
- 4 The king went to Gibeon to offer sacrifices, for that was the most important high place, and Solomon offered a thousand burnt offerings on that altar.
- 5 That night, there in Gibeon, GOD appeared to Solomon in a dream: God said, "What can I give you? Ask."
- 5 At Gibeon the LORD appeared to Solomon during the night in a dream, and God said, "Ask for whatever you want me to give you."
- 6 Solomon said, "You were extravagantly generous in love with David my father, and he lived faithfully in your presence, his relationships were just and his heart right. And you have persisted in this great and generous love by giving him--and this very day!--a son to sit on his throne.
- 6 Solomon answered, "You have shown great kindness to your servant, my father David, because he was faithful to you and righteous and upright in heart. You have continued this great kindness to him and have given him a son to sit on his throne this very day.
- 7 "And now here I am: GOD, my God, you have made me, your servant, ruler of the kingdom in place of David my father. I'm too young for this, a mere child! I don't know the ropes, hardly know the 'ins' and 'outs' of this job.
- 7 Now, O LORD my God, you have made your servant king in place of my father David. But I am only a little child and do not know how to carry out my duties.
- 8 And here I am, set down in the middle of the people you've chosen, a great people--far too many to ever count.
- 8 Your servant is here among the people you have chosen, a great people, too numerous to count or number.
- 9 "Here's what I want: Give me a God-listening heart so I can lead your people well, discerning the difference between good and evil. For who on their own is capable of leading your glorious people?"

- 9 So give your servant a discerning heart to govern your people and to distinguish between right and wrong. For who is able to govern this great people of yours?"
- 10 God, the Master, was delighted with Solomon's response.
- 10 The Lord was pleased that Solomon had asked for this.
- 11 And God said to him, "Because you have asked for this and haven't grasped after a long life, or riches, or the doom of your enemies, but you have asked for the ability to lead and govern well,
- 11 So God said to him, "Since you have asked for this and not for long life or wealth for yourself, nor have asked for the death of your enemies but for discernment in administering justice,
- 12 I'll give you what you've asked for--I'm giving you a wise and mature heart. There's never been one like you before; and there'll be no one after.
- 12 I will do what you have asked. I will give you a wise and discerning heart, so that there will never have been anyone like you, nor will there ever be.
- 13 As a bonus, I'm giving you both the wealth and glory you didn't ask for--there's not a king anywhere who will come up to your mark.
- 13 Moreover, I will give you what you have not asked for--both riches and honor--so that in your lifetime you will have no equal among kings.
- 14 And if you stay on course, keeping your eye on the life-map and the God-signs as your father David did, I'll also give you a long life."
- 14 And if you walk in my ways and obey my statutes and commands as David your father did, I will give you a long life."
- 15 Solomon woke up--what a dream! He returned to Jerusalem, took his place before the Chest of the Covenant of God, and worshiped by sacrificing Whole-Burnt-Offerings and Peace-Offerings. Then he laid out a banquet for everyone in his service.
- 15 Then Solomon awoke--and he realized it had been a dream. He returned to Jerusalem, stood before the ark of the Lord's covenant and sacrificed burnt offerings and fellowship offerings. Then he gave a feast for all his court.
- 16 The very next thing, two prostitutes showed up before the king.
- 16 Now two prostitutes came to the king and stood before him.

- 17 The one woman said, "My master, this woman and I live in the same house. While we were living together, I had a baby.
- 17 One of them said, "My lord, this woman and I live in the same house. I had a baby while she was there with me.
- 18 Three days after I gave birth, this woman also had a baby. We were alone--there wasn't anyone else in the house except for the two of us.
- 18 The third day after my child was born, this woman also had a baby. We were alone; there was no one in the house but the two of us.
- 19 The infant son of this woman died one night when she rolled over on him in her sleep.
- 19 During the night this woman's son died because she lay on him.
- 20 She got up in the middle of the night and took my son--I was sound asleep, mind you!--and put him at her breast and put her dead son at my breast.
- 20 So she got up in the middle of the night and took my son from my side while I your servant was asleep. She put him by her breast and put her dead son by my breast.
- 21 When I got up in the morning to nurse my son, here was this dead baby! But when I looked at him in the morning light, I saw immediately that he wasn't my baby."
- 21 The next morning, I got up to nurse my son--and he was dead! But when I looked at him closely in the morning light, I saw that it wasn't the son I had borne."
- 22 "Not so!" said the other woman. "The living one's mine; the dead one's yours." The first woman countered, "No! Your son's the dead one; mine's the living one." They went back and forth this way in front of the king.
- 22 The other woman said, "No! The living one is my son; the dead one is yours." But the first one insisted, "No! The dead one is yours; the living one is mine." And so they argued before the king.
- 23 The king said, "What are we to do? This woman says, 'The living son is mine and the dead one is yours,' and this woman says, 'No, the dead one's yours and the living one's mine.'"
- 23 The king said, "This one says, 'My son is alive and your son is dead,' while that one says, 'No! Your son is dead and mine is alive.' "
- 24 After a moment the king said, "Bring me a sword." They brought the sword to the king.

- 24 Then the king said, "Bring me a sword." So they brought a sword for the king.
- 25 Then he said, "Cut the living baby in two--give half to one and half to the other."
- 25 He then gave an order: "Cut the living child in two and give half to one and half to the other."
- 26 The real mother of the living baby was overcome with emotion for her son and said, "Oh no, master! Give her the whole baby alive; don't kill him!" But the other one said, "If I can't have him, you can't have him--cut away!"
- 26 The woman whose son was alive was filled with compassion for her son and said to the king, "Please, my lord, give her the living baby! Don't kill him!" But the other said, "Neither I nor you shall have him. Cut him in two!"
- 27 The king gave his decision: "Give the living baby to the first woman. Nobody is going to kill this baby. She is the real mother."
- 27 Then the king gave his ruling: "Give the living baby to the first woman. Do not kill him; she is his mother."
- 28 The word got around--everyone in Israel heard of the king's judgment. They were all in awe of the king, realizing that it was God's wisdom that enabled him to judge truly.
- 28 When all Israel heard the verdict the king had given, they held the king in awe, because they saw that he had wisdom from God to administer justice.

1 Kings 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 King Solomon was off to a good start ruling Israel.
- 1 So King Solomon ruled over all Israel.
- 2 These were the leaders in his government: Azariah son of Zadok--the priest;
- 2 And these were his chief officials: Azariah son of Zadok--the priest;
- 3 Elihoreph and Ahijah, sons of Shisha--secretaries; Jehoshaphat son of Ahilud--historian;

- 3 Elihoreph and Ahijah, sons of Shisha--secretaries; Jehoshaphat son of Ahilud--recorder;
- 4 Benaiah son of Jehoiada--commander of the army; Zadok and Abiathar--priests;
- 4 Benaiah son of Jehoiada--commander in chief; Zadok and Abiathar--priests;
- 5 Azariah son of Nathan--in charge of the regional managers; Zabud son of Nathan--priest and friend to the king;
- 5 Azariah son of Nathan--in charge of the district officers; Zabud son of Nathan--a priest and personal adviser to the king;
- 6 Ahishar--manager of the palace; Adoniram son of Abda--manager of the slave labor.
- 6 Ahishar--in charge of the palace; Adoniram son of Abda--in charge of forced labor.
- 7 Solomon had twelve regional managers distributed throughout Israel. They were responsible for supplying provisions for the king and his administration. Each was in charge of bringing supplies for one month of the year.
- 7 Solomon also had twelve district governors over all Israel, who supplied provisions for the king and the royal household. Each one had to provide supplies for one month in the year.
- 8 These are the names: Ben-Hur in the Ephraim hills;
- 8 These are their names: Ben-Hur--in the hill country of Ephraim;
- 9 Ben-Deker in Makaz, Shaalbim, Beth Shemesh, and Elon Bethhanan;
- 9 Ben-Deker--in Makaz, Shaalbim, Beth Shemesh and Elon Bethhanan;
- 10 Ben-Hesed in Arubboth--this included Socoh and all of Hepher;
- 10 Ben-Hesed--in Arubboth (Socoh and all the land of Hepher were his);
- 11 Ben-Abinadab in Naphoth Dor (he was married to Solomon's daughter Taphath);
- 11 Ben-Abinadab--in Naphoth Dor (he was married to Taphath daughter of Solomon);
- 12 Baana son of Ahilud in Taanach and Megiddo, all of Beth Shan next to Zarethan below Jezreel, and from Beth Shan to Abel Meholah over to Jokmeam;
- 12 Baana son of Ahilud--in Taanach and Megiddo, and in all of Beth Shan next to Zarethan below Jezreel, from Beth Shan to Abel Meholah across

- to Jokmeam;
- 13 Ben-Geber in Ramoth Gilead--this included the villages of Jair son of Manasseh in Gilead and the region of Argob in Bashan with its sixty large walled cities with bronze-studded gates;
- 13 Ben-Geber--in Ramoth Gilead (the settlements of Jair son of Manasseh in Gilead were his, as well as the district of Argob in Bashan and its sixty large walled cities with bronze gate bars);
- 14 Ahinadab son of Iddo in Mahanaim;
- 14 Ahinadab son of Iddo--in Mahanaim;
- 15 Ahimaaz in Naphtali (he was married to Solomon's daughter Basemath);
- 15 Ahimaaz--in Naphtali (he had married Basemath daughter of Solomon);
- 16 Baana son of Hushai in Asher and Aloth;
- 16 Baana son of Hushai--in Asher and in Aloth;
- 17 Jehoshaphat son of Paruah in Issachar;
- 17 Jehoshaphat son of Paruah--in Issachar;
- 18 Shimei son of Ela in Benjamin;
- 18 Shimei son of Ela--in Benjamin;
- 19 Geber son of Uri in Gilead--this was the country of Sihon king of the Amorites and also of Og king of Bashan; he managed the whole district by himself.
- 19 Geber son of Uri--in Gilead (the country of Sihon king of the Amorites and the country of Og king of Bashan). He was the only governor over the district.
- 20 Judah and Israel were densely populated--like sand on an ocean beach! All their needs were met; they ate and drank and were happy.
- 20 The people of Judah and Israel were as numerous as the sand on the seashore; they ate, they drank and they were happy.
- 21 Solomon was sovereign over all the kingdoms from the River Euphrates in the east to the country of the Philistines in the west, all the way to the border of Egypt. They brought tribute and were vassals of Solomon all his life.
- 21 And Solomon ruled over all the kingdoms from the River to the land of the Philistines, as far as the border of Egypt. These countries brought tribute and were Solomon's subjects all his life.
- 22 One day's food supply for Solomon's household was: 185 bushels of fine flour 375 bushels of meal 10 grain-fed cattle 20 range cattle 100

- sheep and miscellaneous deer, gazelles, roebucks, and choice fowl.
- 22 Solomon's daily provisions were thirty cors of fine flour and sixty cors of meal,
- 23 (SEE 4:22)
- 23 ten head of stall-fed cattle, twenty of pasture-fed cattle and a hundred sheep and goats, as well as deer, gazelles, roebucks and choice fowl.
- 24 Solomon was sovereign over everything, countries and kings, west of the River Euphrates from Tiphseh to Gaza. Peace reigned everywhere.
- 24 For he ruled over all the kingdoms west of the River, from Tiphseh to Gaza, and had peace on all sides.
- 25 Throughout Solomon's life, everyone in Israel and Judah lived safe and sound, all of them from Dan in the north to Beersheba in the south--content with what they had.
- 25 During Solomon's lifetime Judah and Israel, from Dan to Beersheba, lived in safety, each man under his own vine and fig tree.
- 26 Solomon had forty thousand stalls for chariot horses and twelve thousand horsemen.
- 26 Solomon had four thousand stalls for chariot horses, and twelve thousand horses.
- 27 The district managers, each according to his assigned month, delivered food supplies for King Solomon and all who sat at the king's table; there was always plenty.
- 27 The district officers, each in his month, supplied provisions for King Solomon and all who came to the king's table. They saw to it that nothing was lacking.
- 28 They also brought to the designated place their assigned quota of barley and straw for the horses.
- 28 They also brought to the proper place their quotas of barley and straw for the chariot horses and the other horses.
- 29 God gave Solomon wisdom--the deepest of understanding and the largest of hearts. There was nothing beyond him, nothing he couldn't handle.
- 29 God gave Solomon wisdom and very great insight, and a breadth of understanding as measureless as the sand on the seashore.
- 30 Solomon's wisdom outclassed the vaunted wisdom of wise men of the East, outshone the famous wisdom of Egypt.

- 30 Solomon's wisdom was greater than the wisdom of all the men of the East, and greater than all the wisdom of Egypt.
- 31 He was wiser than anyone--wiser than Ethan the Ezrahite, wiser than Heman, wiser than Calcol and Darda the sons of Mahol. He became famous among all the surrounding nations.
- 31 He was wiser than any other man, including Ethan the Ezrahite--wiser than Heman, Calcol and Darda, the sons of Mahol. And his fame spread to all the surrounding nations.
- 32 He created three thousand proverbs; his songs added up to 1,005.
- 32 He spoke three thousand proverbs and his songs numbered a thousand and five.
- 33 He knew all about plants, from the huge cedar that grows in Lebanon to the tiny hyssop that grows in the cracks of a wall. He understood everything about animals and birds, reptiles and fish.
- 33 He described plant life, from the cedar of Lebanon to the hyssop that grows out of walls. He also taught about animals and birds, reptiles and fish.
- 34 Sent by kings from all over the earth who had heard of his reputation, people came from far and near to listen to the wisdom of Solomon.
- 34 Men of all nations came to listen to Solomon's wisdom, sent by all the kings of the world, who had heard of his wisdom.

1 Kings 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 Hiram king of Tyre sent ambassadors to Solomon when he heard that he had been crowned king in David's place. Hiram had loved David his whole life.
- 1 When Hiram king of Tyre heard that Solomon had been anointed king to succeed his father David, he sent his envoys to Solomon, because he had always been on friendly terms with David.
- 2 Solomon responded, saying,
- 2 Solomon sent back this message to Hiram:
- 3 "You know that David my father was not able to build a temple in honor of GOD because of the wars he had to fight on all sides, until GOD

finally put them down.

- 3 You know that because of the wars waged against my father David from all sides, he could not build a temple for the Name of the LORD his God until the LORD put his enemies under his feet.
- 4 But now GOD has provided peace all around--no one against us, nothing at odds with us.
- 4 But now the LORD my God has given me rest on every side, and there is no adversary or disaster.
- 5 "Now here is what I want to do: Build a temple in honor of GOD, my God, following the promise that GOD gave to David my father, namely, 'Your son whom I will provide to succeed you as king, he will build a house in my honor.'
- 5 I intend, therefore, to build a temple for the Name of the LORD my God, as the LORD told my father David, when he said, 'Your son whom I will put on the throne in your place will build the temple for my Name.'
- 6 And here is how you can help: Give orders for cedars to be cut from the Lebanon forest; my loggers will work alongside yours and I'll pay your men whatever wage you set. We both know that there is no one like you Sidonians for cutting timber."
- 6 So give orders that cedars of Lebanon be cut for me. My men will work with yours, and I will pay you for your men whatever wages you set. You know that we have no one so skilled in felling timber as the Sidonians.
- 7 When Hiram got Solomon's message, he was delighted, exclaiming, "Blessed be GOD for giving David such a wise son to rule this flourishing people!"
- 7 When Hiram heard Solomon's message, he was greatly pleased and said, "Praise be to the LORD today, for he has given David a wise son to rule over this great nation."
- 8 Then he sent this message to Solomon: "I received your request for the cedars and cypresses. It's as good as done--your wish is my command.
- 8 So Hiram sent word to Solomon: "I have received the message you sent me and will do all you want in providing the cedar and pine logs.
- 9 My lumberjacks will haul the timbers from the Lebanon forest to the sea, assemble them into log rafts, float them to the place you set, then have

- them disassembled for you to haul away. All I want from you is that you feed my crew."
- 9 My men will haul them down from Lebanon to the sea, and I will float them in rafts by sea to the place you specify. There I will separate them and you can take them away. And you are to grant my wish by providing food for my royal household."
- 10 In this way Hiram supplied all the cedar and cypress timber that Solomon wanted.
- 10 In this way Hiram kept Solomon supplied with all the cedar and pine logs he wanted,
- 11 In his turn, Solomon gave Hiram 125,000 bushels of wheat and 115,000 gallons of virgin olive oil. He did this every year.
- 11 and Solomon gave Hiram twenty thousand cors of wheat as food for his household, in addition to twenty thousand baths of pressed olive oil. Solomon continued to do this for Hiram year after year.
- 12 And GOD, for his part, gave Solomon wisdom, just as he had promised. The healthy peace between Hiram and Solomon was formalized by a treaty.
- 12 The LORD gave Solomon wisdom, just as he had promised him. There were peaceful relations between Hiram and Solomon, and the two of them made a treaty.
- 13 King Solomon raised a workforce of 30,000 men from all over Israel.
- 13 King Solomon conscripted laborers from all Israel--thirty thousand men.
- 14 He sent them in shifts of 10,000 each month to the Lebanon forest; they would work a month in Lebanon and then be at home two months. Adoniram was in charge of the work crew.
- 14 He sent them off to Lebanon in shifts of ten thousand a month, so that they spent one month in Lebanon and two months at home. Adoniram was in charge of the forced labor.
- 15 Solomon also had 70,000 unskilled workers and another 80,000 stonecutters up in the hills--
- 15 Solomon had seventy thousand carriers and eighty thousand stonecutters in the hills,
- 16 plus 3,300 foremen managing the project and supervising the work crews.

- 16 as well as thirty-three hundred foremen who supervised the project and directed the workmen.
- 17 Following the king's orders, they quarried huge blocks of the best stone-dressed stone for the foundation of The Temple.
- 17 At the king's command they removed from the quarry large blocks of quality stone to provide a foundation of dressed stone for the temple.
- 18 Solomon and Hiram's construction workers, assisted by the men of Gebal, cut and prepared the timber and stone for building The Temple.
- 18 The craftsmen of Solomon and Hiram and the men of Gebal cut and prepared the timber and stone for the building of the temple.

1 Kings 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 Four hundred and eighty years after the Israelites came out of Egypt, in the fourth year of Solomon's rule over Israel, in the month of Ziv, the second month, Solomon started building The Temple of GOD.
- 1 In the four hundred and eightieth year after the Israelites had come out of Egypt, in the fourth year of Solomon's reign over Israel, in the month of Ziv, the second month, he began to build the temple of the LORD.
- 2 The Temple that King Solomon built to GOD was ninety feet long, thirty feet wide, and forty-five feet high.
- 2 The temple that King Solomon built for the LORD was sixty cubits long, twenty wide and thirty high.
- 3 There was a porch across the thirty-foot width of The Temple that extended out fifteen feet.
- 3 The portico at the front of the main hall of the temple extended the width of the temple, that is twenty cubits, and projected ten cubits from the front of the temple.
- 4 Within The Temple he made narrow, deep-silled windows.
- 4 He made narrow clerestory windows in the temple.
- 5 Against the outside walls he built a supporting structure in which there were smaller rooms:
- 5 Against the walls of the main hall and inner sanctuary he built a structure around the building, in which there were side rooms.

- 6 The lower floor was seven and a half feet wide, the middle floor nine feet, and the third floor ten and a half feet. He had projecting ledges built into the outside Temple walls to support the buttressing beams.
- 6 The lowest floor was five cubits wide, the middle floor six cubits and the third floor seven. He made offset ledges around the outside of the temple so that nothing would be inserted into the temple walls.
- 7 The stone blocks for the building of The Temple were all dressed at the quarry so that the building site itself was reverently quiet--no noise from hammers and chisels and other iron tools.
- 7 In building the temple, only blocks dressed at the quarry were used, and no hammer, chisel or any other iron tool was heard at the temple site while it was being built.
- 8 The entrance to the ground floor was at the south end of The Temple; stairs led to the second floor and then to the third.
- 8 The entrance to the lowest floor was on the south side of the temple; a stairway led up to the middle level and from there to the third.
- 9 Solomon built and completed The Temple, finishing it off with roof beams and planks of cedar.
- 9 So he built the temple and completed it, roofing it with beams and cedar planks.
- 10 The supporting structure along the outside walls was attached to The Temple with cedar beams and the rooms in it were seven and a half feet tall.
- 10 And he built the side rooms all along the temple. The height of each was five cubits, and they were attached to the temple by beams of cedar.
- 11 The word of GOD came to Solomon saying,
- 11 The word of the LORD came to Solomon:
- 12 "About this Temple you are building--what's important is that you live the way I've set out for you and do what I tell you, following my instructions carefully and obediently. Then I'll complete in you the promise I made to David your father.
- 12 As for this temple you are building, if you follow my decrees, carry out my regulations and keep all my commands and obey them, I will fulfill through you the promise I gave to David your father.
- 13 I'll personally take up my residence among the Israelites --I won't desert my people Israel."

- 13 And I will live among the Israelites and will not abandon my people Israel."
- 14 Solomon built and completed The Temple.
- 14 So Solomon built the temple and completed it.
- 15 He paneled the interior walls from floor to ceiling with cedar planks; for flooring he used cypress.
- 15 He lined its interior walls with cedar boards, paneling them from the floor of the temple to the ceiling, and covered the floor of the temple with planks of pine.
- 16 The thirty feet at the rear of The Temple he made into an Inner Sanctuary, cedar planks from floor to ceiling--the Holy of Holies.
- 16 He partitioned off twenty cubits at the rear of the temple with cedar boards from floor to ceiling to form within the temple an inner sanctuary, the Most Holy Place.
- 17 The Main Sanctuary area in front was sixty feet long.
- 17 The main hall in front of this room was forty cubits long.
- 18 The entire interior of The Temple was cedar, with carvings of fruits and flowers. All cedar--none of the stone was exposed.
- 18 The inside of the temple was cedar, carved with gourds and open flowers. Everything was cedar; no stone was to be seen.
- 19 The Inner Sanctuary within The Temple was for housing the Chest of the Covenant of God.
- 19 He prepared the inner sanctuary within the temple to set the ark of the covenant of the LORD there.
- 20 This Inner Sanctuary was a cube, thirty feet each way, all plated with gold. The Altar of cedar was also gold-plated.
- 20 The inner sanctuary was twenty cubits long, twenty wide and twenty high. He overlaid the inside with pure gold, and he also overlaid the altar of cedar.
- 21 Everywhere you looked there was pure gold: gold chains strung in front of the gold-plated Inner Sanctuary--
- 21 Solomon covered the inside of the temple with pure gold, and he extended gold chains across the front of the inner sanctuary, which was overlaid with gold.
- 22 gold everywhere--walls, ceiling, floor, and Altar. Dazzling!

- 22 So he overlaid the whole interior with gold. He also overlaid with gold the altar that belonged to the inner sanctuary.
- 23 Then he made two cherubim, gigantic angel-like figures, from olivewood. Each was fifteen feet tall.
- 23 In the inner sanctuary he made a pair of cherubim of olive wood, each ten cubits high.
- 24 The outstretched wings of the cherubim (they were identical in size and shape) measured another fifteen feet. He placed the two cherubim, their wings spread, in the Inner Sanctuary. The combined wingspread stretched the width of the room, the wing of one cherub touched one wall, the wing of the other the other wall, and the wings touched in the middle.
- 24 One wing of the first cherub was five cubits long, and the other wing five cubits--ten cubits from wing tip to wing tip.
- 25 (SEE 6:24)
- 25 The second cherub also measured ten cubits, for the two cherubim were identical in size and shape.
- 26 (SEE 6:24)
- 26 The height of each cherub was ten cubits.
- 27 (SEE 6:24)
- 27 He placed the cherubim inside the innermost room of the temple, with their wings spread out. The wing of one cherub touched one wall, while the wing of the other touched the other wall, and their wings touched each other in the middle of the room.
- 28 The cherubim were gold plated.
- 28 He overlaid the cherubim with gold.
- 29 He then carved engravings of cherubim, palm trees, and flower blossoms on all the walls of both the Inner and the Main Sanctuary.
- 29 On the walls all around the temple, in both the inner and outer rooms, he carved cherubim, palm trees and open flowers.
- 30 And all the floors of both inner and outer rooms were gold plated.
- 30 He also covered the floors of both the inner and outer rooms of the temple with gold.
- 31 He constructed doors of olivewood for the entrance to the Inner Sanctuary; the lintel and doorposts were five-sided.

- 31 For the entrance of the inner sanctuary he made doors of olive wood with five-sided jambs.
- 32 The doors were also carved with cherubim, palm trees, and flowers, and then covered with gold leaf.
- 32 And on the two olive wood doors he carved cherubim, palm trees and open flowers, and overlaid the cherubim and palm trees with beaten gold.
- 33 Similarly, he built the entrance to the Main Sanctuary using olivewood for the doorposts but these doorposts were four-sided.
- 33 In the same way he made four-sided jambs of olive wood for the entrance to the main hall.
- 34 The doors were of cypress, split into two panels, each panel swinging separately.
- 34 He also made two pine doors, each having two leaves that turned in sockets.
- 35 These also were carved with cherubim, palm trees, and flowers, and plated with finely hammered gold leaf.
- 35 He carved cherubim, palm trees and open flowers on them and overlaid them with gold hammered evenly over the carvings.
- 36 He built the inner court with three courses of dressed stones topped with a course of planed cedar timbers.
- 36 And he built the inner courtyard of three courses of dressed stone and one course of trimmed cedar beams.
- 37 The foundation for GOD's Temple was laid in the fourth year in the month of Ziv.
- 37 The foundation of the temple of the LORD was laid in the fourth year, in the month of Ziv.
- 38 It was completed in the eleventh year in the month of Bul (the eighth month) down to the last detail, just as planned. It took Solomon seven years to build it.
- 38 In the eleventh year in the month of Bul, the eighth month, the temple was finished in all its details according to its specifications. He had spent seven years building it.

1 Kings 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 It took Solomon another thirteen years to finish building his own palace complex.
- 1 It took Solomon thirteen years, however, to complete the construction of his palace.
- 2 He built the Palace of the Forest of Lebanon a hundred and fifty feet long, seventy-five feet wide, and forty-five feet high.
- 2 He built the Palace of the Forest of Lebanon a hundred cubits long, fifty wide and thirty high, with four rows of cedar columns supporting trimmed cedar beams.
- 3 There were four rows of cedar columns supporting forty-five cedar beams, fifteen in each row, and then roofed with cedar.
- 3 It was roofed with cedar above the beams that rested on the columns-- forty-five beams, fifteen to a row.
- 4 Windows in groupings of three were set high in the walls on either side.
- 4 Its windows were placed high in sets of three, facing each other.
- 5 All the doors were rectangular and arranged symmetrically.
- 5 All the doorways had rectangular frames; they were in the front part in sets of three, facing each other.
- 6 He built a colonnaded courtyard seventy-five feet long and forty-five wide. It had a roofed porch at the front with ample eaves.
- 6 He made a colonnade fifty cubits long and thirty wide. In front of it was a portico, and in front of that were pillars and an overhanging roof.
- 7 He built a court room, the Hall of Justice, where he would decide judicial matters, and paneled it with cedar.
- 7 He built the throne hall, the Hall of Justice, where he was to judge, and he covered it with cedar from floor to ceiling.
- 8 He built his personal residence behind the Hall on a similar plan. Solomon also built another one just like it for Pharaoh's daughter, whom he had married.
- 8 And the palace in which he was to live, set farther back, was similar in design. Solomon also made a palace like this hall for Pharaoh's daughter, whom he had married.
- 9 No expense was spared--everything here, inside and out, from foundation to roof was constructed using high-quality stone, accurately cut and

shaped and polished.

- 9 All these structures, from the outside to the great courtyard and from foundation to eaves, were made of blocks of high- grade stone cut to size and trimmed with a saw on their inner and outer faces.
- 10 The foundation stones were huge, ranging in size from twelve to fifteen feet, and of the very best quality.
- 10 The foundations were laid with large stones of good quality, some measuring ten cubits and some eight.
- 11 The finest stone was used above the foundation, shaped to size and trimmed with cedar.
- 11 Above were high- grade stones, cut to size, and cedar beams.
- 12 The courtyard was enclosed with a wall made of three layers of stone and topped with cedar timbers, just like the one in the porch of The Temple of GOD.
- 12 The great courtyard was surrounded by a wall of three courses of dressed stone and one course of trimmed cedar beams, as was the inner courtyard of the temple of the LORD with its portico.
- 13 King Solomon sent to Tyre and asked Hiram (not the king; another Hiram) to come.
- 13 King Solomon sent to Tyre and brought Hiram,
- 14 Hiram's mother was a widow from the tribe of Naphtali. His father was a Tyrian and a master worker in bronze. Hiram was a real artist--he could do anything with bronze. He came to King Solomon and did all the bronze work.
- 14 whose mother was a widow from the tribe of Naphtali and whose father was a man of Tyre and a craftsman in bronze. Hiram was highly skilled and experienced in all kinds of bronze work. He came to King Solomon and did all the work assigned to him.
- 15 First he cast two pillars in bronze, each twenty-seven feet tall and eighteen feet in circumference.
- 15 He cast two bronze pillars, each eighteen cubits high and twelve cubits around, by line.
- 16 He then cast two capitals in bronze to set on the pillars; each capital was seven and a half feet high
- 16 He also made two capitals of cast bronze to set on the tops of the pillars; each capital was five cubits high.

- 17 and flared at the top in the shape of a lily. Each capital was dressed with an elaborate filigree of seven braided chains and a double row of two hundred pomegranates, setting the pillars off magnificently.
- 17 A network of interwoven chains festooned the capitals on top of the pillars, seven for each capital.
- 18 (SEE 7:17)
- 18 He made pomegranates in two rows encircling each network to decorate the capitals on top of the pillars. He did the same for each capital.
- 19 (SEE 7:17)
- 19 The capitals on top of the pillars in the portico were in the shape of lilies, four cubits high.
- 20 (SEE 7:17)
- 20 On the capitals of both pillars, above the bowl-shaped part next to the network, were the two hundred pomegranates in rows all around.
- 21 He set the pillars up in the entrance porch to The Temple; the pillar to the south he named Security (Jachin) and the pillar to the north Stability (Boaz).
- 21 He erected the pillars at the portico of the temple. The pillar to the south he named Jakin and the one to the north Boaz.
- 22 The capitals were in the shape of lilies. When the pillars were finished,
- 22 The capitals on top were in the shape of lilies. And so the work on the pillars was completed.
- 23 Hiram's next project was to make the Sea--an immense round basin of cast metal fifteen feet in diameter, seven and a half feet tall, and forty-five feet in circumference.
- 23 He made the Sea of cast metal, circular in shape, measuring ten cubits from rim to rim and five cubits high. It took a line of thirty cubits to measure around it.
- 24 Just under the rim there were two bands of decorative gourds, ten gourds to each foot and a half. The gourds were cast in one piece with the Sea.
- 24 Below the rim, gourds encircled it--ten to a cubit. The gourds were cast in two rows in one piece with the Sea.
- 25 The Sea was set on twelve bulls, three facing north, three facing west, three facing south, and three facing east; the bulls faced outward supporting the Sea on their hindquarters.

- 25 The Sea stood on twelve bulls, three facing north, three facing west, three facing south and three facing east. The Sea rested on top of them, and their hindquarters were toward the center.
- 26 The Sea was three inches thick and flared at the rim like a cup, or like a lily. It held about 11,500 gallons.
- 26 It was a handbreadth in thickness, and its rim was like the rim of a cup, like a lily blossom. It held two thousand baths.
- 27 Hiram also made ten washstands of bronze. Each was six feet square and four and a half feet tall.
- 27 He also made ten movable stands of bronze; each was four cubits long, four wide and three high.
- 28 They were made like this: Panels were fastened to the uprights.
- 28 This is how the stands were made: They had side panels attached to uprights.
- 29 Lions, bulls, and cherubim were represented on the panels and uprights. Beveled wreath-work bordered the lions and bulls above and below.
- 29 On the panels between the uprights were lions, bulls and cherubim--and on the uprights as well. Above and below the lions and bulls were wreaths of hammered work.
- 30 Each stand was mounted on four bronze wheels with bronze axles. The uprights were cast with decorative relief work.
- 30 Each stand had four bronze wheels with bronze axles, and each had a basin resting on four supports, cast with wreaths on each side.
- 31 Each stand held a basin on a circular engraved support a foot and a half deep set on a pedestal two and a quarter feet square. The washstand itself was square.
- 31 On the inside of the stand there was an opening that had a circular frame one cubit deep. This opening was round, and with its basework it measured a cubit and a half. Around its opening there was engraving. The panels of the stands were square, not round.
- 32 The axles were attached under the stand and the wheels fixed to them. The wheels were twenty-seven inches in diameter;
- 32 The four wheels were under the panels, and the axles of the wheels were attached to the stand. The diameter of each wheel was a cubit and a half.
- 33 they were designed like chariot wheels. Everything--axles, rims, spokes, and hubs--was of cast metal.

- 33 The wheels were made like chariot wheels; the axles, rims, spokes and hubs were all of cast metal.
- 34 There was a handle at the four corners of each washstand, the handles cast in one piece with the stand.
- 34 Each stand had four handles, one on each corner, projecting from the stand.
- 35 At the top of the washstand there was a ring about nine inches deep. The uprights and handles were cast with the stand.
- 35 At the top of the stand there was a circular band half a cubit deep. The supports and panels were attached to the top of the stand.
- 36 Everything and every available surface was engraved with cherubim, lions, and palm trees, bordered by arabesques.
- 36 He engraved cherubim, lions and palm trees on the surfaces of the supports and on the panels, in every available space, with wreaths all around.
- 37 The washstands were identical, all cast in the same mold.
- 37 This is the way he made the ten stands. They were all cast in the same molds and were identical in size and shape.
- 38 He also made ten bronze washbasins, each six feet in diameter with a capacity of 230 gallons, one basin for each of the ten washstands.
- 38 He then made ten bronze basins, each holding forty baths and measuring four cubits across, one basin to go on each of the ten stands.
- 39 He arranged five stands on the south side of The Temple and five on the north. The Sea was placed at the southeast corner of The Temple.
- 39 He placed five of the stands on the south side of the temple and five on the north. He placed the Sea on the south side, at the southeast corner of the temple.
- 40 Hiram then fashioned the various utensils: buckets and shovels and bowls. Hiram completed all the work he set out to do for King Solomon on The Temple of GOD:
- 40 He also made the basins and shovels and sprinkling bowls. So Hiram finished all the work he had undertaken for King Solomon in the temple of the LORD:
- 41 two pillars; two capitals on top of the pillars; two decorative filigrees for the capitals;

- 41 the two pillars; the two bowl-shaped capitals on top of the pillars; the two sets of network decorating the two bowl-shaped capitals on top of the pillars;
- 42 four hundred pomegranates for the two filigrees (a double row of pomegranates for each filigree);
- 42 the four hundred pomegranates for the two sets of network (two rows of pomegranates for each network, decorating the bowl- shaped capitals on top of the pillars);
- 43 ten washstands each with its washbasin; one Sea;
- 43 the ten stands with their ten basins;
- 44 twelve bulls under the Sea;
- 44 the Sea and the twelve bulls under it;
- 45 miscellaneous buckets, shovels, and bowls. All these artifacts that Hiram made for King Solomon for The Temple of GOD were of burnished bronze.
- 45 the pots, shovels and sprinkling bowls. All these objects that Hiram made for King Solomon for the temple of the LORD were of burnished bronze.
- 46 He cast them in clay in a foundry on the Jordan plain between Succoth and Zarethan.
- 46 The king had them cast in clay molds in the plain of the Jordan between Succoth and Zarethan.
- 47 These artifacts were never weighed--there were far too many! Nobody has any idea how much bronze was used.
- 47 Solomon left all these things unweighed, because there were so many; the weight of the bronze was not determined.
- 48 Solomon was also responsible for all the furniture and accessories in The Temple of GOD: the gold Altar; the gold Table that held the Bread of the Presence;
- 48 Solomon also made all the furnishings that were in the LORD's temple: the golden altar; the golden table on which was the bread of the Presence;
- 49 the pure gold candelabras, five to the right and five to the left in front of the Inner Sanctuary; the gold flowers, lamps, and tongs;
- 49 the lampstands of pure gold (five on the right and five on the left, in front of the inner sanctuary); the gold floral work and lamps and tongs;

- 50 the pure gold dishes, wick trimmers, sprinkling bowls, ladles, and censers; the gold sockets for the doors of the Inner Sanctuary, the Holy of Holies, used also for the doors of the Main Sanctuary.
- 50 the pure gold basins, wick trimmers, sprinkling bowls, dishes and censers; and the gold sockets for the doors of the innermost room, the Most Holy Place, and also for the doors of the main hall of the temple.
- 51 That completed all the work King Solomon did on The Temple of GOD. He then brought in the items consecrated by his father David, the silver and the gold and the artifacts. He placed them all in the treasury of GOD's Temple.
- 51 When all the work King Solomon had done for the temple of the LORD was finished, he brought in the things his father David had dedicated--the silver and gold and the furnishings--and he placed them in the treasuries of the LORD's temple.

1 Kings 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 Bringing all this to a climax, King Solomon called in the leaders of Israel, all the heads of the tribes and the family patriarchs, to bring up the Chest of the Covenant of GOD from Zion, the City of David.
- 1 Then King Solomon summoned into his presence at Jerusalem the elders of Israel, all the heads of the tribes and the chiefs of the Israelite families, to bring up the ark of the LORD's covenant from Zion, the City of David.
- 2 And they came, all Israel before King Solomon in the month of Ethanim, the seventh month, for the great autumn festival.
- 2 All the men of Israel came together to King Solomon at the time of the festival in the month of Ethanim, the seventh month.
- 3 With all Israel's leaders present, the priests took up the Chest of GOD
- 3 When all the elders of Israel had arrived, the priests took up the ark,
- 4 and carried up the Chest and the Tent of Meeting and all the holy vessels that went with the Tent.
- 4 and they brought up the ark of the LORD and the Tent of Meeting and all the sacred furnishings in it. The priests and Levites carried them up,

- 5 King Solomon and the entire congregation of Israel were there at the Chest worshiping and sacrificing huge numbers of sheep and cattle--so many that no one could keep track.
- 5 and King Solomon and the entire assembly of Israel that had gathered about him were before the ark, sacrificing so many sheep and cattle that they could not be recorded or counted.
- 6 Then the priests brought the Chest of the Covenant of GOD to its place in the Inner Sanctuary, the Holy of Holies, under the wings of the cherubim.
- 6 The priests then brought the ark of the LORD's covenant to its place in the inner sanctuary of the temple, the Most Holy Place, and put it beneath the wings of the cherubim.
- 7 The outspread wings of the cherubim stretched over the Chest and its poles.
- 7 The cherubim spread their wings over the place of the ark and overshadowed the ark and its carrying poles.
- 8 The poles were so long that their ends could be seen from the entrance to the Inner Sanctuary, but were not noticeable farther out. They're still there today.
- 8 These poles were so long that their ends could be seen from the Holy Place in front of the inner sanctuary, but not from outside the Holy Place; and they are still there today.
- 9 There was nothing in the Chest but the two stone tablets that Moses had placed in it at Horeb where GOD made a covenant with Israel after bringing them up from Egypt.
- 9 There was nothing in the ark except the two stone tablets that Moses had placed in it at Horeb, where the LORD made a covenant with the Israelites after they came out of Egypt.
- 10 When the priests left the Holy Place, a cloud filled The Temple of GOD.
- 10 When the priests withdrew from the Holy Place, the cloud filled the temple of the LORD.
- 11 The priests couldn't carry out their priestly duties because of the cloud--the glory of GOD filled The Temple of GOD!
- 11 And the priests could not perform their service because of the cloud, for the glory of the LORD filled his temple.

12 Then Solomon spoke: GOD has told us that he lives in the dark where no one can see him;

12 Then Solomon said, "The LORD has said that he would dwell in a dark cloud;

13 I've built this splendid Temple, O God, to mark your invisible presence forever.

13 I have indeed built a magnificent temple for you, a place for you to dwell forever."

14 The king then turned to face the congregation and blessed them:

14 While the whole assembly of Israel was standing there, the king turned around and blessed them.

15 "Blessed be GOD, the God of Israel, who spoke personally to my father David. Now he has kept the promise he made when he said,

15 Then he said: "Praise be to the LORD, the God of Israel, who with his own hand has fulfilled what he promised with his own mouth to my father David. For he said,

16 'From the day I brought my people Israel from Egypt, I haven't set apart one city among the tribes of Israel to build a Temple to fix my Name there. But I did choose David to rule my people Israel.'

16 'Since the day I brought my people Israel out of Egypt, I have not chosen a city in any tribe of Israel to have a temple built for my Name to be there, but I have chosen David to rule my people Israel.'

17 "My father David had it in his heart to build a Temple honoring the Name of GOD, the God of Israel.

17 My father David had it in his heart to build a temple for the Name of the LORD, the God of Israel.

18 But GOD told him 'It was good that you wanted to build a Temple in my honor--most commendable!

18 But the LORD said to my father David, 'Because it was in your heart to build a temple for my Name, you did well to have this in your heart.

19 But you are not the one to do it--your son will build it to honor my Name.'

19 Nevertheless, you are not the one to build the temple, but your son, who is your own flesh and blood--he is the one who will build the temple for my Name.'

- 20 "GOD has done what he said he would do: I have succeeded David my father and ruled over Israel just as GOD promised; and now I've built a Temple to honor GOD, the God of Israel,
- 20 The LORD has kept the promise he made: I have succeeded David my father and now I sit on the throne of Israel, just as the LORD promised, and I have built the temple for the Name of the LORD, the God of Israel.
- 21 and I've secured a place for the Chest that holds the covenant of GOD, the covenant that he made with our ancestors when he brought them up from the land of Egypt."
- 21 I have provided a place there for the ark, in which is the covenant of the LORD that he made with our fathers when he brought them out of Egypt."
- 22 Before the entire congregation of Israel, Solomon took a position before the Altar, spread his hands out before heaven,
- 22 Then Solomon stood before the altar of the LORD in front of the whole assembly of Israel, spread out his hands toward heaven
- 23 and prayed, O GOD, God of Israel, there is no God like you in the skies above or on the earth below who unswervingly keeps covenant with his servants and relentlessly loves them as they sincerely live in obedience to your way.
- 23 and said: "O LORD, God of Israel, there is no God like you in heaven above or on earth below--you who keep your covenant of love with your servants who continue wholeheartedly in your way.
- 24 You kept your word to David my father, your personal word. You did exactly what you promised--every detail. The proof is before us today!
- 24 You have kept your promise to your servant David my father; with your mouth you have promised and with your hand you have fulfilled it--as it is today.
- 25 Keep it up, GOD, O God of Israel! Continue to keep the promises you made to David my father when you said, "You'll always have a descendant to represent my rule on Israel's throne, on the condition that your sons are as careful to live obediently in my presence as you have."
- 25 Now LORD, God of Israel, keep for your servant David my father the promises you made to him when you said, 'You shall never fail to have a man to sit before me on the throne of Israel, if only your sons are careful in all they do to walk before me as you have done.'

- 26 O God of Israel, let this all happen; confirm and establish it!
- 26 And now, O God of Israel, let your word that you promised your servant David my father come true.
- 27 Can it be that God will actually move into our neighborhood? Why, the cosmos itself isn't large enough to give you breathing room, let alone this Temple I've built.
- 27 But will God really dwell on earth? The heavens, even the highest heaven, cannot contain you. How much less this temple I have built!
- 28 Even so, I'm bold to ask: Pay attention to these my prayers, both intercessory and personal, O GOD, my God. Listen to my prayers, energetic and devout, that I'm setting before you right now.
- 28 Yet give attention to your servant's prayer and his plea for mercy, O LORD my God. Hear the cry and the prayer that your servant is praying in your presence this day.
- 29 Keep your eyes open to this Temple night and day, this place of which you said, "My Name will be honored there,"
- 29 May your eyes be open toward this temple night and day, this place of which you said, 'My Name shall be there,' so that you will hear the prayer your servant prays toward this place.
- 30 and listen to the prayers that I pray at this place. Listen from your home in heaven and when you hear, forgive.
- 30 Hear the supplication of your servant and of your people Israel when they pray toward this place. Hear from heaven, your dwelling place, and when you hear, forgive.
- 31 When someone hurts a neighbor and promises to make things right, and then comes and repeats the promise before your Altar in this Temple,
- 31 When a man wrongs his neighbor and is required to take an oath and he comes and swears the oath before your altar in this temple,
- 32 listen from heaven and act accordingly: Judge your servants, making the offender pay for his offense and setting the offended free of any charges.
- 32 then hear from heaven and act. Judge between your servants, condemning the guilty and bringing down on his own head what he has done. Declare the innocent not guilty, and so establish his innocence.
- 33 When your people Israel are beaten by an enemy because they've sinned against you, but then turn to you and acknowledge your rule in prayers desperate and devout in this Temple,

- 33 When your people Israel have been defeated by an enemy because they have sinned against you, and when they turn back to you and confess your name, praying and making supplication to you in this temple,
- 34 Listen from your home in heaven, forgive the sin of your people Israel, return them to the land you gave their ancestors.
- 34 then hear from heaven and forgive the sin of your people Israel and bring them back to the land you gave to their fathers.
- 35 When the skies shrivel up and there is no rain because your people have sinned against you, but then they pray at this place, acknowledging your rule and quitting their sins because you have scourged them,
- 35 When the heavens are shut up and there is no rain because your people have sinned against you, and when they pray toward this place and confess your name and turn from their sin because you have afflicted them,
- 36 Listen from your home in heaven, forgive the sins of your servants, your people Israel. Then start over with them: Train them to live right and well; send rain on the land you gave your people as an inheritance.
- 36 then hear from heaven and forgive the sin of your servants, your people Israel. Teach them the right way to live, and send rain on the land you gave your people for an inheritance.
- 37 When disasters strike, famine or catastrophe, crop failure or disease, locust or beetle, or when an enemy attacks their defenses--calamity of any sort--
- 37 When famine or plague comes to the land, or blight or mildew, locusts or grasshoppers, or when an enemy besieges them in any of their cities, whatever disaster or disease may come,
- 38 any prayer that's prayed from anyone at all among your people Israel, hearts penetrated by the disaster, hands and arms thrown out to this Temple for help,
- 38 and when a prayer or plea is made by any of your people Israel--each one aware of the afflictions of his own heart, and spreading out his hands toward this temple--
- 39 Listen from your home in heaven. Forgive and go to work on us. Give what each deserves, for you know each life from the inside (you're the only one with such "inside knowledge"!)

39 then hear from heaven, your dwelling place. Forgive and act; deal with each man according to all he does, since you know his heart (for you alone know the hearts of all men),

40 so that they'll live before you in lifelong reverent and believing obedience on this land you gave our ancestors.

40 so that they will fear you all the time they live in the land you gave our fathers.

41 And don't forget the foreigner who is not a member of your people Israel but has come from a far country because of your reputation.

41 As for the foreigner who does not belong to your people Israel but has come from a distant land because of your name--

42 People are going to be attracted here by your great reputation, your wonder-working power, who come to pray at this Temple.

42 for men will hear of your great name and your mighty hand and your outstretched arm--when he comes and prays toward this temple,

43 Listen from your home in heaven. Honor the prayers of the foreigner so that people all over the world will know who you are and what you're like and will live in reverent obedience before you, just as your own people Israel do; so they'll know that you personally make this Temple that I've built what it is.

43 then hear from heaven, your dwelling place, and do whatever the foreigner asks of you, so that all the peoples of the earth may know your name and fear you, as do your own people Israel, and may know that this house I have built bears your Name.

44 When your people go to war against their enemies at the time and place you send them and they pray to GOD toward the city you chose and this Temple I've built to honor your Name,

44 When your people go to war against their enemies, wherever you send them, and when they pray to the LORD toward the city you have chosen and the temple I have built for your Name,

45 Listen from heaven to what they pray and ask for, and do what's right for them.

45 then hear from heaven their prayer and their plea, and uphold their cause.

46 When they sin against you--and they certainly will; there's no one without sin!--and in anger you turn them over to the enemy and they are

taken captive to the enemy's land, whether far or near,
46 When they sin against you--for there is no one who does not sin--and you become angry with them and give them over to the enemy, who takes them captive to his own land, far away or near;
47 but repent in the country of their captivity and pray with changed hearts in their exile, "We've sinned; we've done wrong; we've been most wicked,"
47 and if they have a change of heart in the land where they are held captive, and repent and plead with you in the land of their conquerors and say, 'We have sinned, we have done wrong, we have acted wickedly';
48 and turn back to you heart and soul in the land of the enemy who conquered them, and pray to you toward their homeland, the land you gave their ancestors, toward the city you chose, and this Temple I have built to the honor of your Name,
48 and if they turn back to you with all their heart and soul in the land of their enemies who took them captive, and pray to you toward the land you gave their fathers, toward the city you have chosen and the temple I have built for your Name;
49 Listen from your home in heaven to their prayers desperate and devout and do what is best for them.
49 then from heaven, your dwelling place, hear their prayer and their plea, and uphold their cause.
50 Forgive your people who have sinned against you; forgive their gross rebellions and move their captors to treat them with compassion.
50 And forgive your people, who have sinned against you; forgive all the offenses they have committed against you, and cause their conquerors to show them mercy;
51 They are, after all, your people and your precious inheritance whom you rescued from the heart of that iron-smelting furnace, Egypt!
51 for they are your people and your inheritance, whom you brought out of Egypt, out of that iron- smelting furnace.
52 O be alert and attentive to the needy prayers of me, your servant, and your dear people Israel; listen every time they cry out to you!
52 May your eyes be open to your servant's plea and to the plea of your people Israel, and may you listen to them whenever they cry out to you.

- 53 You handpicked them from all the peoples on earth to be your very own people, as you announced through your servant Moses when you, O GOD, in your masterful rule, delivered our ancestors from Egypt.
- 53 For you singled them out from all the nations of the world to be your own inheritance, just as you declared through your servant Moses when you, O Sovereign LORD, brought our fathers out of Egypt."
- 54 Having finished praying to GOD--all these bold and passionate prayers--Solomon stood up before GOD's Altar where he had been kneeling all this time, his arms stretched upward to heaven.
- 54 When Solomon had finished all these prayers and supplications to the LORD, he rose from before the altar of the LORD, where he had been kneeling with his hands spread out toward heaven.
- 55 Standing, he blessed the whole congregation of Israel, blessing them at the top of his lungs:
- 55 He stood and blessed the whole assembly of Israel in a loud voice, saying:
- 56 "Blessed be GOD, who has given peace to his people Israel just as he said he'd do. Not one of all those good and wonderful words that he spoke through Moses has misfired.
- 56 Praise be to the LORD, who has given rest to his people Israel just as he promised. Not one word has failed of all the good promises he gave through his servant Moses.
- 57 May GOD, our very own God, continue to be with us just as he was with our ancestors--may he never give up and walk out on us.
- 57 May the LORD our God be with us as he was with our fathers; may he never leave us nor forsake us.
- 58 May he keep us centered and devoted to him, following the life path he has cleared, watching the signposts, walking at the pace and rhythms he laid down for our ancestors.
- 58 May he turn our hearts to him, to walk in all his ways and to keep the commands, decrees and regulations he gave our fathers.
- 59 "And let these words that I've prayed in the presence of GOD be always right there before him, day and night, so that he'll do what is right for me, to guarantee justice for his people Israel day after day after day.
- 59 And may these words of mine, which I have prayed before the LORD, be near to the LORD our God day and night, that he may uphold the

- cause of his servant and the cause of his people Israel according to each day's need,
- 60 Then all the people on earth will know GOD is the true God; there is no other God.
- 60 so that all the peoples of the earth may know that the LORD is God and that there is no other.
- 61 And you, your lives must be totally obedient to GOD, our personal God, following the life path he has cleared, alert and attentive to everything he has made plain this day."
- 61 But your hearts must be fully committed to the LORD our God, to live by his decrees and obey his commands, as at this time."
- 62 The king and all Israel with him then worshiped, offering sacrifices to GOD.
- 62 Then the king and all Israel with him offered sacrifices before the LORD.
- 63 Solomon offered Peace-Offerings, sacrificing to GOD twenty-two thousand cattle, a hundred and twenty thousand sheep. This is how the king and all Israel dedicated The Temple of GOD.
- 63 Solomon offered a sacrifice of fellowship offerings to the LORD: twenty-two thousand cattle and a hundred and twenty thousand sheep and goats. So the king and all the Israelites dedicated the temple of the LORD.
- 64 That same day, the king set apart the central area of the Courtyard in front of GOD's Temple for sacred use and there sacrificed the Whole-Burnt-Offerings, Grain-Offerings, and fat from the Peace-Offerings--the bronze Altar was too small to handle all these offerings.
- 64 On that same day the king consecrated the middle part of the courtyard in front of the temple of the LORD, and there he offered burnt offerings, grain offerings and the fat of the fellowship offerings, because the bronze altar before the LORD was too small to hold the burnt offerings, the grain offerings and the fat of the fellowship offerings.
- 65 This is how Solomon kept the great autumn feast, and all Israel with him, people there all the way from the far northeast (the Entrance to Hamath) to the far southwest (the Brook of Egypt)--a huge congregation. They started out celebrating for seven days--and then did it another seven days! Two solid weeks of celebration!

65 So Solomon observed the festival at that time, and all Israel with him--a vast assembly, people from Lebo Hamath to the Wadi of Egypt. They celebrated it before the LORD our God for seven days and seven days more, fourteen days in all.

66 Then he dismissed them. They blessed the king and went home, exuberant with heartfelt gratitude for all the good GOD had done for his servant David and for his people Israel.

66 On the following day he sent the people away. They blessed the king and then went home, joyful and glad in heart for all the good things the LORD had done for his servant David and his people Israel.

1 Kings 9

MSG

NIV

1 After Solomon had completed building The Temple of GOD and his own palace, all the projects he had set his heart on doing,

1 When Solomon had finished building the temple of the LORD and the royal palace, and had achieved all he had desired to do,

2 GOD appeared to Solomon again, just as he had appeared to him at Gibeon.

2 the LORD appeared to him a second time, as he had appeared to him at Gibeon.

3 And GOD said to him, "I've listened to and received all your prayers, your ever-so-passionate prayers. I've sanctified this Temple that you have built: My Name is stamped on it forever; my eyes are on it and my heart in it always.

3 The LORD said to him: "I have heard the prayer and plea you have made before me; I have consecrated this temple, which you have built, by putting my Name there forever. My eyes and my heart will always be there.

4 As for you, if you live in my presence as your father David lived, pure in heart and action, living the life I've set out for you, attentively obedient to my guidance and judgments,

4 As for you, if you walk before me in integrity of heart and uprightness, as David your father did, and do all I command and observe my decrees

- and laws,
- 5 then I'll back your kingly rule over Israel, make it a sure thing on a solid foundation. The same guarantee I gave David your father I'm giving you: 'You can count on always having a descendant on Israel's throne.'
- 5 I will establish your royal throne over Israel forever, as I promised David your father when I said, 'You shall never fail to have a man on the throne of Israel.'
- 6 "But if you or your sons betray me, ignoring my guidance and judgments, taking up with alien gods by serving and worshiping them,
- 6 But if you or your sons turn away from me and do not observe the commands and decrees I have given you and go off to serve other gods and worship them,
- 7 then the guarantee is off: I'll wipe Israel right off the map and repudiate this Temple I've just sanctified to honor my Name. And Israel will become nothing but a bad joke among the peoples of the world.
- 7 then I will cut off Israel from the land I have given them and will reject this temple I have consecrated for my Name. Israel will then become a byword and an object of ridicule among all peoples.
- 8 And this Temple, splendid as it now is, will become an object of contempt; visitors will shake their heads, saying, 'Whatever happened here? What's the story behind these ruins?'
- 8 And though this temple is now imposing, all who pass by will be appalled and will scoff and say, 'Why has the LORD done such a thing to this land and to this temple?'
- 9 Then they'll be told, 'The people who used to live here betrayed their GOD, the very God who rescued their ancestors from Egypt; they took up with alien gods, worshiping and serving them. That's what's behind this GOD-visited devastation.'"
- 9 People will answer, 'Because they have forsaken the LORD their God, who brought their fathers out of Egypt, and have embraced other gods, worshiping and serving them--that is why the LORD brought all this disaster on them.' "
- 10 At the end of twenty years, having built the two buildings, The Temple of GOD and his personal palace,
- 10 At the end of twenty years, during which Solomon built these two buildings--the temple of the LORD and the royal palace--

- 11 Solomon rewarded Hiram king of Tyre with a gift of twenty villages in the district of Galilee. Hiram had provided him with all the cedar and cypress and gold that he had wanted.
- 11 King Solomon gave twenty towns in Galilee to Hiram king of Tyre, because Hiram had supplied him with all the cedar and pine and gold he wanted.
- 12 But when Hiram left Tyre to look over the villages that Solomon had given him, he didn't like what he saw.
- 12 But when Hiram went from Tyre to see the towns that Solomon had given him, he was not pleased with them.
- 13 He said, "What kind of reward is this, my friend? Twenty backwoods hick towns!" People still refer to them that way.
- 13 What kind of towns are these you have given me, my brother? he asked. And he called them the Land of Cabul, a name they have to this day.
- 14 This is all Hiram got from Solomon in exchange for four and a half tons of gold!
- 14 Now Hiram had sent to the king 120 talents of gold.
- 15 This is the work record of the labor force that King Solomon raised to build The Temple of GOD, his palace, the defense complex (the Millo), the Jerusalem wall, and the fortified cities of Hazor, Megiddo, and Gezer.
- 15 Here is the account of the forced labor King Solomon conscripted to build the LORD's temple, his own palace, the supporting terraces, the wall of Jerusalem, and Hazor, Megiddo and Gezer.
- 16 Pharaoh king of Egypt had come up and captured Gezer, torched it, and killed all the Canaanites who lived there. He gave it as a wedding present to his daughter, Solomon's wife.
- 16 (Pharaoh king of Egypt had attacked and captured Gezer. He had set it on fire. He killed its Canaanite inhabitants and then gave it as a wedding gift to his daughter, Solomon's wife.
- 17 So Solomon rebuilt Gezer. He also built Lower Beth Horon,
- 17 And Solomon rebuilt Gezer.) He built up Lower Beth Horon,
- 18 Baalath, and Tamar in the desert, back-country
- 18 Baalath, and Tadmor in the desert, within his land,
- 19 storehouse villages, and villages for chariots and horses. Solomon built widely and extravagantly in Jerusalem, in Lebanon, and wherever he

fancied.

19 as well as all his store cities and the towns for his chariots and for his horses--whatever he desired to build in Jerusalem, in Lebanon and throughout all the territory he ruled.

20 The remnants from the original inhabitants of the land (Amorites, Hittites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites--all non-Israelites),

20 All the people left from the Amorites, Hittites, Perizzites, Hivites and Jebusites (these peoples were not Israelites),

21 survivors of the holy wars, were rounded up by Solomon for his gangs of slave labor, a policy still in effect.

21 that is, their descendants remaining in the land, whom the Israelites could not exterminate--these Solomon conscripted for his slave labor force, as it is to this day.

22 But true Israelites were not treated this way; they were used in his army and administration--government leaders and commanders of his chariots and charioteers.

22 But Solomon did not make slaves of any of the Israelites; they were his fighting men, his government officials, his officers, his captains, and the commanders of his chariots and charioteers.

23 They were also the project managers responsible for Solomon's building operations--550 of them in charge of the workforce.

23 They were also the chief officials in charge of Solomon's projects--550 officials supervising the men who did the work.

24 It was after Pharaoh's daughter ceremonially ascended from the City of David and took up residence in the house built especially for her that Solomon built the defense complex (the Millo).

24 After Pharaoh's daughter had come up from the City of David to the palace Solomon had built for her, he constructed the supporting terraces.

25 Three times a year Solomon worshiped at the Altar of GOD, sacrificing Whole-Burnt-Offerings and Peace-Offerings, and burning incense in the presence of GOD. Everything that had to do with The Temple he did generously and well; he didn't skimp.

25 Three times a year Solomon sacrificed burnt offerings and fellowship offerings on the altar he had built for the LORD, burning incense before the LORD along with them, and so fulfilled the temple obligations.

- 26 And ships! King Solomon also built ships at Ezion Geber, located near Elath in Edom on the Red Sea.
- 26 King Solomon also built ships at Ezion Geber, which is near Elath in Edom, on the shore of the Red Sea.
- 27 Hiram sent seaworthy sailors to assist Solomon's men with the fleet.
- 27 And Hiram sent his men--sailors who knew the sea--to serve in the fleet with Solomon's men.
- 28 They embarked for Ophir, brought back sixteen tons of gold, and presented it to King Solomon.
- 28 They sailed to Ophir and brought back 420 talents of gold, which they delivered to King Solomon.

1 Kings 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 The queen of Sheba heard about Solomon and his connection with the Name of GOD. She came to put his reputation to the test by asking tough questions.
- 1 When the queen of Sheba heard about the fame of Solomon and his relation to the name of the LORD, she came to test him with hard questions.
- 2 She made a grand and showy entrance into Jerusalem--camels loaded with spices, a huge amount of gold, and precious gems. She came to Solomon and talked about all the things that she cared about, emptying her heart to him.
- 2 Arriving at Jerusalem with a very great caravan--with camels carrying spices, large quantities of gold, and precious stones--she came to Solomon and talked with him about all that she had on her mind.
- 3 Solomon answered everything she put to him--nothing stumped him.
- 3 Solomon answered all her questions; nothing was too hard for the king to explain to her.
- 4 When the queen of Sheba experienced for herself Solomon's wisdom and saw with her own eyes the palace he had built,
- 4 When the queen of Sheba saw all the wisdom of Solomon and the palace he had built,

5 the meals that were served, the impressive array of court officials and sharply dressed waiters, the lavish crystal, and the elaborate worship extravagant with Whole-Burnt-Offerings at the steps leading up to The Temple of GOD, it took her breath away.

5 the food on his table, the seating of his officials, the attending servants in their robes, his cupbearers, and the burnt offerings he made at the temple of the LORD, she was overwhelmed.

6 She said to the king, "It's all true! Your reputation for accomplishment and wisdom that reached all the way to my country is confirmed.

6 She said to the king, "The report I heard in my own country about your achievements and your wisdom is true.

7 I wouldn't have believed it if I hadn't seen it for myself; they didn't exaggerate! Such wisdom and elegance--far more than I could ever have imagined.

7 But I did not believe these things until I came and saw with my own eyes. Indeed, not even half was told me; in wisdom and wealth you have far exceeded the report I heard.

8 Lucky the men and women who work for you, getting to be around you every day and hear your wise words firsthand!

8 How happy your men must be! How happy your officials, who continually stand before you and hear your wisdom!

9 And blessed be GOD, your God, who took such a liking to you and made you king. Clearly, GOD's love for Israel is behind this, making you king to keep a just order and nurture a God-pleasing people."

9 Praise be to the LORD your God, who has delighted in you and placed you on the throne of Israel. Because of the LORD's eternal love for Israel, he has made you king, to maintain justice and righteousness."

10 She then gave the king four and a half tons of gold, and also sack after sack of spices and expensive gems. There hasn't been a cargo of spices like that since that shipload the queen of Sheba brought to King Solomon.

10 And she gave the king 120 talents of gold, large quantities of spices, and precious stones. Never again were so many spices brought in as those the queen of Sheba gave to King Solomon.

- 11 The ships of Hiram also imported gold from Ophir along with tremendous loads of fragrant sandalwood and expensive gems.
- 11 (Hiram's ships brought gold from Ophir; and from there they brought great cargoes of almugwood and precious stones.
- 12 The king used the sandalwood for fine cabinetry in The Temple of GOD and the palace complex, and for making harps and dulcimers for the musicians. Nothing like that shipment of sandalwood has been seen since.
- 12 The king used the almugwood to make supports for the temple of the LORD and for the royal palace, and to make harps and lyres for the musicians. So much almugwood has never been imported or seen since that day.)
- 13 King Solomon for his part gave the queen of Sheba all her heart's desire--everything she asked for, on top of what he had already so generously given her. Satisfied, she returned home with her train of servants.
- 13 King Solomon gave the queen of Sheba all she desired and asked for, besides what he had given her out of his royal bounty. Then she left and returned with her retinue to her own country.
- 14 Solomon received twenty-five tons of gold in tribute annually.
- 14 The weight of the gold that Solomon received yearly was 666 talents,
- 15 This was above and beyond the taxes and profit on trade with merchants and assorted kings and governors.
- 15 not including the revenues from merchants and traders and from all the Arabian kings and the governors of the land.
- 16 King Solomon crafted two hundred body-length shields of hammered gold--seven and a half pounds of gold to each shield--
- 16 King Solomon made two hundred large shields of hammered gold; six hundred bekas of gold went into each shield.
- 17 and three hundred smaller shields about half that size. He stored the shields in the House of the Forest of Lebanon.
- 17 He also made three hundred small shields of hammered gold, with three minas of gold in each shield. The king put them in the Palace of the Forest of Lebanon.
- 18 The king built a massive throne of ivory accented with a veneer of gold.

- 18 Then the king made a great throne inlaid with ivory and overlaid with fine gold.
- 19 The throne had six steps leading up to it, its back shaped like an arch. The armrests on each side were flanked by lions.
- 19 The throne had six steps, and its back had a rounded top. On both sides of the seat were armrests, with a lion standing beside each of them.
- 20 Lions, twelve of them, were placed at either end of the six steps. There was no throne like it in any of the surrounding kingdoms.
- 20 Twelve lions stood on the six steps, one at either end of each step. Nothing like it had ever been made for any other kingdom.
- 21 King Solomon's chalices and tankards were made of gold and all the dinnerware and serving utensils in the House of the Forest of Lebanon were pure gold--nothing was made of silver; silver was considered common and cheap.
- 21 All King Solomon's goblets were gold, and all the household articles in the Palace of the Forest of Lebanon were pure gold. Nothing was made of silver, because silver was considered of little value in Solomon's days.
- 22 The king had a fleet of ocean-going ships at sea with Hiram's ships. Every three years the fleet would bring in a cargo of gold, silver, and ivory, and apes and peacocks.
- 22 The king had a fleet of trading ships at sea along with the ships of Hiram. Once every three years it returned, carrying gold, silver and ivory, and apes and baboons.
- 23 King Solomon was wiser and richer than all the kings of the earth--he surpassed them all.
- 23 King Solomon was greater in riches and wisdom than all the other kings of the earth.
- 24 People came from all over the world to be with Solomon and drink in the wisdom God had given him.
- 24 The whole world sought audience with Solomon to hear the wisdom God had put in his heart.
- 25 And everyone who came brought gifts--artifacts of gold and silver, fashionable robes and gowns, the latest in weapons, exotic spices, and horses and mules--parades of visitors, year after year.
- 25 Year after year, everyone who came brought a gift--articles of silver and gold, robes, weapons and spices, and horses and mules.

- 26 Solomon collected chariots and horses: fourteen hundred chariots and twelve thousand horses! He stabled them in the special chariot cities as well as in Jerusalem.
- 26 Solomon accumulated chariots and horses; he had fourteen hundred chariots and twelve thousand horses, which he kept in the chariot cities and also with him in Jerusalem.
- 27 The king made silver as common as rocks and cedar as common as the fig trees in the lowland hills.
- 27 The king made silver as common in Jerusalem as stones, and cedar as plentiful as sycamore-fig trees in the foothills.
- 28 His horses were brought in from Egypt and Cilicia, specially acquired by the king's agents.
- 28 Solomon's horses were imported from Egypt and from Kue--the royal merchants purchased them from Kue.
- 29 Chariots from Egypt went for fifteen pounds of silver and a horse for about three and three-quarter pounds of silver. Solomon carried on a brisk horse-trading business with the Hittite and Aramean royal houses.
- 29 They imported a chariot from Egypt for six hundred shekels of silver, and a horse for a hundred and fifty. They also exported them to all the kings of the Hittites and of the Arameans.

1 Kings 11

MSG

NIV

- 1 King Solomon was obsessed with women. Pharaoh's daughter was only the first of the many foreign women he loved--Moabite, Ammonite, Edomite, Sidonian, and Hittite.
- 1 King Solomon, however, loved many foreign women besides Pharaoh's daughter--Moabites, Ammonites, Edomites, Sidonians and Hittites.
- 2 He took them from the surrounding pagan nations of which GOD had clearly warned Israel, "You must not marry them; they'll seduce you into infatuations with their gods." Solomon fell in love with them anyway, refusing to give them up.
- 2 They were from nations about which the LORD had told the Israelites, "You must not intermarry with them, because they will surely turn your

- hearts after their gods." Nevertheless, Solomon held fast to them in love.
- 3 He had seven hundred royal wives and three hundred concubines--a thousand women in all! And they did seduce him away from God.
- 3 He had seven hundred wives of royal birth and three hundred concubines, and his wives led him astray.
- 4 As Solomon grew older, his wives beguiled him with their alien gods and he became unfaithful--he didn't stay true to his GOD as his father David had done.
- 4 As Solomon grew old, his wives turned his heart after other gods, and his heart was not fully devoted to the LORD his God, as the heart of David his father had been.
- 5 Solomon took up with Ashtoreth, the whore goddess of the Sidonians, and Molech, the horrible god of the Ammonites.
- 5 He followed Ashtoreth the goddess of the Sidonians, and Molech the detestable god of the Ammonites.
- 6 Solomon openly defied GOD; he did not follow in his father David's footsteps.
- 6 So Solomon did evil in the eyes of the LORD; he did not follow the LORD completely, as David his father had done.
- 7 He went on to build a sacred shrine to Chemosh, the horrible god of Moab, and to Molech, the horrible god of the Ammonites, on a hill just east of Jerusalem.
- 7 On a hill east of Jerusalem, Solomon built a high place for Chemosh the detestable god of Moab, and for Molech the detestable god of the Ammonites.
- 8 He built similar shrines for all his foreign wives, who then polluted the countryside with the smoke and stench of their sacrifices.
- 8 He did the same for all his foreign wives, who burned incense and offered sacrifices to their gods.
- 9 GOD was furious with Solomon for abandoning the GOD of Israel, the God who had twice appeared to him
- 9 The LORD became angry with Solomon because his heart had turned away from the LORD, the God of Israel, who had appeared to him twice.
- 10 and had so clearly commanded him not to fool around with other gods. Solomon faithlessly disobeyed GOD's orders.

- 10 Although he had forbidden Solomon to follow other gods, Solomon did not keep the LORD's command.
- 11 GOD said to Solomon, "Since this is the way it is with you, that you have no intention of keeping faith with me and doing what I have commanded, I'm going to rip the kingdom from you and hand it over to someone else.
- 11 So the LORD said to Solomon, "Since this is your attitude and you have not kept my covenant and my decrees, which I commanded you, I will most certainly tear the kingdom away from you and give it to one of your subordinates.
- 12 But out of respect for your father David I won't do it in your lifetime. It's your son who will pay--I'll rip it right out of his grasp.
- 12 Nevertheless, for the sake of David your father, I will not do it during your lifetime. I will tear it out of the hand of your son.
- 13 Even then I won't take it all; I'll leave him one tribe in honor of my servant David and out of respect for my chosen city Jerusalem."
- 13 Yet I will not tear the whole kingdom from him, but will give him one tribe for the sake of David my servant and for the sake of Jerusalem, which I have chosen."
- 14 GOD incited Hadad, a descendant of the king of Edom, into hostile actions against Solomon.
- 14 Then the LORD raised up against Solomon an adversary, Hadad the Edomite, from the royal line of Edom.
- 15 Years earlier, when David devastated Edom, Joab, commander of the army, on his way to bury the dead, massacred all the men of Edom.
- 15 Earlier when David was fighting with Edom, Joab the commander of the army, who had gone up to bury the dead, had struck down all the men in Edom.
- 16 Joab and his army stayed there for six months, making sure they had killed every man in Edom.
- 16 Joab and all the Israelites stayed there for six months, until they had destroyed all the men in Edom.
- 17 Hadad, just a boy at the time, had escaped with some of the Edomites who had worked for his father.
- 17 But Hadad, still only a boy, fled to Egypt with some Edomite officials who had served his father.

- 18 Their escape route took them through Midian to Paran. They picked up some men in Paran and went on to Egypt and to Pharaoh king of Egypt, who gave Hadad a house, food, and even land.
- 18 They set out from Midian and went to Paran. Then taking men from Paran with them, they went to Egypt, to Pharaoh king of Egypt, who gave Hadad a house and land and provided him with food.
- 19 Pharaoh liked him so well that he gave him the sister of his wife, Queen Tahpenes, in marriage.
- 19 Pharaoh was so pleased with Hadad that he gave him a sister of his own wife, Queen Tahpenes, in marriage.
- 20 She bore Hadad a son named Genubath who was raised like one of the royal family. Genubath grew up in the palace with Pharaoh's children.
- 20 The sister of Tahpenes bore him a son named Genubath, whom Tahpenes brought up in the royal palace. There Genubath lived with Pharaoh's own children.
- 21 While living in Egypt, Hadad heard that both David and Joab, commander of the army, were dead. He approached Pharaoh and said, "Send me off with your blessing--I want to return to my country."
- 21 While he was in Egypt, Hadad heard that David rested with his fathers and that Joab the commander of the army was also dead. Then Hadad said to Pharaoh, "Let me go, that I may return to my own country."
- 22 "But why?" said Pharaoh. "Why would you want to leave here? Hasn't everything been to your liking?" "Everything has been just fine," said Hadad, "but I want to go home--give me a good send-off!"
- 22 What have you lacked here that you want to go back to your own country? Pharaoh asked. "Nothing," Hadad replied, "but do let me go!"
- 23 Then God incited another adversary against Solomon, Rezon son of Eliada, who had deserted from his master, Hadadezer king of Zobah.
- 23 And God raised up against Solomon another adversary, Rezon son of Eliada, who had fled from his master, Hadadezer king of Zobah.
- 24 After David's slaughter of the Arameans, Rezon collected a band of outlaws and became their leader. They later settled in Damascus, where Rezon eventually took over as king.
- 24 He gathered men around him and became the leader of a band of rebels when David destroyed the forces of Zobah; the rebels went to Damascus, where they settled and took control.

- 25 Like Hadad, Rezon was a thorn in Israel's side all of Solomon's life. He was king over Aram, and he hated Israel.
- 25 Rezon was Israel's adversary as long as Solomon lived, adding to the trouble caused by Hadad. So Rezon ruled in Aram and was hostile toward Israel.
- 26 And then, the last straw: Jeroboam son of Nebat rebelled against the king. He was an Ephraimite from Zeredah, his mother a widow named Zeruah. He served in Solomon's administration.
- 26 Also, Jeroboam son of Nebat rebelled against the king. He was one of Solomon's officials, an Ephraimite from Zeredah, and his mother was a widow named Zeruah.
- 27 This is why he rebelled. Solomon had built the outer defense system (the Millo) and had restored the fortifications that were in disrepair from the time of his father David.
- 27 Here is the account of how he rebelled against the king: Solomon had built the supporting terraces and had filled in the gap in the wall of the city of David his father.
- 28 Jeroboam stood out during the construction as strong and able. When Solomon observed what a good worker he was, he put the young man in charge of the entire workforce of the tribe of Joseph.
- 28 Now Jeroboam was a man of standing, and when Solomon saw how well the young man did his work, he put him in charge of the whole labor force of the house of Joseph.
- 29 One day Jeroboam was walking down the road out of Jerusalem. Ahijah the prophet of Shiloh, wearing a brand-new cloak, met him. The two of them were alone on that remote stretch of road.
- 29 About that time Jeroboam was going out of Jerusalem, and Ahijah the prophet of Shiloh met him on the way, wearing a new cloak. The two of them were alone out in the country,
- 30 Ahijah took off the new cloak that he was wearing and ripped it into twelve pieces.
- 30 and Ahijah took hold of the new cloak he was wearing and tore it into twelve pieces.
- 31 Then he said to Jeroboam, "Take ten of these pieces for yourself; this is by order of the GOD of Israel: See what I'm doing--I'm ripping the kingdom out of Solomon's hands and giving you ten of the tribes.

- 31 Then he said to Jeroboam, "Take ten pieces for yourself, for this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'See, I am going to tear the kingdom out of Solomon's hand and give you ten tribes.
- 32 In honor of my servant David and out of respect for Jerusalem, the city I especially chose, he will get one tribe.
- 32 But for the sake of my servant David and the city of Jerusalem, which I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel, he will have one tribe.
- 33 And here's the reason: He faithlessly abandoned me and went off worshiping Ashtoreth goddess of the Sidonians, Chemosh god of the Moabites, and Molech god of the Ammonites. He hasn't lived the way I have shown him, hasn't done what I have wanted, and hasn't followed directions or obeyed orders as his father David did.
- 33 I will do this because they have forsaken me and worshiped Ashtoreth the goddess of the Sidonians, Chemosh the god of the Moabites, and Molech the god of the Ammonites, and have not walked in my ways, nor done what is right in my eyes, nor kept my statutes and laws as David, Solomon's father, did.
- 34 "Still, I won't take the whole kingdom away from him. I'll stick with him through his lifetime because of my servant David whom I chose and who did follow my directions and obey my orders.
- 34 'But I will not take the whole kingdom out of Solomon's hand; I have made him ruler all the days of his life for the sake of David my servant, whom I chose and who observed my commands and statutes.
- 35 But after that I'll remove the kingdom from his son's control and give you ten tribes.
- 35 I will take the kingdom from his son's hands and give you ten tribes.
- 36 I'll leave one tribe to his son, to maintain a witness to my servant David in Jerusalem, the city I chose as a memorial to my Name.
- 36 I will give one tribe to his son so that David my servant may always have a lamp before me in Jerusalem, the city where I chose to put my Name.
- 37 "But I have taken you in hand. Rule to your heart's content! You are to be the king of Israel.
- 37 However, as for you, I will take you, and you will rule over all that your heart desires; you will be king over Israel.

- 38 If you listen to what I tell you and live the way I show you and do what pleases me, following directions and obeying orders as my servant David did, I'll stick with you no matter what. I'll build you a kingdom as solid as the one I built for David. Israel will be yours!
- 38 If you do whatever I command you and walk in my ways and do what is right in my eyes by keeping my statutes and commands, as David my servant did, I will be with you. I will build you a dynasty as enduring as the one I built for David and will give Israel to you.
- 39 I am bringing pain and trouble on David's descendants, but the trials won't last forever."
- 39 I will humble David's descendants because of this, but not forever.' "
- 40 Solomon ordered the assassination of Jeroboam, but he got away to Egypt and found asylum there with King Shishak. He remained in exile there until Solomon died.
- 40 Solomon tried to kill Jeroboam, but Jeroboam fled to Egypt, to Shishak the king, and stayed there until Solomon's death.
- 41 The rest of Solomon's life and rule, his work and his wisdom, you can read for yourself in The Chronicles of Solomon.
- 41 As for the other events of Solomon's reign--all he did and the wisdom he displayed--are they not written in the book of the annals of Solomon?
- 42 Solomon ruled in Jerusalem over all Israel for forty years.
- 42 Solomon reigned in Jerusalem over all Israel forty years.
- 43 He died and was buried in the City of David his father. His son Rehoboam was the next king.
- 43 Then he rested with his fathers and was buried in the city of David his father. And Rehoboam his son succeeded him as king.

1 Kings 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 Rehoboam traveled to Shechem where all Israel had gathered to inaugurate him as king.
- 1 Rehoboam went to Shechem, for all the Israelites had gone there to make him king.
- 2 Jeroboam had been in Egypt, where he had taken asylum from King Solomon; when he got the report of Solomon's death he had come back.
- 2 When Jeroboam son of Nebat heard this (he was still in Egypt, where he had fled from King Solomon), he returned from Egypt.
- 3 Rehoboam assembled Jeroboam and all the people. They said to Rehoboam,
- 3 So they sent for Jeroboam, and he and the whole assembly of Israel went to Rehoboam and said to him:
- 4 "Your father made life hard for us--worked our fingers to the bone. Give us a break; lighten up on us and we'll willingly serve you."
- 4 Your father put a heavy yoke on us, but now lighten the harsh labor and the heavy yoke he put on us, and we will serve you.
- 5 "Give me three days to think it over, then come back," Rehoboam said.
- 5 Rehoboam answered, "Go away for three days and then come back to me." So the people went away.
- 6 King Rehoboam talked it over with the elders who had advised his father when he was alive: "What's your counsel? How do you suggest that I answer the people?"
- 6 Then King Rehoboam consulted the elders who had served his father Solomon during his lifetime. "How would you advise me to answer these people?" he asked.
- 7 They said, "If you will be a servant to this people, be considerate of their needs and respond with compassion, work things out with them, they'll end up doing anything for you."
- 7 They replied, "If today you will be a servant to these people and serve them and give them a favorable answer, they will always be your servants."

- 8 But he rejected the counsel of the elders and asked the young men he'd grown up with who were now currying his favor,
- 8 But Rehoboam rejected the advice the elders gave him and consulted the young men who had grown up with him and were serving him.
- 9 "What do you think? What should I say to these people who are saying, 'Give us a break from your father's harsh ways--lighten up on us'?" "
- 9 He asked them, "What is your advice? How should we answer these people who say to me, 'Lighten the yoke your father put on us'?"
- 10 The young turks he'd grown up with said, "These people who complain, 'Your father was too hard on us; lighten up'--well, tell them this: 'My little finger is thicker than my father's waist.
- 10 The young men who had grown up with him replied, "Tell these people who have said to you, 'Your father put a heavy yoke on us, but make our yoke lighter'--tell them, 'My little finger is thicker than my father's waist.
- 11 If you think life under my father was hard, you haven't seen the half of it. My father thrashed you with whips; I'll beat you bloody with chains!"
- 11 My father laid on you a heavy yoke; I will make it even heavier. My father scourged you with whips; I will scourge you with scorpions.' "
- 12 Three days later Jeroboam and the people showed up, just as Rehoboam had directed when he said, "Give me three days to think it over, then come back."
- 12 Three days later Jeroboam and all the people returned to Rehoboam, as the king had said, "Come back to me in three days."
- 13 The king's answer was harsh and rude. He spurned the counsel of the elders
- 13 The king answered the people harshly. Rejecting the advice given him by the elders,
- 14 and went with the advice of the younger set, "If you think life under my father was hard, you haven't seen the half of it. My father thrashed you with whips; I'll beat you bloody with chains!"
- 14 he followed the advice of the young men and said, "My father made your yoke heavy; I will make it even heavier. My father scourged you with whips; I will scourge you with scorpions."
- 15 Rehoboam turned a deaf ear to the people. GOD was behind all this, confirming the message that he had given to Jeroboam son of Nebat through Ahijah of Shiloh.

- 15 So the king did not listen to the people, for this turn of events was from the LORD, to fulfill the word the LORD had spoken to Jeroboam son of Nebat through Ahijah the Shilonite.
- 16 When all Israel realized that the king hadn't listened to a word they'd said, they stood up to him and said, Get lost, David! We've had it with you, son of Jesse! Let's get out of here, Israel, and fast! From now on, David, mind your own business. And with that, they left.
- 16 When all Israel saw that the king refused to listen to them, they answered the king: "What share do we have in David, what part in Jesse's son? To your tents, O Israel! Look after your own house, O David!" So the Israelites went home.
- 17 But Rehoboam continued to rule those who lived in the towns of Judah.
- 17 But as for the Israelites who were living in the towns of Judah, Rehoboam still ruled over them.
- 18 When King Rehoboam next sent out Adoniram, head of the workforce, the Israelites ganged up on him, pelted him with stones, and killed him. King Rehoboam jumped in his chariot and fled to Jerusalem as fast as he could.
- 18 King Rehoboam sent out Adoniram, who was in charge of forced labor, but all Israel stoned him to death. King Rehoboam, however, managed to get into his chariot and escape to Jerusalem.
- 19 Israel has been in rebellion against the Davidic regime ever since.
- 19 So Israel has been in rebellion against the house of David to this day.
- 20 When the word was out that Jeroboam was back and available, the assembled people invited him and inaugurated him king over all Israel. The only tribe left to the Davidic dynasty was Judah.
- 20 When all the Israelites heard that Jeroboam had returned, they sent and called him to the assembly and made him king over all Israel. Only the tribe of Judah remained loyal to the house of David.
- 21 When Rehoboam got back to Jerusalem, he called up the men of Judah and the tribe of Benjamin, a hundred and eighty thousand of their best soldiers, to go to war against Israel and recover the kingdom for Rehoboam son of Solomon.
- 21 When Rehoboam arrived in Jerusalem, he mustered the whole house of Judah and the tribe of Benjamin--a hundred and eighty thousand fighting

- men--to make war against the house of Israel and to regain the kingdom for Rehoboam son of Solomon.
- 22 At this time the word of God came to Shemaiah, a man of God:
- 22 But this word of God came to Shemaiah the man of God:
- 23 "Tell this to Rehoboam son of Solomon king of Judah, along with everyone in Judah and Benjamin and anyone else who is around:
- 23 Say to Rehoboam son of Solomon king of Judah, to the whole house of Judah and Benjamin, and to the rest of the people,
- 24 This is GOD's word: Don't march out; don't fight against your brothers the Israelites; go back home, every last one of you; I'm in charge here." And they did it; they did what GOD said and went home.
- 24 'This is what the LORD says: Do not go up to fight against your brothers, the Israelites. Go home, every one of you, for this is my doing.' " So they obeyed the word of the LORD and went home again, as the LORD had ordered.
- 25 Jeroboam made a fort at Shechem in the hills of Ephraim, and made that his headquarters. He also built a fort at Penuel.
- 25 Then Jeroboam fortified Shechem in the hill country of Ephraim and lived there. From there he went out and built up Peniel.
- 26 But then Jeroboam thought, "It won't be long before the kingdom is reunited under David.
- 26 Jeroboam thought to himself, "The kingdom will now likely revert to the house of David.
- 27 As soon as these people resume worship at The Temple of GOD in Jerusalem, they'll start thinking of Rehoboam king of Judah as their ruler. They'll then kill me and go back to King Rehoboam."
- 27 If these people go up to offer sacrifices at the temple of the LORD in Jerusalem, they will again give their allegiance to their lord, Rehoboam king of Judah. They will kill me and return to King Rehoboam."
- 28 So the king came up with a plan: He made two golden calves. Then he announced, "It's too much trouble for you to go to Jerusalem to worship. Look at these--the gods who brought you out of Egypt!"
- 28 After seeking advice, the king made two golden calves. He said to the people, "It is too much for you to go up to Jerusalem. Here are your gods, O Israel, who brought you up out of Egypt."
- 29 He put one calf in Bethel; the other he placed in Dan.

- 29 One he set up in Bethel, and the other in Dan.
- 30 This was blatant sin. Think of it--people traveling all the way to Dan to worship a calf!
- 30 And this thing became a sin; the people went even as far as Dan to worship the one there.
- 31 And that wasn't the end of it. Jeroboam built forbidden shrines all over the place and recruited priests from wherever he could find them, regardless of whether they were fit for the job or not.
- 31 Jeroboam built shrines on high places and appointed priests from all sorts of people, even though they were not Levites.
- 32 To top it off, he created a holy New Year festival to be held on the fifteenth day of the eighth month to replace the one in Judah, complete with worship offered on the Altar at Bethel and sacrificing before the calves he had set up there. He staffed Bethel with priests from the local shrines he had made.
- 32 He instituted a festival on the fifteenth day of the eighth month, like the festival held in Judah, and offered sacrifices on the altar. This he did in Bethel, sacrificing to the calves he had made. And at Bethel he also installed priests at the high places he had made.
- 33 This was strictly his own idea to compete with the feast in Judah; and he carried it off with flair, a festival exclusively for Israel, Jeroboam himself leading the worship at the Altar.
- 33 On the fifteenth day of the eighth month, a month of his own choosing, he offered sacrifices on the altar he had built at Bethel. So he instituted the festival for the Israelites and went up to the altar to make offerings.

1 Kings 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 And then this happened: Just as Jeroboam was at the Altar, about to make an offering, a holy man came from Judah by GOD's command
- 1 By the word of the LORD a man of God came from Judah to Bethel, as Jeroboam was standing by the altar to make an offering.
- 2 and preached (these were GOD's orders) to the Altar: "Altar, Altar! GOD's message! 'A son will be born into David's family named Josiah.

- The priests from the shrines who are making offerings on you, he will sacrifice--on you! Human bones burned on you!"
- 2 He cried out against the altar by the word of the LORD: "O altar, altar! This is what the LORD says: 'A son named Josiah will be born to the house of David. On you he will sacrifice the priests of the high places who now make offerings here, and human bones will be burned on you.'"
- 3 At the same time he announced a sign: "This is the proof GOD gives--the Altar will split into pieces and the holy offerings spill into the dirt."
- 3 That same day the man of God gave a sign: "This is the sign the LORD has declared: The altar will be split apart and the ashes on it will be poured out."
- 4 When the king heard the message the holy man preached against the Altar at Bethel, he reached out to grab him, yelling, "Arrest him!" But his arm was paralyzed and hung useless.
- 4 When King Jeroboam heard what the man of God cried out against the altar at Bethel, he stretched out his hand from the altar and said, "Seize him!" But the hand he stretched out toward the man shriveled up, so that he could not pull it back.
- 5 At the same time the Altar broke apart and the holy offerings all spilled into the dirt--the very sign the holy man had announced by GOD's command.
- 5 Also, the altar was split apart and its ashes poured out according to the sign given by the man of God by the word of the LORD.
- 6 The king pleaded with the holy man, "Help me! Pray to your GOD for the healing of my arm." The holy man prayed for him and the king's arm was healed--as good as new!
- 6 Then the king said to the man of God, "Intercede with the LORD your God and pray for me that my hand may be restored." So the man of God interceded with the LORD, and the king's hand was restored and became as it was before.
- 7 Then the king invited the holy man, "Join me for a meal; I have a gift for you."
- 7 The king said to the man of God, "Come home with me and have something to eat, and I will give you a gift."

- 8 The holy man told the king, "Not on your life! You couldn't pay me enough to get me to sit down with you at a meal in this place.
- 8 But the man of God answered the king, "Even if you were to give me half your possessions, I would not go with you, nor would I eat bread or drink water here.
- 9 I'm here under GOD's orders, and he commanded, 'Don't eat a crumb, don't drink a drop, and don't go back the way you came.'"
- 9 For I was commanded by the word of the LORD: 'You must not eat bread or drink water or return by the way you came.' "
- 10 Then he left by a different road than the one on which he had walked to Bethel.
- 10 So he took another road and did not return by the way he had come to Bethel.
- 11 There was an old prophet who lived in Bethel. His sons came and told him the story of what the holy man had done that day in Bethel, told him everything that had happened and what the holy man had said to the king.
- 11 Now there was a certain old prophet living in Bethel, whose sons came and told him all that the man of God had done there that day. They also told their father what he had said to the king.
- 12 Their father said, "Which way did he go?" His sons pointed out the road that the holy man from Judah had taken.
- 12 Their father asked them, "Which way did he go?" And his sons showed him which road the man of God from Judah had taken.
- 13 He told his sons, "Saddle my donkey." When they had saddled it, he got on
- 13 So he said to his sons, "Saddle the donkey for me." And when they had saddled the donkey for him, he mounted it
- 14 and rode after the holy man. He found him sitting under an oak tree. He asked him, "Are you the holy man who came from Judah?" "Yes, I am," he said.
- 14 and rode after the man of God. He found him sitting under an oak tree and asked, "Are you the man of God who came from Judah?" "I am," he replied.
- 15 "Well, come home with me and have a meal."
- 15 So the prophet said to him, "Come home with me and eat."

- 16 "Sorry, I can't do that," the holy man said. "I can neither go back with you nor eat with you in this country.
- 16 The man of God said, "I cannot turn back and go with you, nor can I eat bread or drink water with you in this place.
- 17 I'm under strict orders from GOD: 'Don't eat a crumb; don't drink a drop; and don't come back the way you came.'"
- 17 I have been told by the word of the LORD: 'You must not eat bread or drink water there or return by the way you came.' "
- 18 But he said, "I am also a prophet, just like you. And an angel came to me with a message from GOD: 'Bring him home with you, and give him a good meal!'" But the man was lying.
- 18 The old prophet answered, "I too am a prophet, as you are. And an angel said to me by the word of the LORD: 'Bring him back with you to your house so that he may eat bread and drink water.' " (But he was lying to him.)
- 19 So the holy man went home with him and they had a meal together.
- 19 So the man of God returned with him and ate and drank in his house.
- 20 There they were, sitting at the table together, when the word of GOD came to the prophet who had brought him back.
- 20 While they were sitting at the table, the word of the LORD came to the old prophet who had brought him back.
- 21 He confronted the holy man who had come from Judah: "GOD's word to you: You disobeyed GOD's command; you didn't keep the strict orders your GOD gave you;
- 21 He cried out to the man of God who had come from Judah, "This is what the LORD says: 'You have defied the word of the LORD and have not kept the command the LORD your God gave you.
- 22 you came back and sat down to a good meal in the very place GOD told you, 'Don't eat a crumb; don't drink a drop.' For that you're going to die far from home and not be buried in your ancestral tomb."
- 22 You came back and ate bread and drank water in the place where he told you not to eat or drink. Therefore your body will not be buried in the tomb of your fathers.' "
- 23 When the meal was over, the prophet who had brought him back saddled his donkey for him.

- 23 When the man of God had finished eating and drinking, the prophet who had brought him back saddled his donkey for him.
- 24 Down the road a way, a lion met him and killed him. His corpse lay crumpled on the road, the lion on one side and the donkey on the other.
- 24 As he went on his way, a lion met him on the road and killed him, and his body was thrown down on the road, with both the donkey and the lion standing beside it.
- 25 Some passersby saw the corpse in a heap on the road, with the lion standing guard beside it. They went to the village where the old prophet lived and told what they had seen.
- 25 Some people who passed by saw the body thrown down there, with the lion standing beside the body, and they went and reported it in the city where the old prophet lived.
- 26 When the prophet who had gotten him off track heard it, he said, "It's the holy man who disobeyed GOD's strict orders. GOD turned him over to the lion who knocked him around and killed him, just as GOD had told him."
- 26 When the prophet who had brought him back from his journey heard of it, he said, "It is the man of God who defied the word of the LORD. The LORD has given him over to the lion, which has mauled him and killed him, as the word of the LORD had warned him."
- 27 The prophet told his sons, "Saddle my donkey." They did it.
- 27 The prophet said to his sons, "Saddle the donkey for me," and they did so.
- 28 He rode out and found the corpse in a heap in the road, with the lion and the donkey standing there. The lion hadn't bothered either the corpse or the donkey.
- 28 Then he went out and found the body thrown down on the road, with the donkey and the lion standing beside it. The lion had neither eaten the body nor mauled the donkey.
- 29 The old prophet loaded the corpse of the holy man on his donkey and returned it to his own town to give it a decent burial.
- 29 So the prophet picked up the body of the man of God, laid it on the donkey, and brought it back to his own city to mourn for him and bury him.

- 30 He placed the body in his own tomb. The people mourned, saying, "A sad day, brother!"
- 30 Then he laid the body in his own tomb, and they mourned over him and said, "Oh, my brother!"
- 31 After the funeral, the prophet said to his sons, "When I die, bury me in the same tomb where the holy man is buried, my bones alongside his bones.
- 31 After burying him, he said to his sons, "When I die, bury me in the grave where the man of God is buried; lay my bones beside his bones.
- 32 The message that he preached by GOD's command against the Altar at Bethel and against all the sex-and-religion shrines in the towns of Samaria will come true."
- 32 For the message he declared by the word of the LORD against the altar in Bethel and against all the shrines on the high places in the towns of Samaria will certainly come true."
- 33 After this happened, Jeroboam kept right on doing evil, recruiting priests for the forbidden shrines indiscriminately--anyone who wanted to could be a priest at one of the local shrines.
- 33 Even after this, Jeroboam did not change his evil ways, but once more appointed priests for the high places from all sorts of people. Anyone who wanted to become a priest he consecrated for the high places.
- 34 This was the root sin of Jeroboam's government. And it was this that ruined him.
- 34 This was the sin of the house of Jeroboam that led to its downfall and to its destruction from the face of the earth.

1 Kings 14

MSG

NIV

- 1 At about this time Jeroboam's son Abijah came down sick.
- 1 At that time Abijah son of Jeroboam became ill,
- 2 Jeroboam said to his wife, "Do something. Disguise yourself so no one will know you are the queen and go to Shiloh. Ahijah the prophet lives there, the same Ahijah who told me I'd be king over this people.

- 2 and Jeroboam said to his wife, "Go, disguise yourself, so you won't be recognized as the wife of Jeroboam. Then go to Shiloh. Ahijah the prophet is there--the one who told me I would be king over this people.
- 3 Take along ten loaves of bread, some sweet rolls, and a jug of honey. Make a visit to him and he'll tell you what's going on with our boy."
- 3 Take ten loaves of bread with you, some cakes and a jar of honey, and go to him. He will tell you what will happen to the boy."
- 4 Jeroboam's wife did as she was told; she went straight to Shiloh and to Ahijah's house. Ahijah was an old man at this time, and blind,
- 4 So Jeroboam's wife did what he said and went to Ahijah's house in Shiloh. Now Ahijah could not see; his sight was gone because of his age.
- 5 but GOD had warned Ahijah, "Jeroboam's wife is on her way to consult with you regarding her sick son; tell her this and this and this." When she came in she was disguised.
- 5 But the LORD had told Ahijah, "Jeroboam's wife is coming to ask you about her son, for he is ill, and you are to give her such and such an answer. When she arrives, she will pretend to be someone else."
- 6 Ahijah heard her come through the door and said, "Welcome, wife of Jeroboam! But why the deception? I've got bad news for you.
- 6 So when Ahijah heard the sound of her footsteps at the door, he said, "Come in, wife of Jeroboam. Why this pretense? I have been sent to you with bad news.
- 7 Go and deliver this message I received firsthand from GOD, the God of Israel, to Jeroboam: I raised you up from obscurity and made you the leader of my people Israel.
- 7 Go, tell Jeroboam that this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'I raised you up from among the people and made you a leader over my people Israel.
- 8 I ripped the kingdom from the hands of David's family and gave it to you, but you weren't at all like my servant David who did what I told him and lived from his undivided heart, pleasing me.
- 8 I tore the kingdom away from the house of David and gave it to you, but you have not been like my servant David, who kept my commands and followed me with all his heart, doing only what was right in my eyes.
- 9 Instead you've set a new record in works of evil by making alien gods--tin gods! Pushing me aside and turning your back--you've made me

mighty angry.

- 9 You have done more evil than all who lived before you. You have made for yourself other gods, idols made of metal; you have provoked me to anger and thrust me behind your back.
- 10 "And I'll not put up with it: I'm bringing doom on the household of Jeroboam, killing the lot of them right down to the last male wretch in Israel, whether slave or free. They've become nothing but garbage and I'm getting rid of them.
- 10 'Because of this, I am going to bring disaster on the house of Jeroboam. I will cut off from Jeroboam every last male in Israel--slave or free. I will burn up the house of Jeroboam as one burns dung, until it is all gone.
- 11 The ones who die in the city will be eaten by stray dogs; the ones who die out in the country will be eaten by carrion crows. GOD's decree!
- 11 Dogs will eat those belonging to Jeroboam who die in the city, and the birds of the air will feed on those who die in the country. The LORD has spoken!'
- 12 "And that's it. Go on home--the minute you step foot in town, the boy will die.
- 12 As for you, go back home. When you set foot in your city, the boy will die.
- 13 Everyone will come to his burial, mourning his death. He is the only one in Jeroboam's family who will get a decent burial; he's the only one for whom GOD, the God of Israel, has a good word to say.
- 13 All Israel will mourn for him and bury him. He is the only one belonging to Jeroboam who will be buried, because he is the only one in the house of Jeroboam in whom the LORD, the God of Israel, has found anything good.
- 14 "Then GOD will appoint a king over Israel who will wipe out Jeroboam's family, wipe them right off the map--doomsday for Jeroboam!
- 14 The LORD will raise up for himself a king over Israel who will cut off the family of Jeroboam. This is the day! What? Yes, even now.
- 15 He will hit Israel hard, as a storm slaps reeds about; he'll pull them up by the roots from this good land of their inheritance, weeding them out,

- and then scatter them to the four winds. And why? Because they made GOD so angry with Asherah sex-and-religion shrines.
- 15 And the LORD will strike Israel, so that it will be like a reed swaying in the water. He will uproot Israel from this good land that he gave to their forefathers and scatter them beyond the River, because they provoked the LORD to anger by making Asherah poles.
- 16 He'll wash his hands of Israel because of Jeroboam's sins, which have led Israel into a life of sin."
- 16 And he will give Israel up because of the sins Jeroboam has committed and has caused Israel to commit."
- 17 Jeroboam's wife left and went home to Tirzah. The moment she stepped through the door, the boy died.
- 17 Then Jeroboam's wife got up and left and went to Tirzah. As soon as she stepped over the threshold of the house, the boy died.
- 18 They buried him and everyone mourned his death, just as GOD had said through his servant the prophet Ahijah.
- 18 They buried him, and all Israel mourned for him, as the LORD had said through his servant the prophet Ahijah.
- 19 The rest of Jeroboam's life, the wars he fought and the way he ruled, is written in The Chronicles of the Kings of Israel.
- 19 The other events of Jeroboam's reign, his wars and how he ruled, are written in the book of the annals of the kings of Israel.
- 20 He ruled for twenty-two years. He died and was buried with his ancestors. Nadab his son was king after him.
- 20 He reigned for twenty-two years and then rested with his fathers. And Nadab his son succeeded him as king.
- 21 Rehoboam son of Solomon was king in Judah. He was forty-one years old when he took the throne and was king for seventeen years in Jerusalem, the city GOD selected from all the tribes of Israel for the worship of his Name. Rehoboam's mother was Naamah, an Ammonite.
- 21 Rehoboam son of Solomon was king in Judah. He was forty- one years old when he became king, and he reigned seventeen years in Jerusalem, the city the LORD had chosen out of all the tribes of Israel in which to put his Name. His mother's name was Naamah; she was an Ammonite.
- 22 Judah was openly wicked before GOD, making him very angry. They set new records in sin, surpassing anything their ancestors had done.

- 22 Judah did evil in the eyes of the LORD. By the sins they committed they stirred up his jealous anger more than their fathers had done.
- 23 They built Asherah sex-and-religion shrines and set up sacred stones all over the place--on hills, under trees, wherever you looked.
- 23 They also set up for themselves high places, sacred stones and Asherah poles on every high hill and under every spreading tree.
- 24 Worse, they had male sacred prostitutes, polluting the country outrageously--all the stuff that GOD had gotten rid of when he brought Israel into the land.
- 24 There were even male shrine prostitutes in the land; the people engaged in all the detestable practices of the nations the LORD had driven out before the Israelites.
- 25 In the fifth year of King Rehoboam's rule, Shishak king of Egypt made war against Jerusalem.
- 25 In the fifth year of King Rehoboam, Shishak king of Egypt attacked Jerusalem.
- 26 He plundered The Temple of GOD and the royal palace of their treasures, cleaned them out--even the gold shields that Solomon had made.
- 26 He carried off the treasures of the temple of the LORD and the treasures of the royal palace. He took everything, including all the gold shields Solomon had made.
- 27 King Rehoboam replaced them with bronze shields and outfitted the royal palace guards with them.
- 27 So King Rehoboam made bronze shields to replace them and assigned these to the commanders of the guard on duty at the entrance to the royal palace.
- 28 Whenever the king went to GOD's Temple, the guards carried the shields but always returned them to the guardroom.
- 28 Whenever the king went to the LORD's temple, the guards bore the shields, and afterward they returned them to the guardroom.
- 29 The rest of Rehoboam's life, what he said and did, is all written in The Chronicles of the Kings of Judah.
- 29 As for the other events of Rehoboam's reign, and all he did, are they not written in the book of the annals of the kings of Judah?
- 30 There was war between Rehoboam and Jeroboam the whole time.

- 30 There was continual warfare between Rehoboam and Jeroboam.
- 31 Rehoboam died and was buried with his ancestors in the City of David. His mother was Naamah, an Ammonite. His son Abijah ruled after him.
- 31 And Rehoboam rested with his fathers and was buried with them in the City of David. His mother's name was Naamah; she was an Ammonite. And Abijah his son succeeded him as king.

1 Kings 15

MSG

NIV

- 1 In the eighteenth year of the rule of Jeroboam son of Nebat, Abijah took over the throne of Judah.
- 1 In the eighteenth year of the reign of Jeroboam son of Nebat, Abijah became king of Judah,
- 2 He ruled in Jerusalem three years. His mother was Maacah daughter of Absalom.
- 2 and he reigned in Jerusalem three years. His mother's name was Maacah daughter of Abishalom.
- 3 He continued to sin just like his father before him. He was not truehearted to GOD as his grandfather David had been.
- 3 He committed all the sins his father had done before him; his heart was not fully devoted to the LORD his God, as the heart of David his forefather had been.
- 4 But despite that, out of respect for David, his GOD graciously gave him a lamp, a son to follow him and keep Jerusalem secure.
- 4 Nevertheless, for David's sake the LORD his God gave him a lamp in Jerusalem by raising up a son to succeed him and by making Jerusalem strong.
- 5 For David had lived an exemplary life before GOD all his days, not going off on his own in willful defiance of GOD's clear directions (except for that time with Uriah the Hittite).
- 5 For David had done what was right in the eyes of the LORD and had not failed to keep any of the LORD's commands all the days of his life--except in the case of Uriah the Hittite.
- 6 But war continued between Abijah and Jeroboam the whole time.

- 6 There was war between Rehoboam and Jeroboam throughout Abijah's lifetime.
- 7 The rest of Abijah's life, everything he did, is written in The Chronicles of the Kings of Judah. But the war with Jeroboam was the dominant theme.
- 7 As for the other events of Abijah's reign, and all he did, are they not written in the book of the annals of the kings of Judah? There was war between Abijah and Jeroboam.
- 8 Abijah died and was buried with his ancestors in the City of David. His son Asa was king after him.
- 8 And Abijah rested with his fathers and was buried in the City of David. And Asa his son succeeded him as king.
- 9 In the twentieth year of Jeroboam king of Israel, Asa began his rule over Judah.
- 9 In the twentieth year of Jeroboam king of Israel, Asa became king of Judah,
- 10 He ruled for forty-one years in Jerusalem. His grandmother's name was Maacah.
- 10 and he reigned in Jerusalem forty-one years. His grandmother's name was Maacah daughter of Abishalom.
- 11 Asa conducted himself well before GOD, reviving the ways of his ancestor David.
- 11 Asa did what was right in the eyes of the LORD, as his father David had done.
- 12 He cleaned house: He got rid of the sacred prostitutes and threw out all the idols his predecessors had made.
- 12 He expelled the male shrine prostitutes from the land and got rid of all the idols his fathers had made.
- 13 Asa spared nothing and no one; he went so far as to remove Queen Maacah from her position because she had built a shockingly obscene memorial to the whore goddess Asherah. Asa tore it down and burned it up in the Kidron Valley.
- 13 He even deposed his grandmother Maacah from her position as queen mother, because she had made a repulsive Asherah pole. Asa cut the pole down and burned it in the Kidron Valley.

- 14 Unfortunately, he didn't get rid of the local sex-and-religion shrines. But he was well-intentioned--his heart was in the right place, in tune with GOD.
- 14 Although he did not remove the high places, Asa's heart was fully committed to the LORD all his life.
- 15 All the gold and silver vessels and artifacts that he and his father had consecrated for holy use he installed in The Temple.
- 15 He brought into the temple of the LORD the silver and gold and the articles that he and his father had dedicated.
- 16 But through much of his reign there was war between Asa and Baasha king of Israel.
- 16 There was war between Asa and Baasha king of Israel throughout their reigns.
- 17 Baasha king of Israel started it by building a fort at Ramah and closing the border between Israel and Judah so no one could enter or leave Judah.
- 17 Baasha king of Israel went up against Judah and fortified Ramah to prevent anyone from leaving or entering the territory of Asa king of Judah.
- 18 Asa took all the silver and gold that was left in the treasuries of The Temple of GOD and the royal palace, gave it to his servants, and sent them to Ben-Hadad son of Tabrimmon, the son of Hezion king of Aram, who was ruling in Damascus, with this message:
- 18 Asa then took all the silver and gold that was left in the treasuries of the LORD's temple and of his own palace. He entrusted it to his officials and sent them to Ben-Hadad son of Tabrimmon, the son of Hezion, the king of Aram, who was ruling in Damascus.
- 19 "Let's make a treaty like the one between our fathers. I'm showing my good faith with this gift of silver and gold. Break your deal with Baasha king of Israel so he'll quit fighting against me."
- 19 Let there be a treaty between me and you, he said, "as there was between my father and your father. See, I am sending you a gift of silver and gold. Now break your treaty with Baasha king of Israel so he will withdraw from me."
- 20 Ben-Hadad went along with King Asa and sent out his troops against the towns of Israel. He attacked Ijon, Dan, Abel Beth Maacah, and the

entire region of Kinnereth, including Naphtali.

20 Ben-Hadad agreed with King Asa and sent the commanders of his forces against the towns of Israel. He conquered Ijon, Dan, Abel Beth Maacah and all Kinnereth in addition to Naphtali.

21 When Baasha got the report he quit fortifying Ramah and pulled back to Tirzah.

21 When Baasha heard this, he stopped building Ramah and withdrew to Tirzah.

22 Then King Asa issued orders to everyone in Judah--no exemptions--to haul away the logs and stones Baasha had used in the fortification of Ramah and use them to fortify Geba in Benjamin and Mizpah.

22 Then King Asa issued an order to all Judah--no one was exempt--and they carried away from Ramah the stones and timber Baasha had been using there. With them King Asa built up Geba in Benjamin, and also Mizpah.

23 A full account of Asa's life, all the great things he did and the fortifications he constructed, is written in The Chronicles of the Kings of Judah. In his old age he developed severe gout.

23 As for all the other events of Asa's reign, all his achievements, all he did and the cities he built, are they not written in the book of the annals of the kings of Judah? In his old age, however, his feet became diseased.

24 Then Asa died and was buried with his ancestors in the City of David. His son Jehoshaphat became king after him.

24 Then Asa rested with his fathers and was buried with them in the city of his father David. And Jehoshaphat his son succeeded him as king.

25 Nadab son of Jeroboam became king over Israel in the second year of Asa's rule in Judah. He was king of Israel two years.

25 Nadab son of Jeroboam became king of Israel in the second year of Asa king of Judah, and he reigned over Israel two years.

26 He was openly evil before GOD--he followed in the footsteps of his father who both sinned and made Israel sin.

26 He did evil in the eyes of the LORD, walking in the ways of his father and in his sin, which he had caused Israel to commit.

27 Baasha son of Ahijah of the tribe of Issachar ganged up on him and attacked him at the Philistine town of Gibbethon while Nadab and the Israelites were doing battle there.

- 27 Baasha son of Ahijah of the house of Issachar plotted against him, and he struck him down at Gibbethon, a Philistine town, while Nadab and all Israel were besieging it.
- 28 Baasha killed Nadab in the third year of Asa king of Judah and became Israel's next king.
- 28 Baasha killed Nadab in the third year of Asa king of Judah and succeeded him as king.
- 29 As soon as he was king he killed everyone in Jeroboam's family. There wasn't a living soul left to the name of Jeroboam; Baasha wiped them out totally, just as GOD's servant Ahijah of Shiloh had prophesied--
- 29 As soon as he began to reign, he killed Jeroboam's whole family. He did not leave Jeroboam anyone that breathed, but destroyed them all, according to the word of the LORD given through his servant Ahijah the Shilonite--
- 30 punishment for Jeroboam's sins and for making Israel sin, for making the GOD of Israel thoroughly angry.
- 30 because of the sins Jeroboam had committed and had caused Israel to commit, and because he provoked the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger.
- 31 The rest of Nadab's life, everything else he did, is written in The Chronicles of the Kings of Israel.
- 31 As for the other events of Nadab's reign, and all he did, are they not written in the book of the annals of the kings of Israel?
- 32 There was continuous war between Asa and Baasha king of Israel.
- 32 There was war between Asa and Baasha king of Israel throughout their reigns.
- 33 In the third year of Asa king of Judah, Baasha son of Ahijah became king in Tirzah over all Israel. He ruled twenty-four years.
- 33 In the third year of Asa king of Judah, Baasha son of Ahijah became king of all Israel in Tirzah, and he reigned twenty-four years.
- 34 He was openly evil before GOD, walking in the footsteps of Jeroboam, who both sinned and made Israel sin.
- 34 He did evil in the eyes of the LORD, walking in the ways of Jeroboam and in his sin, which he had caused Israel to commit.

1 Kings 16

MSG

NIV

- 1 The word of GOD came to Jehu son of Hanani with this message for Baasha:
- 1 Then the word of the LORD came to Jehu son of Hanani against Baasha:
- 2 "I took you from nothing--a complete nobody--and set you up as the leader of my people Israel, but you plodded along in the rut of Jeroboam, making my people Israel sin and making me seethe over their sin.
- 2 I lifted you up from the dust and made you leader of my people Israel, but you walked in the ways of Jeroboam and caused my people Israel to sin and to provoke me to anger by their sins.
- 3 And now the consequences--I will burn Baasha and his regime to cinders, the identical fate of Jeroboam son of Nebat.
- 3 So I am about to consume Baasha and his house, and I will make your house like that of Jeroboam son of Nebat.
- 4 Baasha's people who die in the city will be eaten by scavenger dogs; carrion crows will eat the ones who die in the country."
- 4 Dogs will eat those belonging to Baasha who die in the city, and the birds of the air will feed on those who die in the country."
- 5 The rest of Baasha's life, the record of his regime, is written in The Chronicles of the Kings of Israel.
- 5 As for the other events of Baasha's reign, what he did and his achievements, are they not written in the book of the annals of the kings of Israel?
- 6 Baasha died and was buried with his ancestors in Tirzah. His son Elah was king after him.
- 6 Baasha rested with his fathers and was buried in Tirzah. And Elah his son succeeded him as king.
- 7 That's the way it was with Baasha: Through the prophet Jehu son of Hanani, GOD's word came to him and his regime because of his life of open evil before GOD and his making GOD so angry--a chip off the block of Jeroboam, even though GOD had destroyed him.
- 7 Moreover, the word of the LORD came through the prophet Jehu son of Hanani to Baasha and his house, because of all the evil he had done in the eyes of the LORD, provoking him to anger by the things he did, and becoming like the house of Jeroboam--and also because he destroyed it.

- 8 In the twenty-sixth year of Asa king of Judah, Elah son of Baasha began his rule. He was king in Tirzah only two years.
- 8 In the twenty-sixth year of Asa king of Judah, Elah son of Baasha became king of Israel, and he reigned in Tirzah two years.
- 9 One day when he was at the house of Arza the palace manager, drinking himself drunk, Zimri, captain of half his chariot-force, conspired against him.
- 9 Zimri, one of his officials, who had command of half his chariots, plotted against him. Elah was in Tirzah at the time, getting drunk in the home of Arza, the man in charge of the palace at Tirzah.
- 10 Zimri slipped in, knocked Elah to the ground, and killed him. This happened in the twenty-seventh year of Asa king of Judah. Zimri then became the king.
- 10 Zimri came in, struck him down and killed him in the twenty-seventh year of Asa king of Judah. Then he succeeded him as king.
- 11 Zimri had no sooner become king than he killed everyone connected with Baasha, got rid of them all like so many stray dogs--relatives and friends alike.
- 11 As soon as he began to reign and was seated on the throne, he killed off Baasha's whole family. He did not spare a single male, whether relative or friend.
- 12 Zimri totally wiped out the family of Baasha, just as GOD's word delivered by the prophet Jehu had said--
- 12 So Zimri destroyed the whole family of Baasha, in accordance with the word of the LORD spoken against Baasha through the prophet Jehu--
- 13 wages for the sins of Baasha and his son Elah; not only for their sins but for dragging Israel into their sins and making the GOD of Israel angry with their stupid idols.
- 13 because of all the sins Baasha and his son Elah had committed and had caused Israel to commit, so that they provoked the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger by their worthless idols.
- 14 The rest of Elah's life, what he said and did, is written in The Chronicles of the Kings of Israel.
- 14 As for the other events of Elah's reign, and all he did, are they not written in the book of the annals of the kings of Israel?

- 15 Zimri was king in Tirzah for all of seven days during the twenty-seventh year of the reign of Asa king of Judah. The Israelite army was on maneuvers near the Philistine town of Gibbethon at the time.
- 15 In the twenty-seventh year of Asa king of Judah, Zimri reigned in Tirzah seven days. The army was encamped near Gibbethon, a Philistine town.
- 16 When they got the report, "Zimri has conspired against the king and killed him," right there in the camp they made Omri, commander of the army, king.
- 16 When the Israelites in the camp heard that Zimri had plotted against the king and murdered him, they proclaimed Omri, the commander of the army, king over Israel that very day there in the camp.
- 17 Omri and the army immediately left Gibbethon and attacked Tirzah.
- 17 Then Omri and all the Israelites with him withdrew from Gibbethon and laid siege to Tirzah.
- 18 When Zimri saw that he was surrounded and as good as dead, he entered the palace citadel, set the place on fire, and died.
- 18 When Zimri saw that the city was taken, he went into the citadel of the royal palace and set the palace on fire around him. So he died,
- 19 It was a fit end for his sins, for living a flagrantly evil life before GOD, walking in the footsteps of Jeroboam, sinning and then dragging Israel into his sins.
- 19 because of the sins he had committed, doing evil in the eyes of the LORD and walking in the ways of Jeroboam and in the sin he had committed and had caused Israel to commit.
- 20 As for the rest of Zimri's life, along with his infamous conspiracy, it's all written in The Chronicles of the Kings of Israel.
- 20 As for the other events of Zimri's reign, and the rebellion he carried out, are they not written in the book of the annals of the kings of Israel?
- 21 After that the people of Israel were split right down the middle: Half favored Tibni son of Ginath as king, and half wanted Omri.
- 21 Then the people of Israel were split into two factions; half supported Tibni son of Ginath for king, and the other half supported Omri.
- 22 Eventually the Omri side proved stronger than the Tibni side. Tibni ended up dead and Omri king.

- 22 But Omri's followers proved stronger than those of Tibni son of Ginath. So Tibni died and Omri became king.
- 23 Omri took over as king of Israel in the thirty-first year of the reign of Asa king of Judah. He ruled for twelve years, the first six in Tirzah.
- 23 In the thirty-first year of Asa king of Judah, Omri became king of Israel, and he reigned twelve years, six of them in Tirzah.
- 24 He then bought the hill Samaria from Shemer for 150 pounds of silver. He developed the hill and named the city that he built Samaria, after its original owner Shemer.
- 24 He bought the hill of Samaria from Shemer for two talents of silver and built a city on the hill, calling it Samaria, after Shemer, the name of the former owner of the hill.
- 25 But as far as GOD was concerned, Omri lived an evil life--set new records in evil.
- 25 But Omri did evil in the eyes of the LORD and sinned more than all those before him.
- 26 He walked in the footsteps of Jeroboam son of Nebat, who not only sinned but dragged Israel into his sins, making GOD angry--such an empty-headed, empty-hearted life!
- 26 He walked in all the ways of Jeroboam son of Nebat and in his sin, which he had caused Israel to commit, so that they provoked the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger by their worthless idols.
- 27 The rest of Omri's life, the mark he made on his times, is written in The Chronicles of the Kings of Israel.
- 27 As for the other events of Omri's reign, what he did and the things he achieved, are they not written in the book of the annals of the kings of Israel?
- 28 Omri died and was buried in Samaria. His son Ahab was the next king after him.
- 28 Omri rested with his fathers and was buried in Samaria. And Ahab his son succeeded him as king.
- 29 Ahab son of Omri became king of Israel in the thirty-eighth year of Asa king of Judah. Ahab son of Omri was king over Israel for twenty-two years. He ruled from Samaria.
- 29 In the thirty-eighth year of Asa king of Judah, Ahab son of Omri became king of Israel, and he reigned in Samaria over Israel twenty-two

years.

- 30 Ahab son of Omri did even more open evil before GOD than anyone yet--a new champion in evil!
- 30 Ahab son of Omri did more evil in the eyes of the LORD than any of those before him.
- 31 It wasn't enough for him to copy the sins of Jeroboam son of Nebat; no, he went all out, first by marrying Jezebel daughter of Ethbaal king of the Sidonians, and then by serving and worshiping the god Baal.
- 31 He not only considered it trivial to commit the sins of Jeroboam son of Nebat, but he also married Jezebel daughter of Ethbaal king of the Sidonians, and began to serve Baal and worship him.
- 32 He built a temple for Baal in Samaria, and then furnished it with an altar for Baal.
- 32 He set up an altar for Baal in the temple of Baal that he built in Samaria.
- 33 Worse, he went on and built a shrine to the sacred whore Asherah. He made the GOD of Israel angrier than all the previous kings of Israel put together.
- 33 Ahab also made an Asherah pole and did more to provoke the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger than did all the kings of Israel before him.
- 34 It was under Ahab's rule that Hiel of Bethel refortified Jericho, but at a terrible cost: He ritually sacrificed his firstborn son Abiram at the laying of the foundation, and his youngest son Segub at the setting up of the gates. This is exactly what Joshua son of Nun said would happen.
- 34 In Ahab's time, Hiel of Bethel rebuilt Jericho. He laid its foundations at the cost of his firstborn son Abiram, and he set up its gates at the cost of his youngest son Segub, in accordance with the word of the LORD spoken by Joshua son of Nun.

1 Kings 17

MSG

NIV

- 1 And then this happened: Elijah the Tishbite, from among the settlers of Gilead, confronted Ahab: "As surely as GOD lives, the God of Israel before whom I stand in obedient service, the next years are going to see a total drought--not a drop of dew or rain unless I say otherwise."

- 1 Now Elijah the Tishbite, from Tishbe in Gilead, said to Ahab, "As the LORD, the God of Israel, lives, whom I serve, there will be neither dew nor rain in the next few years except at my word."
- 2 GOD then told Elijah,
- 2 Then the word of the LORD came to Elijah:
- 3 "Get out of here, and fast. Head east and hide out at the Kerith Ravine on the other side of the Jordan River.
- 3 Leave here, turn eastward and hide in the Kerith Ravine, east of the Jordan.
- 4 You can drink fresh water from the brook; I've ordered the ravens to feed you."
- 4 You will drink from the brook, and I have ordered the ravens to feed you there."
- 5 Elijah obeyed GOD's orders. He went and camped in the Kerith canyon on the other side of the Jordan.
- 5 So he did what the LORD had told him. He went to the Kerith Ravine, east of the Jordan, and stayed there.
- 6 And sure enough, ravens brought him his meals, both breakfast and supper, and he drank from the brook.
- 6 The ravens brought him bread and meat in the morning and bread and meat in the evening, and he drank from the brook.
- 7 Eventually the brook dried up because of the drought.
- 7 Some time later the brook dried up because there had been no rain in the land.
- 8 Then GOD spoke to him:
- 8 Then the word of the LORD came to him:
- 9 "Get up and go to Zarephath in Sidon and live there. I've instructed a woman who lives there, a widow, to feed you."
- 9 Go at once to Zarephath of Sidon and stay there. I have commanded a widow in that place to supply you with food.
- 10 So he got up and went to Zarephath. As he came to the entrance of the village he met a woman, a widow, gathering firewood. He asked her, "Please, would you bring me a little water in a jug? I need a drink."
- 10 So he went to Zarephath. When he came to the town gate, a widow was there gathering sticks. He called to her and asked, "Would you bring me a little water in a jar so I may have a drink?"

- 11 As she went to get it, he called out, "And while you're at it, would you bring me something to eat?"
- 11 As she was going to get it, he called, "And bring me, please, a piece of bread."
- 12 She said, "I swear, as surely as your GOD lives, I don't have so much as a biscuit. I have a handful of flour in a jar and a little oil in a bottle; you found me scratching together just enough firewood to make a last meal for my son and me. After we eat it, we'll die."
- 12 As surely as the LORD your God lives, she replied, "I don't have any bread--only a handful of flour in a jar and a little oil in a jug. I am gathering a few sticks to take home and make a meal for myself and my son, that we may eat it--and die."
- 13 Elijah said to her, "Don't worry about a thing. Go ahead and do what you've said. But first make a small biscuit for me and bring it back here. Then go ahead and make a meal from what's left for you and your son."
- 13 Elijah said to her, "Don't be afraid. Go home and do as you have said. But first make a small cake of bread for me from what you have and bring it to me, and then make something for yourself and your son."
- 14 This is the word of the GOD of Israel: "The jar of flour will not run out and the bottle of oil will not become empty before GOD sends rain on the land and ends this drought."
- 14 For this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: "The jar of flour will not be used up and the jug of oil will not run dry until the day the LORD gives rain on the land.' "
- 15 And she went right off and did it, did just as Elijah asked. And it turned out as he said--daily food for her and her family.
- 15 She went away and did as Elijah had told her. So there was food every day for Elijah and for the woman and her family.
- 16 The jar of meal didn't run out and the bottle of oil didn't become empty: GOD's promise fulfilled to the letter, exactly as Elijah had delivered it!
- 16 For the jar of flour was not used up and the jug of oil did not run dry, in keeping with the word of the LORD spoken by Elijah.
- 17 Later on the woman's son became sick. The sickness took a turn for the worse--and then he stopped breathing.
- 17 Some time later the son of the woman who owned the house became ill. He grew worse and worse, and finally stopped breathing.

- 18 The woman said to Elijah, "Why did you ever show up here in the first place--a holy man barging in, exposing my sins, and killing my son?"
- 18 She said to Elijah, "What do you have against me, man of God? Did you come to remind me of my sin and kill my son?"
- 19 Elijah said, "Hand me your son." He then took him from her bosom, carried him up to the loft where he was staying, and laid him on his bed.
- 19 Give me your son, Elijah replied. He took him from her arms, carried him to the upper room where he was staying, and laid him on his bed.
- 20 Then he prayed, "O GOD, my God, why have you brought this terrible thing on this widow who has opened her home to me? Why have you killed her son?"
- 20 Then he cried out to the LORD, "O LORD my God, have you brought tragedy also upon this widow I am staying with, by causing her son to die?"
- 21 Three times he stretched himself out full-length on the boy, praying with all his might, "GOD, my God, put breath back into this boy's body!"
- 21 Then he stretched himself out on the boy three times and cried to the LORD, "O LORD my God, let this boy's life return to him!"
- 22 GOD listened to Elijah's prayer and put breath back into his body--he was alive!
- 22 The LORD heard Elijah's cry, and the boy's life returned to him, and he lived.
- 23 Elijah picked the boy up, carried him downstairs from the loft, and gave him to his mother. "Here's your son," said Elijah, "alive!"
- 23 Elijah picked up the child and carried him down from the room into the house. He gave him to his mother and said, "Look, your son is alive!"
- 24 The woman said to Elijah, "I see it all now--you are a holy man. When you speak, GOD speaks--a true word!"
- 24 Then the woman said to Elijah, "Now I know that you are a man of God and that the word of the LORD from your mouth is the truth."

1 Kings 18

MSG

NIV

- 1 A long time passed. Then GOD's word came to Elijah. The drought was now in its third year. The message: "Go and present yourself to Ahab; I'm about to make it rain on the country."
- 1 After a long time, in the third year, the word of the LORD came to Elijah: "Go and present yourself to Ahab, and I will send rain on the land."
- 2 Elijah set out to present himself to Ahab. The drought in Samaria at the time was most severe.
- 2 So Elijah went to present himself to Ahab. Now the famine was severe in Samaria,
- 3 Ahab called for Obadiah, who was in charge of the palace. Obadiah feared GOD--he was very devout.
- 3 and Ahab had summoned Obadiah, who was in charge of his palace. (Obadiah was a devout believer in the LORD.
- 4 Earlier, when Jezebel had tried to kill off all the prophets of GOD, Obadiah had hidden away a hundred of them in two caves, fifty in a cave, and then supplied them with food and water.
- 4 While Jezebel was killing off the LORD's prophets, Obadiah had taken a hundred prophets and hidden them in two caves, fifty in each, and had supplied them with food and water.)
- 5 Ahab ordered Obadiah, "Go through the country; locate every spring and every stream. Let's see if we can find enough grass to keep our horses and mules from dying."
- 5 Ahab had said to Obadiah, "Go through the land to all the springs and valleys. Maybe we can find some grass to keep the horses and mules alive so we will not have to kill any of our animals."
- 6 So they divided the country between them for the search--Ahab went one way, Obadiah the other.
- 6 So they divided the land they were to cover, Ahab going in one direction and Obadiah in another.
- 7 Obadiah went his way and suddenly there he was--Elijah! Obadiah fell on his knees, bowing in reverence, and exclaimed, "Is it really you--my master Elijah?"
- 7 As Obadiah was walking along, Elijah met him. Obadiah recognized him, bowed down to the ground, and said, "Is it really you, my lord Elijah?"
- 8 "Yes," said Elijah, "the real me. Now go and tell your boss, 'I've seen Elijah.'"

- 8 Yes, he replied. "Go tell your master, 'Elijah is here.' "
- 9 Obadiah said, "But what have I done to deserve this? Ahab will kill me.
- 9 What have I done wrong, asked Obadiah, "that you are handing your servant over to Ahab to be put to death?
- 10 As surely as your GOD lives, there isn't a country or kingdom where my master hasn't sent out search parties looking for you. And if they said, 'We can't find him; we've looked high and low,' he would make that country or kingdom swear that you were not to be found.
- 10 As surely as the LORD your God lives, there is not a nation or kingdom where my master has not sent someone to look for you. And whenever a nation or kingdom claimed you were not there, he made them swear they could not find you.
- 11 And now you're telling me, 'Go and tell your master Elijah's found!'
- 11 But now you tell me to go to my master and say, 'Elijah is here.'
- 12 The minute I leave you the Spirit of GOD will whisk you away to who knows where. Then when I report to Ahab, you'll have disappeared and Ahab will kill me. And I've served GOD devoutly since I was a boy!
- 12 I don't know where the Spirit of the LORD may carry you when I leave you. If I go and tell Ahab and he doesn't find you, he will kill me. Yet I your servant have worshiped the LORD since my youth.
- 13 Hasn't anyone told you what I did when Jezebel was out to kill the prophets of GOD, how I risked my life by hiding a hundred of them, fifty to a cave, and made sure they got food and water?
- 13 Haven't you heard, my lord, what I did while Jezebel was killing the prophets of the LORD? I hid a hundred of the LORD's prophets in two caves, fifty in each, and supplied them with food and water.
- 14 And now you're telling me to draw attention to myself by announcing to my master, 'Elijah's been found.' Why, he'll kill me for sure."
- 14 And now you tell me to go to my master and say, 'Elijah is here.' He will kill me!"
- 15 Elijah said, "As surely as GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies lives, and before whom I take my stand, I'll meet with your master face to face this very day."
- 15 Elijah said, "As the LORD Almighty lives, whom I serve, I will surely present myself to Ahab today."

- 16 So Obadiah went straight to Ahab and told him. And Ahab went out to meet Elijah.
- 16 So Obadiah went to meet Ahab and told him, and Ahab went to meet Elijah.
- 17 The moment Ahab saw Elijah he said, "So it's you, old troublemaker!"
- 17 When he saw Elijah, he said to him, "Is that you, you troubler of Israel?"
- 18 "It's not I who has caused trouble in Israel," said Elijah, "but you and your government--you've dumped GOD's ways and commands and run off after the local gods, the Baals.
- 18 I have not made trouble for Israel, Elijah replied. "But you and your father's family have. You have abandoned the LORD's commands and have followed the Baals.
- 19 Here's what I want you to do: Assemble everyone in Israel at Mount Carmel. And make sure that the special pets of Jezebel, the four hundred and fifty prophets of the local gods, the Baals, and the four hundred prophets of the whore goddess Asherah, are there."
- 19 Now summon the people from all over Israel to meet me on Mount Carmel. And bring the four hundred and fifty prophets of Baal and the four hundred prophets of Asherah, who eat at Jezebel's table."
- 20 So Ahab summoned everyone in Israel, particularly the prophets, to Mount Carmel.
- 20 So Ahab sent word throughout all Israel and assembled the prophets on Mount Carmel.
- 21 Elijah challenged the people: "How long are you going to sit on the fence? If GOD is the real God, follow him; if it's Baal, follow him. Make up your minds!" Nobody said a word; nobody made a move.
- 21 Elijah went before the people and said, "How long will you waver between two opinions? If the LORD is God, follow him; but if Baal is God, follow him." But the people said nothing.
- 22 Then Elijah said, "I'm the only prophet of GOD left in Israel; and there are four hundred and fifty prophets of Baal.
- 22 Then Elijah said to them, "I am the only one of the LORD's prophets left, but Baal has four hundred and fifty prophets.
- 23 Let the Baal prophets bring up two oxen; let them pick one, butcher it, and lay it out on an altar on firewood--but don't ignite it. I'll take the

- other ox, cut it up, and lay it on the wood. But neither will I light the fire.
- 23 Get two bulls for us. Let them choose one for themselves, and let them cut it into pieces and put it on the wood but not set fire to it. I will prepare the other bull and put it on the wood but not set fire to it.
- 24 Then you pray to your gods and I'll pray to GOD. The god who answers with fire will prove to be, in fact, God." All the people agreed: "A good plan--do it!"
- 24 Then you call on the name of your god, and I will call on the name of the LORD. The god who answers by fire--he is God." Then all the people said, "What you say is good."
- 25 Elijah told the Baal prophets, "Choose your ox and prepare it. You go first, you're the majority. Then pray to your god, but don't light the fire."
- 25 Elijah said to the prophets of Baal, "Choose one of the bulls and prepare it first, since there are so many of you. Call on the name of your god, but do not light the fire."
- 26 So they took the ox he had given them, prepared it for the altar, then prayed to Baal. They prayed all morning long, "O Baal, answer us!" But nothing happened--not so much as a whisper of breeze. Desperate, they jumped and stomped on the altar they had made.
- 26 So they took the bull given them and prepared it. Then they called on the name of Baal from morning till noon. "O Baal, answer us!" they shouted. But there was no response; no one answered. And they danced around the altar they had made.
- 27 By noon, Elijah had started making fun of them, taunting, "Call a little louder--he is a god, after all. Maybe he's off meditating somewhere or other, or maybe he's gotten involved in a project, or maybe he's on vacation. You don't suppose he's overslept, do you, and needs to be waked up?"
- 27 At noon Elijah began to taunt them. "Shout louder!" he said. "Surely he is a god! Perhaps he is deep in thought, or busy, or traveling. Maybe he is sleeping and must be awakened."
- 28 They prayed louder and louder, cutting themselves with swords and knives--a ritual common to them--until they were covered with blood.
- 28 So they shouted louder and slashed themselves with swords and spears, as was their custom, until their blood flowed.

29 This went on until well past noon. They used every religious trick and strategy they knew to make something happen on the altar, but nothing happened--not so much as a whisper, not a flicker of response.

29 Midday passed, and they continued their frantic prophesying until the time for the evening sacrifice. But there was no response, no one answered, no one paid attention.

30 Then Elijah told the people, "Enough of that--it's my turn. Gather around." And they gathered. He then put the altar back together for by now it was in ruins.

30 Then Elijah said to all the people, "Come here to me." They came to him, and he repaired the altar of the LORD, which was in ruins.

31 Elijah took twelve stones, one for each of the tribes of Jacob, the same Jacob to whom GOD had said, "From now on your name is Israel."

31 Elijah took twelve stones, one for each of the tribes descended from Jacob, to whom the word of the LORD had come, saying, "Your name shall be Israel."

32 He built the stones into the altar in honor of GOD. Then Elijah dug a fairly wide trench around the altar.

32 With the stones he built an altar in the name of the LORD, and he dug a trench around it large enough to hold two seahs of seed.

33 He laid firewood on the altar, cut up the ox, put it on the wood, and said, "Fill four buckets with water and drench both the ox and the firewood."

33 He arranged the wood, cut the bull into pieces and laid it on the wood. Then he said to them, "Fill four large jars with water and pour it on the offering and on the wood."

34 Then he said, "Do it again," and they did it. Then he said, "Do it a third time,"

34 Do it again, he said, and they did it again. "Do it a third time," he ordered, and they did it the third time.

35 and they did it a third time. The altar was drenched and the trench was filled with water.

35 The water ran down around the altar and even filled the trench.

36 When it was time for the sacrifice to be offered, Elijah the prophet came up and prayed, "O GOD, God of Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, make it known right now that you are God in Israel, that I am your servant, and that I'm doing what I'm doing under your orders."

- 36 At the time of sacrifice, the prophet Elijah stepped forward and prayed:
"O LORD, God of Abraham, Isaac and Israel, let it be known today that
you are God in Israel and that I am your servant and have done all these
things at your command.
- 37 Answer me, GOD; O answer me and reveal to this people that you are
GOD, the true God, and that you are giving these people another chance
at repentance."
- 37 Answer me, O LORD, answer me, so these people will know that you,
O LORD, are God, and that you are turning their hearts back again."
- 38 Immediately the fire of GOD fell and burned up the offering, the wood,
the stones, the dirt, and even the water in the trench.
- 38 Then the fire of the LORD fell and burned up the sacrifice, the wood,
the stones and the soil, and also licked up the water in the trench.
- 39 All the people saw it happen and fell on their faces in awed worship,
exclaiming, "GOD is the true God! GOD is the true God!"
- 39 When all the people saw this, they fell prostrate and cried, "The LORD--
he is God! The LORD--he is God!"
- 40 Elijah told them, "Grab the Baal prophets! Don't let one get away!"
They grabbed them. Elijah had them taken down to the Brook Kishon
and they massacred the lot.
- 40 Then Elijah commanded them, "Seize the prophets of Baal. Don't let
anyone get away!" They seized them, and Elijah had them brought down
to the Kishon Valley and slaughtered there.
- 41 Elijah said to Ahab, "Up on your feet! Eat and drink--celebrate! Rain is
on the way; I hear it coming."
- 41 And Elijah said to Ahab, "Go, eat and drink, for there is the sound of a
heavy rain."
- 42 Ahab did it: got up and ate and drank. Meanwhile, Elijah climbed to the
top of Carmel, bowed deeply in prayer, his face between his knees.
- 42 So Ahab went off to eat and drink, but Elijah climbed to the top of
Carmel, bent down to the ground and put his face between his knees.
- 43 Then he said to his young servant, "On your feet now! Look toward the
sea." He went, looked, and reported back, "I don't see a thing." "Keep
looking," said Elijah, "seven times if necessary."
- 43 Go and look toward the sea, he told his servant. And he went up and
looked. "There is nothing there," he said. Seven times Elijah said, "Go

back."

44 And sure enough, the seventh time he said, "Oh yes, a cloud! But very small, no bigger than someone's hand, rising out of the sea." "Quickly then, on your way. Tell Ahab, 'Saddle up and get down from the mountain before the rain stops you.'"

44 The seventh time the servant reported, "A cloud as small as a man's hand is rising from the sea." So Elijah said, "Go and tell Ahab, 'Hitch up your chariot and go down before the rain stops you.' "

45 Things happened fast. The sky grew black with wind-driven clouds, and then a huge cloudburst of rain, with Ahab hightailing it in his chariot for Jezreel.

45 Meanwhile, the sky grew black with clouds, the wind rose, a heavy rain came on and Ahab rode off to Jezreel.

46 And GOD strengthened Elijah mightily. Pulling up his robe and tying it around his waist, Elijah ran in front of Ahab's chariot until they reached Jezreel.

46 The power of the LORD came upon Elijah and, tucking his cloak into his belt, he ran ahead of Ahab all the way to Jezreel.

1 Kings 19

MSG

NIV

1 Ahab reported to Jezebel everything that Elijah had done, including the massacre of the prophets.

1 Now Ahab told Jezebel everything Elijah had done and how he had killed all the prophets with the sword.

2 Jezebel immediately sent a messenger to Elijah with her threat: "The gods will get you for this and I'll get even with you! By this time tomorrow you'll be as dead as any one of those prophets."

2 So Jezebel sent a messenger to Elijah to say, "May the gods deal with me, be it ever so severely, if by this time tomorrow I do not make your life like that of one of them."

3 When Elijah saw how things were, he ran for dear life to Beersheba, far in the south of Judah. He left his young servant there

3 Elijah was afraid and ran for his life. When he came to Beersheba in Judah, he left his servant there,

4 and then went on into the desert another day's journey. He came to a lone broom bush and collapsed in its shade, wanting in the worst way to be done with it all--to just die: "Enough of this, GOD! Take my life--I'm ready to join my ancestors in the grave!"

4 while he himself went a day's journey into the desert. He came to a broom tree, sat down under it and prayed that he might die. "I have had enough, LORD," he said. "Take my life; I am no better than my ancestors."

5 Exhausted, he fell asleep under the lone broom bush. Suddenly an angel shook him awake and said, "Get up and eat!"

5 Then he lay down under the tree and fell asleep. All at once an angel touched him and said, "Get up and eat."

6 He looked around and, to his surprise, right by his head were a loaf of bread baked on some coals and a jug of water. He ate the meal and went back to sleep.

6 He looked around, and there by his head was a cake of bread baked over hot coals, and a jar of water. He ate and drank and then lay down again.

7 The angel of GOD came back, shook him awake again, and said, "Get up and eat some more--you've got a long journey ahead of you."

7 The angel of the LORD came back a second time and touched him and said, "Get up and eat, for the journey is too much for you."

8 He got up, ate and drank his fill, and set out. Nourished by that meal, he walked forty days and nights, all the way to the mountain of God, to Horeb.

8 So he got up and ate and drank. Strengthened by that food, he traveled forty days and forty nights until he reached Horeb, the mountain of God.

9 When he got there, he crawled into a cave and went to sleep. Then the word of GOD came to him: "So Elijah, what are you doing here?"

9 There he went into a cave and spent the night. And the word of the LORD came to him: "What are you doing here, Elijah?"

10 "I've been working my heart out for the GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies," said Elijah. "The people of Israel have abandoned your covenant, destroyed the places of worship, and murdered your prophets. I'm the only one left, and now they're trying to kill me."

- 10 He replied, "I have been very zealous for the LORD God Almighty. The Israelites have rejected your covenant, broken down your altars, and put your prophets to death with the sword. I am the only one left, and now they are trying to kill me too."
- 11 Then he was told, "Go, stand on the mountain at attention before GOD. GOD will pass by." A hurricane wind ripped through the mountains and shattered the rocks before GOD, but GOD wasn't to be found in the wind; after the wind an earthquake, but GOD wasn't in the earthquake;
- 11 The LORD said, "Go out and stand on the mountain in the presence of the LORD, for the LORD is about to pass by." Then a great and powerful wind tore the mountains apart and shattered the rocks before the LORD, but the LORD was not in the wind. After the wind there was an earthquake, but the LORD was not in the earthquake.
- 12 and after the earthquake fire, but GOD wasn't in the fire; and after the fire a gentle and quiet whisper.
- 12 After the earthquake came a fire, but the LORD was not in the fire. And after the fire came a gentle whisper.
- 13 When Elijah heard the quiet voice, he muffled his face with his great cloak, went to the mouth of the cave, and stood there. A quiet voice asked, "So Elijah, now tell me, what are you doing here?"
- 13 When Elijah heard it, he pulled his cloak over his face and went out and stood at the mouth of the cave. Then a voice said to him, "What are you doing here, Elijah?"
- 14 Elijah said it again, "I've been working my heart out for GOD, the GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, because the people of Israel have abandoned your covenant, destroyed your places of worship, and murdered your prophets. I'm the only one left, and now they're trying to kill me."
- 14 He replied, "I have been very zealous for the LORD God Almighty. The Israelites have rejected your covenant, broken down your altars, and put your prophets to death with the sword. I am the only one left, and now they are trying to kill me too."
- 15 GOD said, "Go back the way you came through the desert to Damascus. When you get there anoint Hazael; make him king over Aram.
- 15 The LORD said to him, "Go back the way you came, and go to the Desert of Damascus. When you get there, anoint Hazael king over Aram.

- 16 Then anoint Jehu son of Nimshi; make him king over Israel. Finally, anoint Elisha son of Shaphat from Abel Meholah to succeed you as prophet.
- 16 Also, anoint Jehu son of Nimshi king over Israel, and anoint Elisha son of Shaphat from Abel Meholah to succeed you as prophet.
- 17 Anyone who escapes death by Hazael will be killed by Jehu; and anyone who escapes death by Jehu will be killed by Elisha.
- 17 Jehu will put to death any who escape the sword of Hazael, and Elisha will put to death any who escape the sword of Jehu.
- 18 Meanwhile, I'm preserving for myself seven thousand souls: the knees that haven't bowed to the god Baal, the mouths that haven't kissed his image."
- 18 Yet I reserve seven thousand in Israel--all whose knees have not bowed down to Baal and all whose mouths have not kissed him."
- 19 Elijah went straight out and found Elisha son of Shaphat in a field where there were twelve pairs of yoked oxen at work plowing; Elisha was in charge of the twelfth pair. Elijah went up to him and threw his cloak over him.
- 19 So Elijah went from there and found Elisha son of Shaphat. He was plowing with twelve yoke of oxen, and he himself was driving the twelfth pair. Elijah went up to him and threw his cloak around him.
- 20 Elisha deserted the oxen, ran after Elijah, and said, "Please! Let me kiss my father and mother good-bye--then I'll follow you." "Go ahead," said Elijah, "but, mind you, don't forget what I've just done to you."
- 20 Elisha then left his oxen and ran after Elijah. "Let me kiss my father and mother good-by," he said, "and then I will come with you." "Go back," Elijah replied. "What have I done to you?"
- 21 So Elisha left; he took his yoke of oxen and butchered them. He made a fire with the plow and tackle and then boiled the meat--a true farewell meal for the family. Then he left and followed Elijah, becoming his right-hand man.
- 21 So Elisha left him and went back. He took his yoke of oxen and slaughtered them. He burned the plowing equipment to cook the meat and gave it to the people, and they ate. Then he set out to follow Elijah and became his attendant.

1 Kings 20

MSG

NIV

- 1 At about this same time Ben-Hadad king of Aram mustered his troops. He recruited in addition thirty-two local sheiks, all outfitted with horses and chariots. He set out in force and surrounded Samaria, ready to make war.
- 1 Now Ben-Hadad king of Aram mustered his entire army. Accompanied by thirty-two kings with their horses and chariots, he went up and besieged Samaria and attacked it.
- 2 He sent an envoy into the city to set his terms before Ahab king of Israel:
- 2 He sent messengers into the city to Ahab king of Israel, saying, "This is what Ben-Hadad says:
- 3 "Ben-Hadad lays claim to your silver and gold, and to the pick of your wives and sons."
- 3 'Your silver and gold are mine, and the best of your wives and children are mine.' "
- 4 The king of Israel accepted the terms: "As you say, distinguished lord; I and everything I have is yours."
- 4 The king of Israel answered, "Just as you say, my lord the king. I and all I have are yours."
- 5 But then the envoy returned a second time, saying, "On second thought, I want it all--your silver and gold and all your wives and sons. Hand them over--the whole works.
- 5 The messengers came again and said, "This is what Ben- Hadad says: 'I sent to demand your silver and gold, your wives and your children.
- 6 I'll give you twenty-four hours; then my servants will arrive to search your palace and the houses of your officials and loot them; anything that strikes their fancy, they'll take."
- 6 But about this time tomorrow I am going to send my officials to search your palace and the houses of your officials. They will seize everything you value and carry it away.' "
- 7 The king of Israel called a meeting of all his tribal elders. He said, "Look at this--outrageous! He's just looking for trouble. He means to clean me

- out, demanding all my women and children. And after I already agreed to pay him off handsomely!"
- 7 The king of Israel summoned all the elders of the land and said to them, "See how this man is looking for trouble! When he sent for my wives and my children, my silver and my gold, I did not refuse him."
- 8 The elders, backed by the people, said, "Don't cave in to him. Don't give an inch."
- 8 The elders and the people all answered, "Don't listen to him or agree to his demands."
- 9 So he sent an envoy to Ben-Hadad, "Tell my distinguished lord, 'I agreed to the terms you delivered the first time, but this I can't do--this I won't do!'" The envoy went back and delivered the answer.
- 9 So he replied to Ben-Hadad's messengers, "Tell my lord the king, 'Your servant will do all you demanded the first time, but this demand I cannot meet.' " They left and took the answer back to Ben-Hadad.
- 10 Ben-Hadad shot back his response: "May the gods do their worst to me, and then worse again, if there'll be anything left of Samaria but rubble."
- 10 Then Ben-Hadad sent another message to Ahab: "May the gods deal with me, be it ever so severely, if enough dust remains in Samaria to give each of my men a handful."
- 11 The king of Israel countered, "Think about it--it's easier to start a fight than end one."
- 11 The king of Israel answered, "Tell him: 'One who puts on his armor should not boast like one who takes it off.' "
- 12 It happened that when Ben-Hadad heard this retort he was into some heavy drinking, boozing it up with the sheiks in their field shelters. Drunkenly, he ordered his henchmen, "Go after them!" And they attacked the city.
- 12 Ben-Hadad heard this message while he and the kings were drinking in their tents, and he ordered his men: "Prepare to attack." So they prepared to attack the city.
- 13 Just then a lone prophet approached Ahab king of Israel and said, "GOD's word: Have you taken a good look at this mob? Well, look again--I'm turning it over to you this very day. And you'll know, beyond the shadow of a doubt, that I am GOD."

- 13 Meanwhile a prophet came to Ahab king of Israel and announced, "This is what the LORD says: 'Do you see this vast army? I will give it into your hand today, and then you will know that I am the LORD.' "
- 14 Ahab said, "Really? And who is going to make this happen?" GOD said, "The young commandos of the regional chiefs." "And who," said Ahab, "will strike the first blow?" GOD said, "You."
- 14 But who will do this? asked Ahab. The prophet replied, "This is what the LORD says: 'The young officers of the provincial commanders will do it.' " "And who will start the battle?" he asked. The prophet answered, "You will."
- 15 Ahab looked over the commandos of the regional chiefs; he counted 232. Then he assessed the available troops--7,000.
- 15 So Ahab summoned the young officers of the provincial commanders, 232 men. Then he assembled the rest of the Israelites, 7,000 in all.
- 16 At noon they set out after Ben-Hadad who, with his allies, the thirty-two sheiks, was busy at serious drinking in the field shelters.
- 16 They set out at noon while Ben-Hadad and the 32 kings allied with him were in their tents getting drunk.
- 17 The commandos of the regional chiefs made up the vanguard. A report was brought to Ben-Hadad: "Men are on their way from Samaria."
- 17 The young officers of the provincial commanders went out first. Now Ben-Hadad had dispatched scouts, who reported, "Men are advancing from Samaria."
- 18 He said, "If they've come in peace, take them alive as hostages; if they've come to fight, the same--take them alive as hostages."
- 18 He said, "If they have come out for peace, take them alive; if they have come out for war, take them alive."
- 19 The commandos poured out of the city with the full army behind them.
- 19 The young officers of the provincial commanders marched out of the city with the army behind them
- 20 They hit hard in hand-to-hand combat. The Arameans scattered from the field, with Israel hard on their heels. But Ben-Hadad king of Aram got away on horseback, along with his cavalry.
- 20 and each one struck down his opponent. At that, the Arameans fled, with the Israelites in pursuit. But Ben-Hadad king of Aram escaped on horseback with some of his horsemen.

- 21 The king of Israel cut down both horses and chariots--an enormous defeat for Aram.
- 21 The king of Israel advanced and overpowered the horses and chariots and inflicted heavy losses on the Arameans.
- 22 Sometime later the prophet came to the king of Israel and said, "On the alert now--build up your army, assess your capabilities, and see what has to be done. Before the year is out, the king of Aram will be back in force."
- 22 Afterward, the prophet came to the king of Israel and said, "Strengthen your position and see what must be done, because next spring the king of Aram will attack you again."
- 23 Meanwhile the advisors to the king of Aram said, "Their god is a god of the mountains--we don't stand a chance against them there. So let's engage them on the plain where we'll have the advantage."
- 23 Meanwhile, the officials of the king of Aram advised him, "Their gods are gods of the hills. That is why they were too strong for us. But if we fight them on the plains, surely we will be stronger than they."
- 24 Here's the strategy: Remove each sheik from his place of leadership and replace him with a seasoned officer.
- 24 Do this: Remove all the kings from their commands and replace them with other officers.
- 25 Then recruit a fighting force equivalent in size to the army that deserted earlier--horse for horse, chariot for chariot. And we'll fight them on the plain--we're sure to prove stronger than they are." It sounded good to the king; he did what they advised.
- 25 You must also raise an army like the one you lost--horse for horse and chariot for chariot--so we can fight Israel on the plains. Then surely we will be stronger than they." He agreed with them and acted accordingly.
- 26 As the new year approached, Ben-Hadad rallied Aram and they went up to Aphek to make war on Israel.
- 26 The next spring Ben-Hadad mustered the Arameans and went up to Aphek to fight against Israel.
- 27 The Israelite army prepared to fight and took the field to meet Aram. They moved into battle formation before Aram in two camps, like two flocks of goats. The plain was seething with Arameans.

- 27 When the Israelites were also mustered and given provisions, they marched out to meet them. The Israelites camped opposite them like two small flocks of goats, while the Arameans covered the countryside.
- 28 Just then a holy man approached the king of Israel saying, "This is GOD's word: Because Aram said, 'GOD is a god of the mountains and not a god of the valleys,' I'll hand over this huge mob of an army to you. Then you'll know that I am GOD."
- 28 The man of God came up and told the king of Israel, "This is what the LORD says: 'Because the Arameans think the LORD is a god of the hills and not a god of the valleys, I will deliver this vast army into your hands, and you will know that I am the LORD.' "
- 29 The two armies were poised in a standoff for seven days. On the seventh day fighting broke out. The Israelites killed 100,000 of the Aramean infantry in one day.
- 29 For seven days they camped opposite each other, and on the seventh day the battle was joined. The Israelites inflicted a hundred thousand casualties on the Aramean foot soldiers in one day.
- 30 The rest of the army ran for their lives back to the city, Aphek, only to have the city wall fall on 27,000 of the survivors. Ben-Hadad escaped into the city and hid in a closet.
- 30 The rest of them escaped to the city of Aphek, where the wall collapsed on twenty-seven thousand of them. And Ben-Hadad fled to the city and hid in an inner room.
- 31 Then his advisors told him, "Look, we've heard that the kings of Israel play by the rules; let's dress in old gunnysacks, carry a white flag of truce, and present ourselves to the king of Israel on the chance that he'll let you live."
- 31 His officials said to him, "Look, we have heard that the kings of the house of Israel are merciful. Let us go to the king of Israel with sackcloth around our waists and ropes around our heads. Perhaps he will spare your life."
- 32 So that's what they did. They dressed in old gunnysacks and carried a white flag, and came to the king of Israel saying, "Your servant Ben-Hadad said, 'Please let me live.'" Ahab said, "You mean to tell me that he's still alive? If he's alive, he's my brother."

- 32 Wearing sackcloth around their waists and ropes around their heads, they went to the king of Israel and said, "Your servant Ben-Hadad says: 'Please let me live.' " The king answered, "Is he still alive? He is my brother."
- 33 The men took this as a good sign and concluded that everything was going to be all right: "Ben-Hadad is most certainly your brother!" The king said, "Go and get him." They went and brought him back by chariot.
- 33 The men took this as a good sign and were quick to pick up his word. "Yes, your brother Ben-Hadad!" they said. "Go and get him," the king said. When Ben-Hadad came out, Ahab had him come up into his chariot.
- 34 Ahab said, "I am prepared to return the cities that my father took from your father. And you can set up your headquarters in Damascus just as my father did in Samaria; I'll send you home under safe conduct." Then he made a covenant with him and sent him off.
- 34 I will return the cities my father took from your father, Ben-Hadad offered. "You may set up your own market areas in Damascus, as my father did in Samaria." Ahab said, "On the basis of a treaty I will set you free." So he made a treaty with him, and let him go.
- 35 A man who was one of the prophets said to a bystander, "Hit me; wound me. Do it for GOD's sake--it's his command. Hit me; wound me." But the man wouldn't do it.
- 35 By the word of the LORD one of the sons of the prophets said to his companion, "Strike me with your weapon," but the man refused.
- 36 So he told him, "Because you wouldn't obey GOD's orders, as soon as you leave me a lion will attack you." No sooner had the man left his side than a lion met him and attacked.
- 36 So the prophet said, "Because you have not obeyed the LORD, as soon as you leave me a lion will kill you." And after the man went away, a lion found him and killed him.
- 37 He then found another man and said, "Hit me; wound me." That man did it--hit him hard in the face, drawing blood.
- 37 The prophet found another man and said, "Strike me, please." So the man struck him and wounded him.

- 38 Then the prophet went and took a position along the road, with a bandage over his eyes, waiting for the king.
- 38 Then the prophet went and stood by the road waiting for the king. He disguised himself with his headband down over his eyes.
- 39 It wasn't long before the king happened by. The man cried out to the king, "Your servant was in the thick of the battle when a man showed up and turned over a prisoner to me, saying, 'Guard this man with your life; if he turns up missing you'll pay dearly.'
- 39 As the king passed by, the prophet called out to him, "Your servant went into the thick of the battle, and someone came to me with a captive and said, 'Guard this man. If he is missing, it will be your life for his life, or you must pay a talent of silver.'
- 40 But I got busy doing one thing after another and the next time I looked he was gone." The king of Israel said, "You've just pronounced your own verdict."
- 40 While your servant was busy here and there, the man disappeared." "That is your sentence," the king of Israel said. "You have pronounced it yourself."
- 41 At that, the man ripped the bandage off his eyes and the king recognized who he was--one of the prophets!
- 41 Then the prophet quickly removed the headband from his eyes, and the king of Israel recognized him as one of the prophets.
- 42 The man said to the king, "GOD's word: Because you let a man go who was under sentence by GOD, it's now your life for his, your people for his."
- 42 He said to the king, "This is what the LORD says: 'You have set free a man I had determined should die. Therefore it is your life for his life, your people for his people.' "
- 43 The king of Israel went home in a sulk. He arrived in Samaria in a very bad mood.
- 43 Sullen and angry, the king of Israel went to his palace in Samaria.

1 Kings 21

MSG

NIV

- 1 And then, to top it off, came this: Naboth the Jezreelite owned a vineyard in Jezreel that bordered the palace of Ahab king of Samaria.
- 1 Some time later there was an incident involving a vineyard belonging to Naboth the Jezreelite. The vineyard was in Jezreel, close to the palace of Ahab king of Samaria.
- 2 One day Ahab spoke to Naboth, saying, "Give me your vineyard so I can use it as a kitchen garden; it's right next to my house--so convenient. In exchange I'll give you a far better vineyard, or if you'd prefer I'll pay you money for it."
- 2 Ahab said to Naboth, "Let me have your vineyard to use for a vegetable garden, since it is close to my palace. In exchange I will give you a better vineyard or, if you prefer, I will pay you whatever it is worth."
- 3 But Naboth told Ahab, "Not on your life! So help me GOD, I'd never sell the family farm to you!"
- 3 But Naboth replied, "The LORD forbid that I should give you the inheritance of my fathers."
- 4 Ahab went home in a black mood, sulking over Naboth the Jezreelite's words, "I'll never turn over my family inheritance to you." He went to bed, stuffed his face in his pillow, and refused to eat.
- 4 So Ahab went home, sullen and angry because Naboth the Jezreelite had said, "I will not give you the inheritance of my fathers." He lay on his bed sulking and refused to eat.
- 5 Jezebel his wife came to him. She said, "What's going on? Why are you so out of sorts and refusing to eat?"
- 5 His wife Jezebel came in and asked him, "Why are you so sullen? Why won't you eat?"
- 6 He told her, "Because I spoke to Naboth the Jezreelite. I said, 'Give me your vineyard--I'll pay you for it or, if you'd rather, I'll give you another vineyard in exchange.' And he said, 'I'll never give you my vineyard.'"
- 6 He answered her, "Because I said to Naboth the Jezreelite, 'Sell me your vineyard; or if you prefer, I will give you another vineyard in its place.' But he said, 'I will not give you my vineyard.' "
- 7 Jezebel said, "Is this any way for a king of Israel to act? Aren't you the boss? On your feet! Eat! Cheer up! I'll take care of this; I'll get the vineyard of this Naboth the Jezreelite for you."

- 7 Jezebel his wife said, "Is this how you act as king over Israel? Get up and eat! Cheer up. I'll get you the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite."
- 8 She wrote letters over Ahab's signature, stamped them with his official seal, and sent them to the elders in Naboth's city and to the civic leaders.
- 8 So she wrote letters in Ahab's name, placed his seal on them, and sent them to the elders and nobles who lived in Naboth's city with him.
- 9 She wrote "Call for a fast day and put Naboth at the head table.
- 9 In those letters she wrote: "Proclaim a day of fasting and seat Naboth in a prominent place among the people.
- 10 Then seat a couple of stool pigeons across from him who, in front of everybody will say, 'You! You blasphemed God and the king!' Then they'll throw him out and stone him to death."
- 10 But seat two scoundrels opposite him and have them testify that he has cursed both God and the king. Then take him out and stone him to death."
- 11 And they did it. The men of the city--the elders and civic leaders--followed Jezebel's instructions that she wrote in the letters sent to them.
- 11 So the elders and nobles who lived in Naboth's city did as Jezebel directed in the letters she had written to them.
- 12 They called for a fast day and seated Naboth at the head table.
- 12 They proclaimed a fast and seated Naboth in a prominent place among the people.
- 13 Then they brought in two stool pigeons and seated them opposite Naboth. In front of everybody the two degenerates accused him, "He blasphemed God and the king!" The company threw him out in the street, stoned him mercilessly, and he died.
- 13 Then two scoundrels came and sat opposite him and brought charges against Naboth before the people, saying, "Naboth has cursed both God and the king." So they took him outside the city and stoned him to death.
- 14 When Jezebel got word that Naboth had been stoned to death, she told Ahab, "Go for it, Ahab--take the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite for your own, the vineyard he refused to sell you. Naboth is no more; Naboth is dead."
- 14 Then they sent word to Jezebel: "Naboth has been stoned and is dead."
- 15 (SEE 21:14)

- 15 As soon as Jezebel heard that Naboth had been stoned to death, she said to Ahab, "Get up and take possession of the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite that he refused to sell you. He is no longer alive, but dead."
- 16 The minute Ahab heard that Naboth was dead, he set out for the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite and claimed it for his own.
- 16 When Ahab heard that Naboth was dead, he got up and went down to take possession of Naboth's vineyard.
- 17 Then GOD stepped in and spoke to Elijah the Tishbite,
- 17 Then the word of the LORD came to Elijah the Tishbite:
- 18 "On your feet; go down and confront Ahab of Samaria, king of Israel. You'll find him in the vineyard of Naboth; he's gone there to claim it as his own.
- 18 Go down to meet Ahab king of Israel, who rules in Samaria. He is now in Naboth's vineyard, where he has gone to take possession of it.
- 19 Say this to him: 'GOD's word: What's going on here? First murder, then theft?' Then tell him, 'GOD's verdict: The very spot where the dogs lapped up Naboth's blood, they'll lap up your blood--that's right, your blood.'"
- 19 Say to him, 'This is what the LORD says: Have you not murdered a man and seized his property?' Then say to him, 'This is what the LORD says: In the place where dogs licked up Naboth's blood, dogs will lick up your blood--yes, yours!' "
- 20 Ahab answered Elijah, "My enemy! So, you've run me down!" "Yes, I've found you out," said Elijah. "And because you've bought into the business of evil, defying GOD.
- 20 Ahab said to Elijah, "So you have found me, my enemy!" "I have found you," he answered, "because you have sold yourself to do evil in the eyes of the LORD.
- 21 'I will most certainly bring doom upon you, make mincemeat of your descendants, kill off every sorry male wretch who's even remotely connected with the name Ahab.
- 21 'I am going to bring disaster on you. I will consume your descendants and cut off from Ahab every last male in Israel--slave or free.
- 22 And I'll bring down on you the same fate that fell on Jeroboam son of Nebat and Baasha son of Ahijah--you've made me that angry by making Israel sin."

- 22 I will make your house like that of Jeroboam son of Nebat and that of Baasha son of Ahijah, because you have provoked me to anger and have caused Israel to sin.'
- 23 As for Jezebel, GOD said, "Dogs will fight over the flesh of Jezebel all over Jezreel.
- 23 And also concerning Jezebel the LORD says: 'Dogs will devour Jezebel by the wall of Jezreel.'
- 24 Anyone tainted by Ahab who dies in the city will be eaten by stray dogs; corpses in the country will be eaten by carrion crows."
- 24 Dogs will eat those belonging to Ahab who die in the city, and the birds of the air will feed on those who die in the country.
- 25 Ahab, pushed by his wife Jezebel and in open defiance of GOD, set an all-time record in making big business of evil.
- 25 (There was never a man like Ahab, who sold himself to do evil in the eyes of the LORD, urged on by Jezebel his wife.
- 26 He indulged in outrageous obscenities in the world of idols, copying the Amorites whom GOD had earlier kicked out of Israelite territory.
- 26 He behaved in the vilest manner by going after idols, like the Amorites the LORD drove out before Israel.)
- 27 When Ahab heard what Elijah had to say, he ripped his clothes to shreds, dressed in penitential rough burlap, and fasted. He even slept in coarse burlap pajamas. He tiptoed around, quiet as a mouse.
- 27 When Ahab heard these words, he tore his clothes, put on sackcloth and fasted. He lay in sackcloth and went around meekly.
- 28 Then GOD spoke to Elijah the Tishbite:
- 28 Then the word of the LORD came to Elijah the Tishbite:
- 29 "Do you see how penitently submissive Ahab has become to me? Because of his repentance I'll not bring the doom during his lifetime; Ahab's son, though, will get it."
- 29 Have you noticed how Ahab has humbled himself before me? Because he has humbled himself, I will not bring this disaster in his day, but I will bring it on his house in the days of his son.

1 Kings 22

MSG

NIV

- 1 They enjoyed three years of peace--no fighting between Aram and Israel.
- 1 For three years there was no war between Aram and Israel.
- 2 In the third year, Jehoshaphat king of Judah had a meeting with the king of Israel.
- 2 But in the third year Jehoshaphat king of Judah went down to see the king of Israel.
- 3 Israel's king remarked to his aides, "Do you realize that Ramoth Gilead belongs to us, and we're sitting around on our hands instead of taking it back from the king of Aram?"
- 3 The king of Israel had said to his officials, "Don't you know that Ramoth Gilead belongs to us and yet we are doing nothing to retake it from the king of Aram?"
- 4 He turned to Jehoshaphat and said, "Will you join me in fighting for Ramoth Gilead?" Jehoshaphat said, "You bet. I'm with you all the way--my troops are your troops, my horses are your horses."
- 4 So he asked Jehoshaphat, "Will you go with me to fight against Ramoth Gilead?" Jehoshaphat replied to the king of Israel, "I am as you are, my people as your people, my horses as your horses."
- 5 He then continued, "But before you do anything, ask GOD for guidance."
- 5 But Jehoshaphat also said to the king of Israel, "First seek the counsel of the LORD."
- 6 The king of Israel got the prophets together--all four hundred of them--and put the question to them: "Should I attack Ramoth Gilead? Or should I hold back?" "Go for it," they said. "GOD will hand it over to the king."
- 6 So the king of Israel brought together the prophets-- about four hundred men--and asked them, "Shall I go to war against Ramoth Gilead, or shall I refrain?" "Go," they answered, "for the Lord will give it into the king's hand."
- 7 But Jehoshaphat dragged his heels: "Is there still another prophet of GOD around here we can consult?"
- 7 But Jehoshaphat asked, "Is there not a prophet of the LORD here whom we can inquire of?"
- 8 The king of Israel told Jehoshaphat, "As a matter of fact, there is still one such man. But I hate him. He never preaches anything good to me, only

- doom, doom, doom--Micaiah son of Imlah." "The king shouldn't talk about a prophet like that," said Jehoshaphat.
- 8 The king of Israel answered Jehoshaphat, "There is still one man through whom we can inquire of the LORD, but I hate him because he never prophesies anything good about me, but always bad. He is Micaiah son of Imlah." "The king should not say that," Jehoshaphat replied.
- 9 So the king of Israel ordered one of his men, "On the double! Get Micaiah son of Imlah."
- 9 So the king of Israel called one of his officials and said, "Bring Micaiah son of Imlah at once."
- 10 Meanwhile, the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat were seated on their thrones, dressed in their royal robes, resplendent in front of the Samaria city gates. All the prophets were staging a prophecy-performance for their benefit.
- 10 Dressed in their royal robes, the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat king of Judah were sitting on their thrones at the threshing floor by the entrance of the gate of Samaria, with all the prophets prophesying before them.
- 11 Zedekiah son of Kenaanah had even made a set of iron horns, and brandishing them called out, "GOD's word! With these horns you'll gore Aram until there's nothing left of him!"
- 11 Now Zedekiah son of Kenaanah had made iron horns and he declared, "This is what the LORD says: 'With these you will gore the Arameans until they are destroyed.' "
- 12 All the prophets chimed in, "Yes! Go for Ramoth Gilead! An easy victory! GOD's gift to the king!"
- 12 All the other prophets were prophesying the same thing. "Attack Ramoth Gilead and be victorious," they said, "for the LORD will give it into the king's hand."
- 13 The messenger who went to get Micaiah said, "The prophets have all said Yes to the king. Make it unanimous--vote Yes!"
- 13 The messenger who had gone to summon Micaiah said to him, "Look, as one man the other prophets are predicting success for the king. Let your word agree with theirs, and speak favorably."
- 14 But Micaiah said, "As surely as GOD lives, what GOD says, I'll say."
- 14 But Micaiah said, "As surely as the LORD lives, I can tell him only what the LORD tells me."

- 15 With Micaiah before him, the king asked him, "So Micaiah--do we attack Ramoth Gilead, or do we hold back?" "Go ahead," he said. "An easy victory. GOD's gift to the king."
- 15 When he arrived, the king asked him, "Micaiah, shall we go to war against Ramoth Gilead, or shall I refrain?" "Attack and be victorious," he answered, "for the LORD will give it into the king's hand."
- 16 "Not so fast," said the king. "How many times have I made you promise under oath to tell me the truth and nothing but the truth?"
- 16 The king said to him, "How many times must I make you swear to tell me nothing but the truth in the name of the LORD?"
- 17 "All right," said Micaiah, "since you insist. I saw all of Israel scattered over the hills, sheep with no shepherd. Then GOD spoke: 'These poor people have no one to tell them what to do. Let them go home and do the best they can for themselves.'"
- 17 Then Micaiah answered, "I saw all Israel scattered on the hills like sheep without a shepherd, and the LORD said, 'These people have no master. Let each one go home in peace.' "
- 18 Then the king of Israel turned to Jehoshaphat, "See! What did I tell you? He never has a good word for me from GOD, only doom."
- 18 The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "Didn't I tell you that he never prophesies anything good about me, but only bad?"
- 19 Micaiah kept on: "I'm not done yet; listen to GOD's word: I saw GOD enthroned, and all the angel armies of heaven Standing at attention ranged on his right and his left.
- 19 Micaiah continued, "Therefore hear the word of the LORD: I saw the LORD sitting on his throne with all the host of heaven standing around him on his right and on his left.
- 20 And GOD said, 'How can we seduce Ahab into attacking Ramoth Gilead?' Some said this, and some said that.
- 20 And the LORD said, 'Who will entice Ahab into attacking Ramoth Gilead and going to his death there?' "One suggested this, and another that.
- 21 Then a bold angel stepped out, stood before GOD, and said, 'I'll seduce him.' 'And how will you do it?' said GOD.
- 21 Finally, a spirit came forward, stood before the LORD and said, 'I will entice him.'

22 'Easy,' said the angel, 'I'll get all the prophets to lie.' 'That should do it,' said GOD. 'On your way--seduce him!'

22 'By what means?' the LORD asked. 'I will go out and be a lying spirit in the mouths of all his prophets,' he said. " 'You will succeed in enticing him,' said the LORD. 'Go and do it.'

23 "And that's what has happened. GOD filled the mouths of your puppet prophets with seductive lies. GOD has pronounced your doom."

23 So now the LORD has put a lying spirit in the mouths of all these prophets of yours. The LORD has decreed disaster for you.

24 Just then Zedekiah son of Kenaanah came up and punched Micaiah in the nose, saying, "Since when did the Spirit of GOD leave me and take up with you?"

24 Then Zedekiah son of Kenaanah went up and slapped Micaiah in the face. "Which way did the spirit from the LORD go when he went from me to speak to you?" he asked.

25 Micaiah said, "You'll know soon enough; you'll know it when you're frantically and futilely looking for a place to hide."

25 Micaiah replied, "You will find out on the day you go to hide in an inner room."

26 The king of Israel had heard enough: "Get Micaiah out of here! Turn him over to Amon the city magistrate and to Joash the king's son

26 The king of Israel then ordered, "Take Micaiah and send him back to Amon the ruler of the city and to Joash the king's son

27 with this message, 'King's orders: Lock him up in jail; keep him on bread and water until I'm back in one piece.'"

27 and say, 'This is what the king says: Put this fellow in prison and give him nothing but bread and water until I return safely.' "

28 Micaiah said, "If you ever get back in one piece, I'm no prophet of GOD." He added, "When it happens, O people, remember where you heard it!"

28 Micaiah declared, "If you ever return safely, the LORD has not spoken through me." Then he added, "Mark my words, all you people!"

29 The king of Israel and Jehoshaphat king of Judah attacked Ramoth Gilead.

29 So the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat king of Judah went up to Ramoth Gilead.

30 The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "Wear my kingly robe; I'm going into battle disguised." So the king of Israel entered the battle in disguise.

30 The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "I will enter the battle in disguise, but you wear your royal robes." So the king of Israel disguised himself and went into battle.

31 Meanwhile, the king of Aram had ordered his chariot commanders (there were thirty-two of them): "Don't bother with anyone, whether small or great; go after the king of Israel and him only."

31 Now the king of Aram had ordered his thirty-two chariot commanders, "Do not fight with anyone, small or great, except the king of Israel."

32 When the chariot commanders saw Jehoshaphat they said, "There he is! The king of Israel!" and took after him. Jehoshaphat yelled out,

32 When the chariot commanders saw Jehoshaphat, they thought, "Surely this is the king of Israel." So they turned to attack him, but when Jehoshaphat cried out,

33 and the chariot commanders realized they had the wrong man--it wasn't the king of Israel after all. They let him go.

33 the chariot commanders saw that he was not the king of Israel and stopped pursuing him.

34 Just then someone, without aiming, shot an arrow randomly into the crowd and hit the king of Israel in the chink of his armor. The king told his charioteer, "Turn back! Get me out of here--I'm wounded."

34 But someone drew his bow at random and hit the king of Israel between the sections of his armor. The king told his chariot driver, "Wheel around and get me out of the fighting. I've been wounded."

35 All day the fighting continued, hot and heavy. Propped up in his chariot, the king watched from the sidelines. He died that evening. Blood from his wound pooled in the chariot.

35 All day long the battle raged, and the king was propped up in his chariot facing the Arameans. The blood from his wound ran onto the floor of the chariot, and that evening he died.

36 As the sun went down, shouts reverberated through the ranks, "Abandon camp! Head for home!"

36 As the sun was setting, a cry spread through the army: "Every man to his town; everyone to his land!"

- 37 The king is dead!" The king was brought to Samaria and there they buried him.
- 37 So the king died and was brought to Samaria, and they buried him there.
- 38 They washed down the chariot at the pool of Samaria where the town whores bathed, and the dogs lapped up the blood, just as GOD's word had said.
- 38 They washed the chariot at a pool in Samaria (where the prostitutes bathed), and the dogs licked up his blood, as the word of the LORD had declared.
- 39 The rest of Ahab's life--everything he did, the ivory palace he built, the towns he founded, and the defense system he built up--is all written up in The Chronicles of the Kings of Israel.
- 39 As for the other events of Ahab's reign, including all he did, the palace he built and inlaid with ivory, and the cities he fortified, are they not written in the book of the annals of the kings of Israel?
- 40 He was buried in the family cemetery and his son Ahaziah was the next king.
- 40 Ahab rested with his fathers. And Ahaziah his son succeeded him as king.
- 41 Jehoshaphat son of Asa became king of Judah in the fourth year of Ahab king of Israel.
- 41 Jehoshaphat son of Asa became king of Judah in the fourth year of Ahab king of Israel.
- 42 Jehoshaphat was thirty-five years old when he became king and he ruled for twenty-five years in Jerusalem. His mother was Azubah daughter of Shilhi.
- 42 Jehoshaphat was thirty-five years old when he became king, and he reigned in Jerusalem twenty-five years. His mother's name was Azubah daughter of Shilhi.
- 43 He continued the kind of life characteristic of his father Asa--no detours, no dead ends--pleasing GOD with his life. But he failed to get rid of the neighborhood sex-and-religion shrines. People continued to pray and worship at these idolatrous shrines.
- 43 In everything he walked in the ways of his father Asa and did not stray from them; he did what was right in the eyes of the LORD. The high

places, however, were not removed, and the people continued to offer sacrifices and burn incense there.

44 And he kept on good terms with the king of Israel.

44 Jehoshaphat was also at peace with the king of Israel.

45 The rest of Jehoshaphat's life, his achievements and his battles, is all written in The Chronicles of the Kings of Judah.

45 As for the other events of Jehoshaphat's reign, the things he achieved and his military exploits, are they not written in the book of the annals of the kings of Judah?

46 Also, he got rid of the sacred prostitutes left over from the days of his father Asa.

46 He rid the land of the rest of the male shrine prostitutes who remained there even after the reign of his father Asa.

47 Edom was kingless during his reign; a deputy was in charge.

47 There was then no king in Edom; a deputy ruled.

48 Jehoshaphat built ocean-going ships to sail to Ophir for gold. But they never made it; they shipwrecked at Ezion Geber.

48 Now Jehoshaphat built a fleet of trading ships to go to Ophir for gold, but they never set sail--they were wrecked at Ezion Geber.

49 During that time Ahaziah son of Ahab proposed a joint shipping venture, but Jehoshaphat wouldn't go in with him.

49 At that time Ahaziah son of Ahab said to Jehoshaphat, "Let my men sail with your men," but Jehoshaphat refused.

50 Then Jehoshaphat died and was buried in the family cemetery in the City of David his ancestor. Jehoram his son was the next king.

50 Then Jehoshaphat rested with his fathers and was buried with them in the city of David his father. And Jehoram his son succeeded him.

51 Ahaziah son of Ahab became king over Israel in Samaria in the seventeenth year of Jehoshaphat king of Judah. He ruled Israel for two years.

51 Ahaziah son of Ahab became king of Israel in Samaria in the seventeenth year of Jehoshaphat king of Judah, and he reigned over Israel two years.

52 As far as GOD was concerned, he lived an evil life, reproducing the bad life of his father and mother, repeating the pattern set down by Jeroboam son of Nebat, who led Israel into a life of sin.

- 52 He did evil in the eyes of the LORD, because he walked in the ways of his father and mother and in the ways of Jeroboam son of Nebat, who caused Israel to sin.
- 53 Worshiping at the Baal shrines, he made GOD, the God of Israel, angry, oh, so angry. If anything, he was worse than his father.
- 53 He served and worshiped Baal and provoked the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger, just as his father had done.